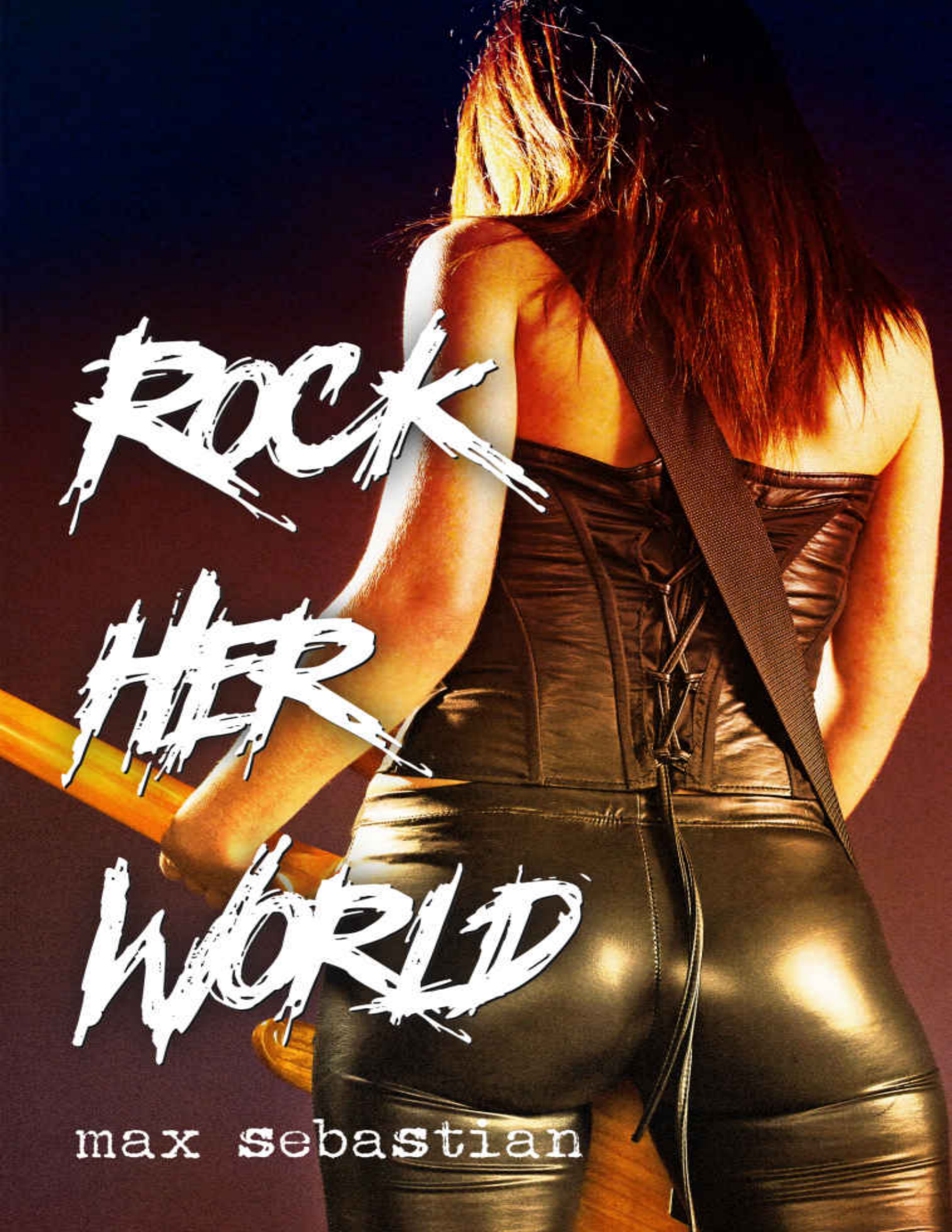


A woman with long, reddish-brown hair is shown from the back, wearing a black leather corset with lacing and a matching leather skirt. She is holding a guitar neck, which is visible on the left side of the frame. The background is a dark, warm-toned gradient.

Rock

Her

World

max sebastian

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Chapter One

“I don’t understand how a heart is a spade.”

Kat’s voice carried out over the crowd, sweeter and more harmonic than the original Elastica version, but no less powerful. She found Julian in the crowd of the bar, mixed in with the rest of the patrons at The Rail. Even through the dim light of the bar, he could see how bright her brown eyes shone, alive with energy. The way she always got when performing.

The band grew quiet, its dramatic inhalation before the punch of the next line. Kat leaned in, grasping the mic on its stand and pulling it close to her lips. She smiled as she looked out over the audience. And delivered.

“But somehow the vital connection is made!”

Pushing the mic away so abruptly that it wobbled and nearly fell off the stage, she stepped back, strummed down on her guitar, and let the band around her erupt into noise.

Julian couldn’t help smiling, and when their eyes met again, she was smiling back. She looked good up there, and it wasn’t just the energy of the music and stage and performance. She’d transformed from the woman Julian had been married to for the past five years into the rocker chick he fantasized she’d been, back in her early twenties. She wore skin-tight, ripped jeans, and a loose, sleeveless t-shirt that hung off one shoulder, exposing her bright red bra strap beneath.

Donny, the male lead of the band, stepped forward and took up the vocals as Kat went to work on her guitar. She tossed her head as the music moved through her, her high ponytail bouncing back and forth. The jagged sweep of her bangs, which she was growing back out, fell across her eyes and stuck to her forehead. Julian thought of sex, and looking around, wondered how many other guys in the bar were thinking the same thing.

Weird thing about that was that most of the guys here knew Kat, although not this version of her. This venue, The Rail, was local, as was the band she performed with. They were a garage band of 30-somethings who got together once a week and messed around on their instruments, reliving their younger years. Most of the time, they were known by their day jobs—

Donny was in commercial insurance; Kat was the music instructor at Kingston High School and organized the high school band; the others had similarly normal jobs. But every once in awhile, they'd dress up and play rock band for a night, here at The Rail, or at a neighborhood festival, or even, on occasion, at a gig in the city.

Julian always loved these nights, because playing in front of an audience like this always got Kat worked up. By the time they got home, they were tearing each other's clothes off like they were newlyweds.

It did get Julian wondering what she'd been like, back in the day, when she'd played guitar for The Ponytails and had actually gone out on tour. Like every other time he considered this, his pulse rose and his pants began to tighten. The Ponytails, the all-girl, college rock band she joined when she was in school about fifteen years before and had made something of a name for itself, always projected a wholesome image. But they also toured, had groupies, and were all attractive women at the most carefree time in their lives. He figured *something* must have happened behind the scenes, and his idea of that *something* seemed to get wilder and naughtier with each passing year.

Not that he ever asked her about it. More likely than not, the things he imagined were all in his head, and he didn't want that fact to be confirmed. He didn't want to be disappointed. He wanted to live the fantasy, and preferred to exist in a world where the possibility was alive.

Kat and her current band played through a few more covers of songs from their younger years—some Garbage, some Stones and some Beatles, and a touching rendition of Nirvana's *Come As You Are* with Kat on vocals. Most people were at The Rail to drink and socialize, but enough got into it that it felt like an audience. When they came off, they got a nice round of applause, even some whistles mixed among the high-fives and pats on the back.

A thin sheen of sweat had settled across Kat's tanned skin—a gift from her Puerto Rican mom and Italian dad, along with her dark and wavy hair. She was smiling, her teeth bright and straight, her cheekbones rising, flushed from the set. Julian wanted to grab her, drag her home, and throw her on the bed. He pushed through the crowd, determined to do just that, when someone else got to her first—a statuesque blonde he recognized but couldn't immediately place.

“Awesome job,” he saw her say to Kat before hugging her. Julian took in the trim blonde automatically. She looked about Kat’s age—mid-thirties—tall and attractive and stylish. The way people from LA were stylish. She had the tanned complexion of a Southern Californian, too, her tousled golden hair loosely falling around her shoulders.

Kat spotted him over the woman’s shoulder, her face brightening. She waved him over as the blonde turned to regard him. “Jules, I want you to meet my good friend Josie Jones. God, you look great, Josie!”

Josie Jones. It took Julian just a second more for the name to fall into place. When it did, he wasn’t the only one to turn and take a second look at the blonde. Josie Jones had been the founder and lead singer of The Ponytails. She was also the only one of the five to go on and make something of a name for herself, cutting a few solo albums before moving into a production role for some label or another. She was an MTV personality at one point, posed in Maxim and FHM and a few other men’s magazines, and ten years ago, she would have been recognizable anywhere. Now, she was hanging out with Julian and Katalina Dennis.

“Jules. So good to meet you,” she said. Josie had a deep, sensual quality to her voice, damp and throaty, exactly like her vocals.

“It’s good to meet you, too,” he said, unsure of whether he should shake her hand or hug her. So instead, he did nothing but stand there awkwardly and let his wife take control of the questioning.

“So what are you doing here? Where are you staying? You should have told me you were coming.” Kat stopped herself, laughing. “Sorry, this is just so unexpected.”

There was a vibrancy to Kat that made Julian think of a younger version of his wife, albeit a version he’d never met. Girly and giddy in a way that the Kat he knew just wasn’t.

“Sorry. I would have given you some advanced warning, but I wanted to share this news in person.” Josie glanced at the stage, where the next band had started to do their sound check. “Let’s grab a booth. Away from the stage.”

Julian felt something shift inside him, exciting and scary and uncomfortable all at once. As he followed Josie Jones to the front of the bar, where a table had opened up near the door, he felt the current of the evening catch him, pulling him into the dark unknown.

The table was rickety and sticky from spilled beer. No one had bothered to come and wipe it down. It was that kind of night. If it bothered Josie Jones, though, she didn't show it. If anything, as Julian watched her look around and smile, she seemed at home here, more than he did.

Josie leaned in, and Kat, opposite her, did the same. "Okay, so you know that new Aaron Simpson flick that's coming out? *Prisoner's Wife*?"

"You mean the sexy Oscar-grab?" Kat asked. "Of course."

"Well, they want to use *Prisoner of My Heart*." Josie's big, blue eyes went wide. "*In the opening credits*."

Prisoner of My Heart was The Ponytails's one and only hit. Although it never made it into the Top 100 or anything, it got enough radio play to warrant a tour.

"No way," Kat said, covering her mouth.

"Yes!"

"You do this?"

Josie looked sly. "Maybe I played a part." The women exchanged a conspiratorial look that Julian couldn't parse. "But there's more. They want us to re-record it, so that it matches up with their framing." She did this squeal without actually squealing, and incredibly, uncharacteristically, Kat echoed it. "We're getting the band back together!"

"You talk to the others?" Kat said.

"Mm hm. Renee and Alyssa are in. Jacqueline was a maybe because she's expecting in a few months, but I've got another drummer lined up in case she can't. So what do you say?"

Kat turned to Julian, and at first he thought she was looking for approval. That was certainly there, mixed in with a *can you believe this* bewilderment. But there was something else that he couldn't quite place. Something that just barely knitted her brows together and cast a shadow across her amber irises.

He put his hand over hers, squeezing it. "You're on summer break. If you want to, I say go for it."

Josie nodded in encouragement. "I saw you tonight. You've still got it. Come on, it'll be like old times."

Kat's face seemed to color, although it was hard to tell with her dusky skin and the dim light of the bar. The next band came on, the crash of drums drowning out Kat's response. Julian thought he heard her say, "That's what I'm afraid of," but he couldn't hear.

“Sure. I’m in.”

*

They talked logistics after that. Kat would have to fly out to LA in about a month, where she’d meet the crew of *The Prisoner’s Wife*, maybe even Aaron Simpson, Josie said. She’d be there just a couple days, recording the updated version of *Prisoner of My Heart*, and then she’d be home.

After that was settled, the two women caught up with each other’s lives. Julian listened, although most of the details were lost on him. He’d met the other members of the band, but it was years ago, at their wedding—Josie couldn’t make it, but Alyssa, the bass player, Renee, the keyboardist, and Jacqueline, their drummer, had attended. All were married now, even Josie, which Kat almost didn’t believe, despite the sizable diamond ring the blonde wore.

“It’s true. It was kind of a spur of the moment thing. We were in Vegas and...” She shrugged.

Kat laughed. “Okay, now that makes more sense.”

Julian was again struck by the subtle change that overcame his wife as she caught up with her old friend. She seemed younger. More carefree. She smiled more. Laughed more. Just watching her mannerisms, the way her eyes went wide when Josie said something shocking, the way she’d lean in and cover her mouth, was like seeing the woman she must have been in The Ponytails days.

Not that they talked about those days. Not directly. Whenever things started to veer in that direction, the two would cast furtive looks at Julian and they’d skirt around it, back into safer territory. Or maybe he was just imagining that. He was, after all, getting kind of drunk, and when he drank, his imagination had the habit of getting away from him.

Eventually, the night ran out. Josie caught a cab back to her hotel—despite Kat almost insisting that she crash on their couch. Despite how much he really liked Josie, Julian was happy to see her go her way. It may have been late, but seeing this side of his wife, along with the drinks they’d put away, had him itching to fool around with Kat. Not to mention the fact that she was looking so good dressed as the rocker girl she was.

*

“That was unexpected,” Kat said as they entered their townhouse. Julian could still feel the energy of the night, and even better, could sense it in Kat, too. “I haven’t thought of Josie in ages.”

“Apparently she’s been thinking of you,” he said. He moved up behind her, running his hand across her ass. He took a deep breath, steeling himself to ask the next question. “So, you never think back to those times?”

She glanced at me over her shoulder, the spill of her bangs falling over one eye. “Sometimes.” The word had gravity.

“Nights like tonight?”

She nodded.

His hands went to the bottom of her shirt. He began to pull it up, revealing the smooth and flawless expanse of her lower back. He leaned down and kissed her shoulder, right next to the red strap of her bra, where her shirt had slipped off. “You miss it?”

She helped him remove her shirt before answering. “Parts of it.”

“Such as?”

“Performing in front of a crowd.” She turned, facing Julian. Still in her heeled ankle boots, she was nearly as tall as his 5’9”, only much more lean, much more sleek. And with much larger breasts. The red bra she wore, padded and lacy and straining to contain her tanned cleavage, did a good job driving this point home.

“You like the attention?” Julian ran his hand up her side, feeling her ribs beneath his fingertips.

“That’s not it exactly.” She’d talked about this before, but for some reason, Julian wanted to hear it again. “It’s more the energy of performing. The instant feedback loop. When we’re up there, and the audience is into it, energized because we’re energized...”

She shuddered. Her nipples were hard, pressing against the red lace. Julian reached up, pushing the straps from her shoulders.

“All that energy turns you on,” he finished for her, although he was pretty sure that wasn’t exactly what she was going to say.

“You know it does.”

He tugged the straps lower, out along her arms until the cups pulled away from her dark and swollen nipples. Leaning into her, he sucked the left one into his mouth.

He wanted to ask her how she dealt with that lust-fueled energy back before him. Instead, he said, “What else do you miss about being in The

Ponytails?”

Kat groaned as he toyed with her tits, her hands raking through his curly hair. For a moment, he thought that was all he was going to get out of her. Then: “The girls. Hanging out with them.”

“It was fun?”

“Mmm... yeah.”

“Bet you got into some trouble.”

Kat’s laugh turned into a sigh of pleasure. This time, she didn’t answer, but her hands did become more insistent in his hair. He realized that she was pulling him back up to her, in for a kiss that was deep and hard and urgent. How could he not read all kinds of dirty things into a kiss like that?

She dragged his shirt off as they kissed and groped through the apartment, heading for the bedroom. They didn’t quite make it, tripping over the coffee table and tumbling onto the sofa. Kat laughed, her tits jiggling over the edge of the bra as she fell onto her back.

Julian pursued, dropping to his knees between her legs. He reached for her jeans, expensively torn and clinging to the flare of her hips. She unsnapped them as he yanked, the practiced motion of two people married for the last five years. He took her thong with it, unleashing the trimmed bush of dark hair. He could smell her excitement, her pubic curls glistening with it.

Julian dove down between her tawny thighs, spreading her pussy with his fingers as his tongue traced her slit, from base to her engorged clit. He felt the weight of her heel on his back and was encouraged by her purr. She was wet, the way she was always wet after performing, and opened to his tongue and mouth like a flower in the spring.

He fantasized as he ate out his wife. He thought about her time with The Ponytails, coming off a show, charged by the music, her fans, the energy of a night of rock and roll. He thought about the looks that Josie and Kat shared, or the way they never seemed to actually *talk* about the good old days.

Was she hiding something? In his head, as he danced his tongue along her clit, he hoped that she was. He imagined a stranger coming up to her, a tall, handsome groupie with broad shoulders, a big cock, and all the confidence that went with it. Then his mind added a second guy, just as strapping, just as cocky, and things got really wild.

Above her, in the real world, Kat was gasping and moaning. *Ohhh, yes...that's...that feels sooo good.*

In his head, though, she'd gone back to her hotel with these two guys...and this time, Josie was with her. They'd pair off, each making out with one guy, then they'd switch and make out with the other, slowly getting naked the whole time.

Kat in real life clamped her thighs around his head, muffling out everything else as she rode his face. He could feel her orgasm, more than he could hear it. He felt the quiver of her thighs, felt the tightness of her pussy around his fingers, the way her fingers gripped his hair. She lifted her ass from the sofa, grinding it against his mouth. She'd never done that before.

Not with him, anyway.

That thought ignited something inside of Julian. He rose, working open his cock. She reached for his erection, grabbing it, guiding it down to her open thighs. She didn't say anything, but she was hungry. He wondered if she was thinking about the past, too.

He entered her, sinking cleanly. Easily. Burying his face in her rich hair, laced with sweat and perfume, he went back to the fantasy. The guys were fucking the two women, each of them bouncing in a lap—Kat's dark, Latin complexion riding one man, Josie's California tan riding another. Their eyes would meet, and they'd lean in together, their lips touching in a soft kiss before they giggled and broke apart. *Fuck, that's hot*, one of the guys would say. *Do it again*, agreed the other. The second kiss would be deeper, less playful. Josie would push her tongue into Kat's mouth, and Kat wouldn't hesitate to accept.

"Oh, Kat." Julian grunted, the only warning he gave as he exploded inside his wife.

"Yes, yes, Jules. Come. Come for me!" She wrapped her arms around him as he drove forward, releasing a torrent of come deep. The fantasy lingered as her cries turned into cries for the fantasy man and his come. He'd grab her by the hips, jerk her hard into his lap, and erupt inside her.

Sated, but not sober, Julian and Kat clung to one another as they tried to catch their breath. "We're still in the living room," Kat said, looking around. She gave a sharp laugh.

So, she'd been somewhere else, too, Julian noted. He wanted to ask *where*. Instead, he said, "I think I had too much to drink."

"Lightweight," she giggled.

“Hard to keep up with a couple of rocker girls.”

“Please. That was fifteen years ago.”

Julian stroked the small of Kat’s back. “Maybe not so long ago for Josie.”

“Yeah, I get that impression, too. I still can’t believe she actually got married.”

“Was she pretty wild? Back in the day?” He added the second question as a hedge.

Kat shrugged. “You could say that.”

“Want to share any fun stories?”

Kat shifted, looking at him with a knowing smile. “Why? So you can fantasize about Josie Jones and her wild exploits?”

Or I could fantasize about your wild exploits. He almost said it, then chickened out. “I wouldn’t be the first.”

“Come on, husband of mine. Let’s go to bed.”

The moment had passed.

Or so Julian thought.

Little did he know that everything was about to change.

Chapter Two

Thank goodness it was the summer break, that was all Kat could say.

There was no way she would have pulled any of this off during the semester, even if they could have squeezed the whole recording session into a weekend. She only had a month to prepare—that was insane.

She had so much to ask Josie about what had been agreed, but the first thing she said on Facebook Messenger when she got home was:

[Kat:] Are you kidding me? We only have a month to get ready for this? When did you find out?

Josie came back.

[Josie:] I swear, I only found out last week, and I really wanted to tell you in person.

Even an extra week would have been nice.

[Kat:] You can tell me on Facebook next time, or email. Give me a call, even.

It was okay for Josie, she was already based out in LA, she had the vocal coach, the personal trainer, even a goddamn personal chef to keep her in top form. Sure, her acting career hadn't exactly taken off if you didn't count guest appearances, but she was ready for something like this.

[Josie:] You know if this all goes well, people could be streaming and buying our stuff online. Isn't that crazy? I could see us coming back at Christmas to get some kind of Greatest Hits album off the ground.

A Greatest Hits album... no pressure.

But Kat had to prepare herself. Oh, she kept in shape, but she was going to meet the stars of *Prisoner's Wife*. Aaron Simpson. She was going to have to fit in with all those stick thin Southern California women.

"You look amazing, are you kidding me?" Julian said as she returned from her third gym visit that first week after Josie's visit. "You don't have to fit in with anybody. I love that you're not stick thin. You have curves, baby."

But he supported her when she went to yoga twice a week, when she did it in front of the TV in the evenings. When she transformed her diet into

something lean and protein-rich and supposedly based on something done in South Beach, Miami.

And then she had to actually practice, of course. Almost all her free time was spent in the attic of their townhouse, thrashing at her old Gibson. The infamous mid-track guitar solo had her the most worried. It had been years since she'd played it, and while she could still hit all the right chords, it never sounded right to her.

"You're not shooting a video," Julian had said to her.

"No," she replied, "but I am playing the kind of song that was exhausting enough when I was twenty. I need to be in amazing shape."

It wasn't a wholly physical thing, of course. She had enough experience with live performances—and with just two days to record the track, this was akin to a live performance—to know how important confidence was to her own music. If she could get back some semblance of her early-twenties form, she could play like one, too.

Julian helped with the confidence, too. The way he looked at her when she came back from a run, or while he watched her doing yoga in front of the TV, was exhilarating.

He helped fix her meals on the weekends. He massaged her aching muscles after a workout. He watched her practice her guitar sometimes, and he made love to her afterward when she was so frisky from the buzz of playing and him watching.

He could make her come like a damn freight train when she came down from practicing. He barely had to pull off her damp clothes, get his hands on her and she was already halfway there.

And when they were together, his questions—his interest—got her going, too. Wow. Was the band really getting back together? It was going to be wild.

"What do you want to know?"

"You know... just what happened... what it was like."

"What it was like? It was...exciting. Why do you want to know?"

Early on, of course, Kat had felt guarded about Julian's questions. She didn't want him to know what it had really been like in the band, on tour. Half of it she couldn't remember anyway. The other half... well, he'd been jealous enough when they'd started dating.

"Because I'm curious. You were in a band! You never really talk about it. You were famous for goodness' sake."

“Hardly famous. We had one hit single.”

“You were playing to... what... five thousand people at a time? Ten thousand?”

Kat laughed. “I think the most we ever performed in front of was, like, three. And that was just when we were opening for Garbage.”

“Even so. Three thousand people wanting to get into your panties—”

“It really wasn’t like that, honey. Ever.”

Not quite, anyway. On Facebook, Josie told her that she told her husband stories about the old days all the time. George got off on hearing about his wife’s exploits with the band, from inviting fans into the dressing room between numbers, to banging members of the headline act on the damn tour bus.

But then, as Josie told it, George got off on stories about her sleeping around in Hollywood even these days, *during* their marriage.

[Josie:] You know if we get the Greatest Hits album going, there might be demand for a comeback tour?

[Kat:] Seriously?

[Josie:] Hell yeah. You think Julian would be up for you doing that? Maybe even quitting your job for a few months...

[Kat:] I don’t know... what does George think of the idea?

[Josie:] George is in love with the idea. And what goes on tour stays on tour, as far as he’s concerned.

[Kat:] Except that you tell George everything, of course.

[Josie:] Of course. Don’t you think Julian would care to know how his wife is on tour?

[Kat:] And how is his wife on tour?

[Josie:] Come on girl—you can barely pick up your guitar without fucking something in pants when you finally put it down again.

[Kat:] Julian knows that.

[Josie:] I bet he does. I saw the way he looked at you when you’re on stage.

[Kat:] And how does he look at me on stage?

[Josie:] Like George looks at me. Like he can’t wait for you to tear the clothes off whichever man is nearest when you come off stage—even if it’s not him.

[Kat:] You’re crazy, Josie. With a capital Zee.

There was no way Julian was like Josie's husband. Josie had met him only once. Anything she thought she might have seen was just projecting. It's what Josie did. It's how she lived her life.

In Kat's mind, it was best to let sleeping dogs lie. When they'd dated, she'd talked about being in the band. He'd been uncomfortable about her fame, about guys coming up to her in the street and recognizing her. He hadn't liked the way guys had looked at her, the way men had owned her with their eyes just because they recognized her from The Ponytails.

Why was it so different five years on?

But maybe it was different. He was a lot more inquisitive these days, asking more questions about her time back then. What was it like being so famous? Being on TV, being on stage in front of thousands?

What was it like being a sex symbol? Being on posters on the bedroom walls of teenagers all over the country?

Kat told Josie about Julian's renewed interest, and Josie had said maybe she should open up about what it was really like, particularly on that final tour. There's no way Julian would want to know all that, she'd said. Josie had just laughed and went back to telling her how much George lapped it up.

She almost did tell him. It had all happened so long ago, before the two of them, before any hope of a band revival.

On the last evening before the flight to LA, she was lounging on their large L-shaped couch in nothing more than a white tank top and a pair of little blue lace panties, strumming her un-amped guitar on her lap in front of a muted TV. She'd been thinking about things, about how it had been. About the wild times on tour.

Her panties had been damp before he'd even come to sit down on the floor between her knees, leaning back against the edge of the couch. Before she'd put the guitar aside and reached forward to peel off his t-shirt. Before she'd draped her legs over his shoulders, stroking his hair to encourage him to turn around, to go down on her right there in front of the TV.

She'd almost told him.

Honey, you know what a total slut I was in that band? How it really was on tour? How the groupies used to line up hoping we were gonna pick some of them to help us warm up between songs?

Instead she'd just opened her legs for him, lounging back against the cushions as he kissed his way up her legs, then tugged her little blue panties

down over her hips and thighs and off past her ankles.

“You’re ready?” he asked her, although it was more statement than question.

“Uh-huh,” she said, and maybe she was referring to being ready to play, maybe she meant she was ready for his devotion.

“I’m going to miss you this weekend,” he said, dropping her panties on the couch beside her. She stretched her legs apart for him, her feet sliding along each edge of the L-shaped couch out from the apex.

“Mmm... I’m going to miss this,” she purred, reaching forward playfully to grab his head and guide him down between her thighs.

His moans as he kissed so very close to her pussy drove her wild. His deep voice resonating with her, the vibrations stirring her even before his soft mouth began working its magic.

“Oh God...” she moaned. And then, a few moments later, “why don’t you come with me?”

“Seriously?”

She stroked his hair, gasped as she felt his tongue working its way through her folds, time and again, lodging deep in there. She giggled as he nibbled on her pussy lips, sighed as he nudged her clit with his nose.

“You can be my... support team...”

Julian moaned as he nuzzled into her sweet pussy, her little trimmed patch of dark hair tickling his nose as he feasted on her. She nearly came just from the vibrations of his voice alone.

“I have to work,” he groaned. “I really have to work... You needed a support team in the old days?”

Boy, had she.

She gazed down at her devoted husband as he sucked on her pussy lips, as he flicked his tongue over her little button. “Why... would you even want to know?” she asked. “God that feels sooo good...”

“You guys did nothing but sing about sex and love,” he chuckled, and his deep laughter seemed to provoke the kind of vibrations that melted her.

“We sang about it because we weren’t getting it,” she joked, pulling his head tight against her as though to stop his questions. She came that way. She always came that way.

“We really didn’t get a chance to do much fooling around,” she said when finally releasing his head, unwrapping her thighs from his face. “It’s a big myth that rock stars get laid all the time. Especially female rock stars.”

“A myth, huh?”

Pulling him up for a kiss, tasting herself on his mouth, she allowed him to wrestle her onto the couch. God, five days without him in LA was going to be hard. How would she do without him if the band got back on the road?

“Sleeping with the fans is a bad idea,” she sighed, sitting in his lap to ride the huge bulge in his pants.

“Why’s that?”

She moaned as he reached down to touch her sex while she gyrated her hips over him. “Josie once slept with this guy from Oakland... a fan... he stalked her for the whole rest of the tour...”

“You never dated any of the guys from other bands on tour?”

She gave him a wry smile. “Since when did we talk about dating history, anyway?” She slumped down to the floor now, rubbing her face over his prominent bulge. “You never used to want to know about me... before we met...”

“I was never this... secure,” he said. “I feel different now. Mature, I guess.”

“Mature?” She slipped his big prick out. “I guess so...”

She thought about what Josie had said on Facebook Messenger. How it had all started for her with George. George, who had single-handedly financed her first solo album, who had stood by as she’d dated her producer, her drummer, even her publicist.

It had started with George asking her to talk about her past, her time with the band, her dating. The guy wasn’t jealous, how could he be?

And here was Julian, asking Kat about whether she’d dated guys from other bands on tour. Looking down at her with not just interest, but real desire. *So, this was how it starts*, she thought to herself.

And God, he was so hard when he looked down at her like that. She couldn’t get enough of his colossal form, the size of his manhood, its slight upward curve, the thickness that seemed built for her hands, for her mouth to stretch around.

“I don’t want to know about the girls you dated,” she protested in between mouthfuls of his powerful cock.

“I wasn’t in a band. I didn’t date anyone of any significance.”

She liked the way he said that.

But it immediately invited her unthinking response. “You think fans and groupies are significant?”

“So, you did sleep with them?” He had her there.

But she only smiled, sat back, peeled her top off to reveal her breasts to him, getting off on how he looked at her when she did, her dark little nipples so stiff as he stared at her like that. “Guys in other bands on tour... they were too much like co-workers, you know? And if you’re doing a hundred, two hundred shows with those guys... it’s a long road if you split up with them.”

“Okay,” he said. “So, you guys... didn’t get any action at all while you were on tour?”

She shrugged. “We were constantly on the move... there’s really no time... or space... or money...”

She rubbed herself all over his big erection—her soft face, her breasts, her stomach. Trailing her long, silky black hair all over his pale skin. Slipping the tip of his cock back into her mouth. “You’re sharing hotel rooms with your bandmates,” she said. “There’s twelve on your tour bus and the bunks are like... coffins...”

“Totally shot down my image of life in a band,” Julian grinned. “So you really didn’t date anyone back then?”

She shrugged. “Girls I talked to... always said rock stars pretty much all drink too much to, you know, get it up.”

She stood up, feeling phenomenal after all her working out, after reminiscing. She led him upstairs, to the bedroom, and their large bed where his hands and his eyes could roam her taut body at will.

“Why do you think we’ve all ended up with civilian husbands?”

“Civilians?” He kissed her stomach, breathing her in as though he only needed her scent to reach orgasm. “I’m a civilian?”

“Uh-huh.” She turned her back, letting him run his hands all over her body, all over the velvet skin of her behind, up between her thighs where she was soaking wet. Then she crouched, balancing her body on the tip of his big cock, teasing it into place at the entrance of her sex.

Sinking down slowly, she took his immensity inside her, holding his knees as she bounced on him.

She moved on him, her gaze drifting to the Matisse print on their wall without really seeing it. Her mind drifted... and suddenly he could have been anyone—the fan she’d been with in Austin. Or the drummer from Dreadnaught over in Portland. Or the bass guitarist from Oblivion in Chicago.

She could imagine he was all kinds of other men, men she'd had, men she'd wanted.

And when he had her down on the bed, moving in on her from behind, licking her pussy as she pressed her face into the bedsheets, sliding his fingers inside her, and finally his huge cock... she let herself remember the old days, her rocker days, the days she always figured were behind her for good.

She felt bad about not sharing those thoughts, but she just wasn't sure he was ready to hear about them. As much as she wanted him to be like Josie's George, she could still remember the jealousy and the arguments they used to have. She could still remember thinking: *I'm going to lose this guy, and I love him.*

"You really want me to tell you who I slept with before I met you?"

She looked behind her, watching his eyes widen, his face going tight. He seemed to struggle to answer, catch his breath, and grimace. "Kat, I..." He lost the thread in his uncertainty. His eyes closed and he came hard, exploding deep inside of her.

She looked at him, somewhat surprised herself. "What was that?" she murmured as they lay down on the bed together. "You never did that before."

"I'm sorry," he said. "I guess... maybe I'm getting old."

"That wasn't getting old," she said. "That was... losing control."

"I'm sorry... you didn't..."

"Oh, I did. Plenty." She grinned up at him as he stretched forward to kiss her mouth.

She turned out the lights and lay there beside him, her hand snaking down over his body to rest between his legs. "You really want to know who I saw before you?" she asked. "You're really curious?"

It was mere minutes after sex, but here he was thickening up again, like magic. She thought about George and Josie. Maybe Josie was right. Maybe they really were alike. She brought her fingers to his hardness and gasped. "You're all surprises tonight."

"I don't know why... I'm just... curious, that's all," he said.

"Curious," she said in the darkness, and stroked his stiffening cock. "This is curious?"

"Something like that."

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Chapter Three

Kat flew out to LA the next day, and Julian scrambled to get a ticket to meet up with her. The best he could do was to fly out the following day, his flight arriving late in the evening. It wasn't ideal, but it would have to do.

"I'm going to miss you so much," Kat said at the airport.

"It's just a day, and most of the time you'll be in studio anyway."

"And then I *won't* be in studio," she said.

"Then you'll have to call me and we can try to...work through that."

Phone sex. It wasn't a thing he'd ever tried, and as it turned out, something they didn't end up doing. Kat flew out and, apparently, spent all day and late into the evening recording. By the time they finished, Julian was fast asleep.

Not that sleep came easily. The night before she'd left had been satisfying and hot, but it left him with more questions than answers. Why was she being so vague about her past? Why did it feel like she was constantly dodging his questions? When he fell asleep, it was almost midnight—nine o'clock in LA. They'd been recording since almost the time that Kat got there, so nearly nine hours. He could imagine how tired she probably was...and how turned on.

And he wasn't there to take care of her, either way.

He woke to find some texts from her.

[Kat]: Done for tonight. I'm so fucking sleepy, but the girls want to get a drink. I'm too old for this.

It was time stamped 10:53 LA time. Nearly two in the morning by her body.

[Julian]: So did you go out?

He didn't get a response for almost four hours, and when he did, he laughed.

[Kat]: What a mistake.

He figured she was probably talking about the drinks and being hung over while jet-lagged, but for one brief moment, he let himself think of a darker, sexier mistake she could have made.

Not that he wanted that. Not at all. Even if she had been a little wild back in the day, that was back in the day. Things were different now. Also, importantly, he could totally trust her.

As if reading his mind, she clarified a moment later.

[Kat]: Remind me never to do tequila shots again. Also, I crashed out around 2, but the other three kept on going. Insanity.

[Julian]: Hope you're not all partied out. I'll see you tonight.

[Kat]: Don't worry. I'll recover. Have to, because tonight's the Prisoner's Wife party. And Aaron Simpson IS going to be there!

[Julian]: Good thing I got the flight that I did!

Only it wasn't that good. A storm delayed his flight, and he ended up touching down in LA at nearly nine o'clock local time. As he touched down, he quickly texted Kat that he'd arrived. He didn't get a response until he'd disembarked and was making his way toward the terminal exit.

[Kat]: At the party now. Someone will be there to meet you and take you directly here. See you soon! xx

She was at the party already. Of course she was. She was also at the party after playing guitar for hours, hanging out with a woman who reminded her of her wilder, younger days. It seemed like a recipe for disaster, and yet had Julian hard as a rock.

Exiting the terminal at LAX, he almost completely missed the man in a black suit and a black cap, holding a sign that read, "DENNIS."

"I think that's me," Julian said to the man.

"Right this way, sir."

He led Julian out to a shiny, black Town Car, driven by another man. Julian slipped the man a couple bucks before getting in, already feeling like he'd stepped off the plane and into a dream.

"Um, take me to... I'm supposed to go to a party. I'm Kat Dennis' husband."

"Yes, sir. I know who you are and where we're going."

"Okay." Right, of course he did. Julian looked down at himself, at what he was wearing, suddenly realizing he was headed to a Hollywood party where a movie star would be in attendance. He wore jeans, a t-shirt, and a zip-up sweater. Not great, but he supposed it could have been worse. He could have been wearing sweats.

His suit, the thing he'd intended to wear to the party, was in the trunk with the rest of his bags. He wondered if he could ask the driver to pull over

so he could grab it, but they were already pulling out onto the highway, and the driver didn't look like the type for small talk.

The car drove into the hills that overlooked the glittering lights of LA, where the streets were lined with parked cars and Julian could hear the music of the party before he saw it. It was a classic LA party, right from the movies, and Julian suddenly felt very self-conscious in a zip-up sweater.

"I'll bring your bags to your hotel," the driver said as he pulled to a stop before the ranch-style home. A valet came and opened the door for Julian. "They'll be in your room when you return."

"Um, let me grab something first. Hold on." Julian scampered into the back and exchanged his sweater for his suit's coat. It wasn't perfect, but at least he felt a little better in this crowd. "Do you know where The Ponytails are in there?"

The driver shrugged. "Good luck, man." And he peeled away, leaving Julian without a lifeline. Worse, when he went to retrieve his phone and text Kat that he was here, he realized he'd left it in the backseat of the car.

"Shit."

"Excuse me?" the man at the entrance of the LA home asked.

"Sorry. I'm looking for someone. Kat Dennis?"

The man looked at Julian blankly.

"How about Josie Jones? Of the Ponytails?"

He shook his head, suddenly looking at Julian suspiciously. "What's your name? I need to check if you're on the list."

"Uh, Julian, um, Dennis."

The man scanned the list, a little surprised to find Julian's name printed there. "Go right on in."

Julian grimaced at him. So far, this place didn't seem all that friendly. He entered his first ever Hollywood party. It was everything he expected it to be. Beautiful women wearing tiny dresses. Good looking guys hitting on said women. Fancy cocktails and microbrew beers and loud music being spun by a female DJ wearing a bikini top and a pair of painted on jeans. Sex permeated the air, and somewhere in here was Kat. His wife. Who was probably horny as hell.

He searched the inside of the house for her, and while he spotted several B and C list celebrities, he didn't find his wife, or anyone else from the Ponytails, for that matter. There were some bedrooms in the way back—a few of which had closed doors—but he didn't dare check there. Not yet.

Behind the house was a pool, lit up with underwater lights, and occupied by some patrons who'd thought to come in bikinis. The crowd wasn't as stifling out here, but just as crowded. And he still couldn't find his wife and her friends.

"Excuse me," he said, stopping a redhead wearing a short, blue dress. "Maybe you can help me. I'm looking for...Josie Jones?" He figured if this woman recognized a name, it would be Josie's.

The redhead got it right away. "From the Ponytails? Yeah, I saw them hanging out on the deck. Other side of the house."

Julian looked at the woman. She looked familiar, but he couldn't place her.

"What?" she asked.

"Sorry to stare. This is my first party like this. It's like going to my high school reunion, only I've forgotten everyone's name. Except here, I actually never knew anyone in the first place, just saw them on TV or the movies or something."

He stopped when he realized he was rambling, but he was surprised to see the redhead nodding in agreement, her eyes lit up. "Yes!"

"You look familiar."

"Well, I don't know about that. I'm just another struggling actor in this town is all. Maybe you saw me in a commercial?" There was a sweetness to her that was magnetic.

"Maybe."

"Don't let this one fool you," a deep, cock-sure voice said. Julian would have recognized it anywhere, but was still surprised to see Aaron Simpson join them, putting his arm around the redhead. "This one's destined to be big." He squeezed her close.

"Oh, stop, Aaron," she said, blushing.

To Julian, Aaron said, "Take a good look, my man. You can one day say that you met Hayley Martin before she was an international sensation."

"You're embarrassing me," Haley said, although she was smiling.

"Get used to it. When *Prisoner's Wife* is out, your life's going to change."

Julian cleared his throat. "I better..." He indicated the direction she'd said his wife was. "It's nice meeting you."

Haley nodded, but Aaron had already dismissed him. He was all for the redhead. If those two weren't an item, they soon would be.

Just as the redhead said, Julian found The Ponytails gathered on the deck on the side of the house. Behind them, LA glittered beyond the dark hills the house was perched on. Other than Josie, he'd met them all five years previously at his wedding, but would have recognized them even if he hadn't. He'd spent a lot of time looking over pictures online of The Ponytails, album artwork, tour photos. Now in their mid-thirties, every one of them matured into their beauty, and tonight, they were dressed to show off.

Kat jumped up, giving him a quick flash of the flouncy, bright blue dress she wore before she wrapped her arms around him in a bear hug, sloshing a little beer in the process.

"You made it!" she squealed. When the hug was over, she pulled back and kissed him hard, her mouth cold and wet from the drink. "God, I missed you so much."

"I missed you, too," Julian said. He hugged her again. "And it's good to see you here. This place is—"

"Pretty surreal?"

"Yes. I just ran into Aaron Simpson."

Josie approached them. "Well, this is his home."

"Really?"

"His Beverly Hills one, anyway. He spends most of his time out in Malibu." The blonde pushed a lock of hair from her face. "Hey, Julian. Glad you could make it out. Now George will have a guy to talk to."

Beside her stood George, Josie's husband, and a man who didn't match his idea of what a George should look like—whatever that was. He was short and bald and looked like an accountant in little owlsh spectacles. How on Earth did Josie Jones go for a man like that? Far less marry him. Yet when he spoke, his voice was calm and confident, and when he shook Julian's hand, it was firm.

"Nice to meet you, man. Kat's been talking nonstop about you."

"Really?"

"Just missing you, that's all." Kat snuggled against her husband. Then she bounced off him, taking his hand and pulling him along. "Come on, meet the rest of the gang."

Julian laughed, unable to get over the change in his wife. She seemed effervescent in a way that he wasn't used to, practically skipping with energy. Had she been burying this all these years?

The band greeted him like they were old friends, each coming over and giving him a hug—something he didn't mind at all given the tightness of their cocktail dresses. He probably knew Renee, the keyboardist, the best since she lived only a couple hours away. She was a petite fireball of fun, her shoulder-length hair dyed neon red, as though being a natural redhead just wasn't enough for her. Tonight, her hair was tied back in mischievous pigtails rather than the customary ponytail, to reveal a splash of freckles that should have been cute, but came off as sexy. "Hey, Julian. Been too long," she said after the hug. "You've been keeping in shape. Could you talk to my husband about that, please?"

"I'll see what I can do," he said.

Alyssa, the bass player, was next, hugging him just as tightly. She'd been a brunette the last time he saw her, but tonight, her hair appeared lighter, highlighted to almost a honey-blonde as it caught the soft lights around them. It was long, straighter than Kat's, and pinned out of her face. She had a bit of Russian in her blood, giving her beauty a balanced perfection that was even more stunning now than when she was younger.

"I now understand why Kat couldn't go a few days without you," she said. Where Renee was cute, Alyssa was sultry. He felt himself stir, and did his best to ignore it. "You'll have to let me borrow him later, Kat."

"Get," Kat said. "Hands off this one."

Alyssa laughed, pouting, but took a step back.

"So Aaron asked us to do a quick set here," Kat said, and for the first time, Julian noticed the amps set up on the deck, along with the drums, all set against the backdrop of LA.

"I'm guessing you guys said yes?"

Josie laughed. "One doesn't say no to a man like Aaron." *Aaron*. She even called him by his first name. They were officially in La La Land.

"What about your drummer? Thought Jacqueline was having a baby."

"We got a replacement—Lisa," Josie said, her eyes shifting behind him. Julian looked, and a tall woman with a shaved head turned to them at the sound of her name.

Lisa was something of a surprise to Julian, not necessarily because she was head-and-shoulders taller than him, but because her whole look was just darker than the rest of Ponytails really went for. It was more death metal than hard rock.

"She does know it's called 'The Ponytails', right?" Julian said.

Josie laughed. "She's only a stand-in."

"We can buy her a wig if she needs it," Renee smirked.

Lisa approached them at Josie's signal, and her smile was ready and friendly. "You must be Julian. So glad to finally meet you. Your wife's been talking you up."

"So I heard," Julian laughed. "Well, good luck, throwing yourself in with this bunch."

Lisa chuckled. "I'm up for anything."

"So, you guys are doing, what, a song?"

"Actually," Josie looked back at the group. "We've been working on something new, too. Brand new."

Kat added, "Josie wrote it a while ago, and we practiced over the last few days. It'll be kind of rough, but—"

"It'll be great," Josie interrupted. "And it'll give this bunch a thrill."

"We plan on playing *Prisoner of My Heart* first, then a few of our other hits from back in the day," Alyssa said.

"And then hit them with the new one," Renee finished.

"Glad I made it here in time," Julian said.

"Well, we don't go on for a little bit. Need to finish setting up here. It's all kind of last minute stuff."

George put his arm around him. "Come on, let's grab a drink. Leave the ladies—and gentleman—to transform themselves into rockstars."

Kat kissed him. "I'll see you in a bit," she said, and Julian read suggestion into the look. She must have been amped up, and playing in front of this LA crowd would get her only more so. He was in for a treat tonight.

*

George and Julian ended up settling into a spot beside the pool, sharing a beer as scantily clad women pranced about. It was hard not to look, but Julian tried. Until George called him on it.

"Go ahead. Look. They don't mind."

"I'm not...I mean..." Julian blushed. "This is crazy."

"This scene?"

"Yeah," Julian said. "We live in the suburbs now. We hang out at local bars. Jeans and tennis shoes kinds of places."

“Yeah, no thanks,” George said, then seemed to realize how offensive that sounded. “Sorry man, I didn’t mean anything against you. It is weird to think of Kat Conti living in the burbs, though.”

Julian’s chest tightened. He knew something. Of course he did. “Why’s that?” he asked tentatively.

George studied Julian, raising his brows slowly. “How much do you know about what went on back then?”

Julian’s heart began to race. “Not much. Just that they were really busy, and spent a lot of time on a cramped tour bus.”

George grinned. “Yeah they did.” He left it at that, and as much as Julian wanted to ask more, he didn’t. George moved on. “I’m curious about this new thing.”

“New thing?”

“Josie’s got it in her head to make a comeback. Aaron Simpson’s movie isn’t the first she’s pitched a Ponytail song to. It’s just the first to pick it up.”

“That’s pretty huge though.”

“Josie has her ways,” George said mysteriously—suggestively. “But yeah, it is. And Josie’s hoping it’ll be a springboard for a new album.”

“Wow. You think it’ll work?”

“Probably. If there’s one thing I’ve learned about my wife, it’s that when she sets her mind to a thing, she gets it done.”

“That would be great. Kat would never say it, but she misses it.” He thought of the wild sex they’d been having, and how amped up she always got after a show.

“I bet she is,” George said, again with that hint of suggestion. “But how do *you* feel about that?”

“Happy for her.” He got the distinct impression that he was missing the point. “You?”

“I can’t wait. Josie’s always so fucking hot when she’s performing. Biggest fucking aphrodisiac.”

“Kat, too.”

“So I heard.” George grinned. Before Julian could ask more, though, he went on. “You’re running on East Coast time, man. Must be rough.”

“It’s...what?” Julian looked at his watch, which he hadn’t had a chance to adjust yet. “Two in the morning. Wow.”

George's chuckle was a deep baritone. "You're a real trooper. Out here, midnight's when the real party just begins. Come on, let's get you fixed up with something that'll help you catch that second wind."

Julian followed George into the house and down a hallway, where the bedrooms were. Which was weird, but he went with it. Nothing about this night was normal, so why start now? The music was quiet back here. He eyed the bedrooms, most of which were open. But not all. As if on cue, one of the shut doors opened and a model-thin young woman emerged, rubbing her nose. Another woman followed, equally attractive, wearing a bikini top and still in the process of snapping her jeans shut.

"Perfect," George said, leading Julian into the room they'd vacated. It smelled like sex. "Fucking LA, man. This party's insane."

"They're not all like this?" Julian asked.

George laughed. "No. Not quite like this. This is the big leagues right here, son. Josie did well with this one." He glanced back at Julian. "Hey, lock the door, will ya?"

"Sure," Julian said, his heart rate suddenly elevated. "What are we doing?"

George produced a little baggie of white powder from his jacket pocket. "Partying, of course."

Julian blinked at what he was seeing, his mouth going dry. His heart seemed to want to crawl up his throat. "I... um..."

He lost the ability to speak as George poured a small pile of the stuff onto the dresser and began to carve up a couple lines. Julian wanted to scream. He backpedaled, reaching behind him for the door.

"I'm sorry. I don't do...that."

"Don't worry, man. This is not the chalky stuff. It's real good. Josie gets it from some guy who's real connected." He rolled up a bill, inserted it into his nose, and snorted one of the lines. "Mm, yeah. That's nice."

"Josie does coke?" He knew she was wild, but for some reason, he didn't think that this was part of that.

"Well, not a lot." George chuckled to himself, twisting the rolled bill in his hands. "Not like back when she was touring all the time."

"Like...with the Ponytails?" Julian felt like someone had yanked the rug out from under his feet. His face burned, yet he felt so cold inside.

"Oh yeah man. Those girls knew how to party, from what I hear. Josie's got some wild stories."

“I thought they were more... wholesome.” It sounded like such a ridiculous thing to say.

“Is that really what Kat told you?”

George actually started to look sorry for him, so Julian quickly said, “No, I know it got pretty wild. But I just thought—”

Someone tried to open the door, and Julian almost jumped out of his skin. “Occupied!” George shouted. He held the bill out to Julian and lowered his voice. “You bumping up? We can’t be in here forever.”

“I’ll pass. Thanks.”

George shrugged, doing the second line himself before tucking the totally illegal drugs away again. Jesus. Did... did Kat do that? The thought made him dizzy and sick and aroused all at once. It was insane. *He* was insane.

“You’re missing out, bud. And I’m not sure you’re going to make it.”

“Don’t worry about me,” Julian said. “I’m pretty wide awake right now.”

By the time they exited and got back outside, people were starting to gather for The Ponytail’s show. The windows along the living room had been thrown open, letting people watch the makeshift stage on the deck from inside, as well as out.

Julian lost track of George, which he was completely fine with. Instead, he pushed into the crowd and watched as The Ponytails, minus their drummer, took positions in front of their instruments. Josie stepped to the mic, looking amazing in her skintight, leather pants and equally tight tank top.

“First of all, I want to thank Aaron Simpson for hosting this amazing party,” she began, leading a round of applause that was heartily picked up by everyone. “Working with the crew of the *Prisoner’s Wife* has been so fabulous. The movie’s going to be great, and if it doesn’t win an Oscar, then fuck the Academy.”

There were nervous chuckles, but clearly this crowd wasn’t so iconoclastic as Josie Jones.

“For those of you who don’t know me, I’m Josie Jones, lead singer of The Ponytails, and this is my band behind me.” She went around, introducing everyone. “But we’re not here to talk at you, right?” Lisa began hammering at the drum. “We’re here to rock!”

And with that, Kat strummed down on the guitar and they launched into an updated, amazing rendition of their hit song. Julian had watched Kat play plenty of times with her local band, but the energy that rolled off of them and infused the crowd was a level beyond anything he'd felt before. The music was loud, thundering through them, and like everyone else, he couldn't help himself as he began to move to it.

Josie's vocals were as seductive as ever, but he was surprised when, during the second verse, she stepped back, took up her own guitar, and began to play as Kat took over vocals. Mic in hand, her right foot planted in front of her left, Kat came alive before that group, and by the time she released the mic back to Josie, she was panting.

After playing *Prisoner*, they sang a couple of their other classics. Many in the crowd recognized the songs, but they weren't as enraptured as they were by the hit. That was, until they got to the last song, the new one.

"We've got a little surprise for you," Josie introduced. "We call it 'Smoke.'"

Unlike the hits from the old days, "Smoke" was slower, more paced, more sensual. It seduced the crowd, getting them to lean in, beckoning them close as it built and built. Kat and Josie switched off vocals, their guitars harmonizing along with their voices. Just when the tension was so high the crowd couldn't take it anymore, Lisa came in with the drums, beating louder and louder, faster and faster. The band opened up, Josie whooped into the microphone, and Kat took off on a solo that Julian only now recognized from her last month of practices. He'd thought it was a new riff for *Prisoner of My Heart*. Turned out, she'd been practicing for this very moment.

And it blew everyone away.

Even after the song was over and Josie gave her thank yous, even after the crowd stopped cheering and chanting for an encore, it lingered.

"That was fucking amazing," Julian heard someone say.

"Where can we get that? iTunes?"

"I don't think it's available anywhere."

"Anyone record that?"

Kat found Julian in the crowd. Her blue dress clung to her. Her skin glistened with sweat. She was still heaving, her dark eyes bright. On fire. "That was amazing," Julian said before she bowled him over, kissing him

hard. All he could do was wrap his arms around her and hold her close as she squeezed his head so hard it hurt.

“I *need* you,” she whispered. “Come on.”

She dragged him into the back, slipping into the first open door she found—a bathroom. She shoved him against the door as her hands went to work on his jeans. He was hard for her, caught up in the swirl and desperation she was feeling. It was like all those times back home, only they weren’t at home. They weren’t anywhere private. He could still hear the party behind him, felt the bass of the music as the DJ filled the void left by The Ponytails.

“I missed you so much last night,” Kat said, dragging his pants down. She clutched at his cock, stroking it. “Missed *this*.”

“I’m here now.”

She reached beneath her, shimmying out of her panties without removing her dress. “Yes, you are. Now stop talking and fuck me.”

Julian kissed her hard before turning her, pushing her down over the sink. He flipped her dress up around her waist, took his cock, and buried himself. She was drenched, and he slid into her with only the slightest of resistance.

“You liked playing in front of all those people?” he asked as he began to fuck her.

“Mmmhmmm.”

“You were so hot up there. So commanding.”

Their eyes met in the mirror. Hers were wild with excitement. “It felt amazing,” she said.

“Like old times?”

“Exactly like old times.”

“So back then, did you ever drag someone into a bathroom for a quick fuck?”

Kat moaned, shutting her eyes rather than answering. Her orgasm crashed through her, ambushing her. She gritted her teeth, trying to quiet her moans, but anyone walking by would know exactly what was going on.

Julian couldn’t let it go, though. He’d been teased too much by her past. He needed something concrete, for once. “Did you, Kat? Tell me.”

“Uh, baby, do you really want to know?”

“Yes!” He squeezed her ass in frustration.

“I did,” she said. “That what you want to hear?”

He clutched her ass harder, fucked her faster. “Yes, baby. I do. Tell me more.”

“I didn’t do it often, but there were a couple times when I just couldn’t wait... the biggest shows, the ones in front of the largest crowds, were so fucking intense.”

“Intense enough that you dragged the first guy you saw into a bathroom to take care of you?”

“Well maybe not the first,” she said, her eyes glittering. “But the second or third, yes.”

“So hot,” Julian moaned.

“One time, I couldn’t even get to a bathroom. We fucked in an alcove backstage, as the main act went on.”

“You did?”

“It was so hot, Jules,” she said. Her voice was strained. Her second orgasm was peaking.

“I bet it was. Did you suck him off? Or just go at it. Like this?”

“Just like this. No foreplay. He yanked my pants down and fucked me.”

“Oh, fuck.” Julian lost it, his balls tightening, come boiling up his shaft.

“*Then* I blew him. For round two.”

“Fuck!” He exploded, filling his wife as she filled his head with her dirty, naughty past. She joined him, dropping her head between her shoulders and she pushed her hips back into him, accepting him, accepting his strange excitement.

When they recovered, they realized where they were, and what they’d just shared. She looked at him in the mirror again, because it felt safer than meeting him face-to-face. “You’re okay with that?”

Julian pulled his jeans back up. “Of course, baby. It was a long time ago.”

“It was.” She took his hand. “Come on, let’s get back to the party.”

With the sex out of the way, they rejoined the party and had a good, normal time. It felt more like a reunion than a time hanging out with a bunch of rockstars. Only they were rockstars, and occasionally people would come up to them and ask about the new song.

“So, what’s the plan?” Julian asked at last.

“We’ll see,” Josie said. “We’ll know in the next couple days if it left an impression. It’ll get back to a label, and someone will approach us. If that happens...” She made an exploding motion with her hands.

All the women seemed excited by this prospect. George put his arm around his wife. “Then, the real excitement happens.”

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Chapter Four

“She’s not the kind of girl

Who likes to tell the world...”

They were back in The Rail again, and Kat was with her garage band of middle-age misfits, who sometimes called themselves the Warblers, sometimes the Ragbags, sometimes Kristen Stewart Blew Me Sideways or some other such anonymous label.

“About the way she feels about herself...”

Kat was on vocals again, since her fill-in band was mostly male, and they were covering a Garbage song from the 90s. God, she felt good. She was wearing a ballerina’s tutu over skin-tight leather pants, and a sparkly skin-tight top that was so low-cut it looked as though her breasts could spring free any moment, particularly if she jumped up and down a little more.

What could she say? Ever since she’d got back from LA she just felt like showing off. She liked the way people looked at her, people wanted her. Men.

“She takes a little time

In making up her mind...”

There was a little group of men in the front row, holding their beers and gazing up at her as she sang. Wanting her. Maybe it was just the opportunity Josie had dangled in front of her—of the Greatest Hits album, of going on tour again. She was horny almost all the time now—and doubly so when she was up on stage performing.

Thank God she was wearing leather pants, that was all she could think as she looked at her fans in the front row. She could feel that tingle between her legs as she looked at them, so adoring. As she remembered the power she used to command over men like that in the old days.

She flicked her ponytail and continued singing The Trick Is to Keep Breathing, and it almost felt like she was making love to the audience with her mouth.

Julian was going to get it when they got home. She was going to have to pounce on him.

*“Lately I’m not the only one
I say never trust anyone...”*

Right now she could see him standing there at the back by the bar. Unobtrusively. She flashed him a smile and he flashed one back, adoring her, loving how much fun she was having up here on stage. God, he was amazing. Ever since they’d got back from LA, he’d been a rock. In more ways than one. She’d wanted to spend more time keeping fit, and practicing guitar, and he just supported her, whatever she wanted to do.

As the song hit its stride following the release of Prisoner’s Wife, Julian had supported her in attending the movie premiere in New York.

As the rumors persisted that the band was reforming, that there might be a tour on the cards, it was Julian who had said it would be fine for her to cut back on her work at the high school if such an opportunity came along.

*“I won’t be the one who’s going to let you down
Maybe you’ll get what you want this time around...”*

And of course, Julian had been there every week that she managed to appear here at The Rail with the rest of her local band. Letting her get up there on stage, get her rocks off. There for her when they ended their set, and she just needed to go home and fuck someone.

Ever since LA, Julian had been particularly good at that.

Only, he kept asking about her past, about her time with the band. About who she had slept with on tour. Sometimes she persuaded him it wasn’t a good idea for her to tell him everything. Sometimes she was just too horny to keep the details from him.

They came to the end of the Garbage cover, and Kat went back to playing guitar on the next number, a Green Day song. It allowed her a little more freedom to look out into the audience—where she saw Julian talking to someone at the bar. A guy she recognized.

Who was it?

The two of them were still watching the band, but chatting as though they were old buddies. The guy was wearing a faded black t-shirt... Kat recognized it as a tour t-shirt, from the Ponytails no less. Now she knew where she recognized him from.

He had been on tour. Not a roadie, not a member of a supporting band or a headline band... a fan... a groupie... Oh God...

He smiled at her. He had hardly aged at all in the decade since the Ponytails had done anything together. Handsome, sure. Square-jawed, almost military in bearing. It was his eyes she remembered particularly—those cool blue eyes, eyes she's stared down into while he'd gone down on her after she'd come off the stage.

What was he talking about with Julian? She felt frightened, and a little turned on. Did Julian know who he was? Julian would be interested, she had no doubt of that. But would he be horrified what had really gone on during the tour?

The man clinked glasses with Julian as though they'd just made a bet. He moved through the crowd, toward the empty table just by the edge of the stage. He caught Kat's eye again as she strummed the guitar, and Kat could feel her pussy tingling just from the memory of his tongue...

What was he doing sitting there? Did he imagine she would go straight to him after she was done on stage?

Glancing back at Julian, she found him talking with someone else—Josie Jones, trying to blend in by wearing a pair of ridiculous sunglasses.

Kat watched her talking with Julian as though they were old friends, as though they'd fought in the trenches together. Their greeting was much warmer than it had been the last time they'd met in The Rail. Even if it had only been a few days, it seemed that spending a weekend in LA at the same parties now gave Julian a solid connection to Josie.

What was she doing here? Something good, hopefully. And if Josie bothered to come to The Rail, chances were it did mean something good.

At the end of the Green Day song, that was it for their set. Kat was itching to get off the stage and find out why Josie was there.

"Kat! Kat!" The guy was right there as she came off stage. Towering over her. She remembered that, his huge physical presence. He'd been a Marine or something. Before his obsession had turned to the Ponytails.

"Hey, how are you?" she greeted him as though she didn't really remember him, but was pleased he knew who she was.

"You don't remember me?" he laughed.

She stepped around him, though in doing so one of her hands brushed up against his chest. His big, strong muscle-bound chest. Jesus. It made her shiver.

"You knew me from the band?" she asked him.

“You could say that,” he grinned. “We went out, remember? I used to...make you feel good...after you finished on stage.”

“I...I remember...” she said, not wanting to react to him, but feeling completely betrayed by her body. The memory of his body against hers made her tingle. “What are you doing here?”

He laughed again. “You’re all going on tour again, right? You’re all getting back together.”

“How did you—”

“It’s obvious,” he grinned. “The Prisoner’s Wife... the new track... the Greatest Hits album... you gotta be going on tour again.”

She stepped away from him, feeling slightly intimidated—and totally frightened by her own desire for him. How could a guy make her feel like that? After all this time?

He reached for her, handed her something. A room key.

“Four Seasons,” he called out. “Two-five-oh-one.”

She skedaddled. First time that word had ever seemed appropriate to her. She skedaddled, scurried away to the back of the room.

“Hey, you look like you’ve seen a ghost,” was the first thing Josie said to her. The two women embraced.

“I... uh... think I might have,” she grinned, accepting a large rum and coke from Julian gratefully.

“You were amazing up there,” the blonde said. “You had the audience in the palm of your hand.”

“What’re you doing here?” Kat asked Josie.

“I came to talk to Jules, here,” her old bandmate giggled. She was wearing faded blue jeans and a striped top, with a faded black jacket over it. Very dressed down, and yet she still looked gorgeous in it.

“You came all the way across country to talk to my husband?” Kat laughed.

Josie shrugged. “I can talk to you on Facebook, honey. But right now I need to get the support of the husbands... if we’re going to do what I want us to do.”

“What are you talking about?”

“The tour, baby!”

“No!”

Cue much screaming and yelping. Julian looked slightly dazed by it all. Kat couldn’t believe it was really happening, but Josie was here to tell

her it really was.

“The track’s out next week for streaming,” she said. “But there’s already been a lot of advanced orders... and a lot of interest in us touring again. We’ve had offers from a ton of bands to support them, put it that way.”

Kat was squealing, she was so excited. Josie following suit, the two women seeming to forget where they were, and the fact that the blonde, at least, was trying not to stick out.

“Hey, look,” Josie said. “Let’s go back to my hotel, huh? We can raid the mini-bar, order room service. Celebrate, for God’s sake!”

There was another man with Josie. He hadn’t spoken all night, accompanied her as though he was some kind of bodyguard. He had the kind of physical presence to be a bodyguard, anyway, Kat thought.

“George not with you on this trip?” Julian asked her as they clambered into a black Lincoln Town Car for the journey to the hotel.

“Oh, George is back home,” Josie smiled. “He doesn’t much enjoy leaving California, to be honest. He sent his buddy Marco, here, to keep me company...”

Julian nodded a greeting at Marco, the bodyguard who now shared the kind of smile with Josie that made it seem like he was more than just a bodyguard.

“You guys,” Kat giggled. “Poor George.”

Josie smiled. “George loves the idea of me being out here with Marco, actually.” She patted Marco on the thigh. The big man put his hand on hers, and it was clear that something was going on between them.

“How is that?” Kat asked. “How can he just...let you go like that?”

Josie shrugged. “Ask Jules. Jules can understand it.”

Kat looked to her husband. He was blushing furiously. He said, “I just want you...to be happy, sweetie.”

“Happy? What are you talking about?”

He shrugged. “What happens on tour...stays on tour, and all that.”

“I totally don’t get what you’re saying,” Kat said.

Josie sighed. “I didn’t just come here to ask Jules to let you go on tour, hon,” she said. “I mean, he doesn’t own you, right? It’s not up to him.”

“No, it’s not. But it has a lot to do with him,” Kat pointed out. “It affects our lives together.”

Josie said, “I know you, Kat. How you get... on tour...”

“And how do I get?” she demanded to know.

Josie shrugged. “Horny?” she suggested. “I mean, to start with.”

They were pulling up at the hotel now—the Four Seasons, just down the highway from Kingston, and the closest luxury hotel.

“What are you saying?” Kat asked her bandmate while they were in the elevator up to the room.

“I’m saying... either Jules comes with us on tour... or... he has to accept some kind of leniency... if you know what I’m saying. There’s no way you’ll survive otherwise.”

Kat glanced at her husband. He did not look unhappy with the situation. He did not look in any way upset at the dilemma they were facing. “Leniency?” she asked him.

He tilted his head, “It’ll be okay,” he said. “I think it’ll make you happier, honey. In the long run.”

“But... what are you saying, leniency? Leniency in what?”

The room door closed behind them. Josie said, “We’re going on tour for quite a while, honey. On the road. Jules can’t come with us the whole time—he’s got to work, right? So he’s... going to allow you... a little freedom.”

“What kind of freedom?” Kat felt her heart beating like a hammer drill. Was she being stupid, wanting Julian to spell it out?

He said, “Look, I know how it’s going to be. You’re going to need... some attention... that I can’t always give you. I just think... maybe if we’re completely honest about it with each other, it wouldn’t be so bad. Rather than keeping things secret from each other.”

“Hey,” Kat said, “I wasn’t intending to keep anything secret from you...”

“No,” he said, “but this way... you’ll get the best of the experience from going on tour, right?”

She frowned. Josie lounged on one of the sofas set around this part of their suite, and Marco poured her a Bourbon. The blonde said, “Honey, you remember what happened in Sacramento?”

Kat looked blankly at her bandmate. “Sacramento?”

Josie laughed. “You... had to take a course of antibiotics, remember?”

Kat blanched, and looked horrified at her husband, but Julian just smiled and accepted a drink from Marco. Kat said simply, “I remember.”

Josie nodded. "You couldn't have sex for two weeks," she said. "You remember what that did to your confidence? And your playing?" The blonde shook her head. "We're not going through that again," she said. "We have one shot at this, we don't have much room for bad nights."

Kat took a Diet Coke from the mini-bar. "Who was that guy you were talking to before Josie turned up?" she asked her husband.

"Vincent?" he asked her.

"I've seen him somewhere before, haven't I?"

Julian nodded. "One of your old fans," he said. "Heard there was a new tour happening. Heard you performed fairly regularly at The Rail, too."

"But what did you guys talk about?"

Julian shrugged. "He told me... how hot you get on stage. How... you know... you have needs when you come off stage."

Kat sighed, and took a seat on the couch opposite Julian. "What else did he say?"

"That he used to... help you. That you picked him out of the crowd a few times... during gigs..."

Her husband was talking as though telling her about his day at work, or about some movie she'd never seen before, or the items they needed at the grocery store. He didn't seem in the slightest bit jealous, or angry, or horrified.

"He told me that if he stood by the stage tonight, you'd run into him and you'd want to... sleep with him."

"And what did you say?" Kat asked him.

He shrugged. "I didn't really say anything to him," he said.

Marco poured himself a Scotch and soda, and now came to sit with Josie. Right next to her, in fact, as though the two were a couple. He really was a big guy, in every respect. Josie always had had a thing for big guys, from Kat's recollection.

"So... how does it work with George?" Kat asked Josie now.

"How does what work?"

"You know... letting you... see other guys."

Josie shrugged, and stroked Marco's tree-like thigh. "He likes me to be happy," she said. "He likes me to have fun... and... he wants to know all about it."

"What does that mean?" Kat said, and now got up to snuggle in with Julian on the other couch. "What does he want to know?"

Josie said, "I talk to him every night, at least. And he gets to hear every detail about everyone I see while I'm not with him."

"You tell him about Marco?"

"Uh-huh. All about Marco."

"And how does Marco feel about this?"

Josie looked at her lover. Marco shrugged. "Marco gets to sleep with me," Josie said. "I don't think he complains about it."

Kat stroked her husband's thigh now. "And you really think something like that could work for us?" she asked him. "For the whole tour?"

She couldn't help but notice the bulge in his pants.

He shrugged. "I can't say why," he said earnestly. "I just think it's hot."

"And... what... you'd get to see other women while I'm away?" Kat asked him, a sharp edge in his voice.

He shook his head. "I'm not interested in other women," he said. "I have you, honey."

Kat felt the room key digging into her hip. She had it stowed in her pocket—should have thrown it away, of course, but she hadn't. Vincent. The man who had made her come like nobody had ever. And right now, she could walk down a few flights of stairs and have him there between her thighs again.

"What happens on tour stays on tour," she said. "Except that I'd have to tell my husband everything, right?"

Josie nodded. "That's about it."

Kat's hand brushed gently over her husband's substantial erection. "You know that Vincent guy is staying in this hotel?" she said, then asked Josie, "Did you have a hand in that?"

Josie shrugged. "The guy's been calling my production office for months wanting your phone number."

"And now I have his room key," Kat said, glancing at her husband with a question in her eye.

Her heart was just about beating loud enough to wake the dead.

Chapter Five

Julian watched Kat struggle. They all did. The room itself practically held its breath. He felt like he'd been dipped in the caldera of a volcano, and the lava was still dripping off him. Kat glanced at him, her dark eyes lost, confused...tempted?

"I..." She shut her eyes and released a loud breath. "God, I can't." Shaking her head without opening them, she said, "I'm not that girl anymore. I'm not her." When she opened them again, she stared at Josie in defiance. "I'm not."

Josie, for her part, just held up her hands in surrender. "Hey, girl, I'm here to support you. We all are, right, Julian?"

The spotlight back on him, he burned again. "I... yes."

"You're not disappointed, are you, dear?"

"Josie..." Kat said in warning.

"I know how much you like hearing about Kat, back in the day, but she's totally right. She's not the same woman who spent the entire bus ride between Phoenix and San Diego fucking our stage manager at the time—"

"Josie!"

"Oh, I'm sorry, you didn't tell him about Steven?" She looked at Julian. "Should I tell him about Steven?"

"No thank you," Kat said. Turning to her husband, she said, "Steven was our stage manager for a part of the tour, and we got... close."

Josie went on. "Steven replaced Vincent when Vincent couldn't follow us anymore, who was then replaced by Maurice... You know, I ran into Maurice the other day. He's shaved his head now. Still has the goatee, though. God, I love that look—black man, shaved head, bit of facial hair. Maybe I should have told *him* about you out here. I'm sure he'd love to reconnect."

Kat was bright red. "Don't listen to her. She's making it sound worse than it was."

"Am I, though?" the blonde teased.

“Yes! We played, most of the time. It wasn’t like, wall-to-wall orgies or anything.”

“No, we only had a couple orgies,” the blonde winked.

Julian’s eyes grew wide, his cock so stiff he had to shift and adjust.

“You like that idea, huh, Jules?” Josie asked.

It was Marco, though, who found his voice. “Wait a minute, did you two hook up?”

Kat stared at the blonde, slowly shaking her head. Josie, for once, seemed to heed Kat’s plea. Sort of. “What happens on tour, stays on tour.”

“Fuck me,” Marco groaned.

Josie climbed into his lap. “I plan on it.” To Kat and Julian, she said, “You want to watch?” Then she smiled wickedly. “I know Kat does, and I bet you do, too. Eh, Julian?”

“We’re out of here,” Kat said, although she didn’t move immediately. She seemed enthralled by Josie, even as the blonde pulled her shirt over her head, revealing a black, lacy bra beneath. Her chest rose and fell in rapid succession.

Julian recognized that reaction, recognized her need now. As much as she wanted to claim that she wasn’t the same woman she’d been back on tour, as much as she pretended that she could get by without the kind of leniency Josie had suggested he offer her, he knew she couldn’t. Sex and rock and roll were so tightly wound in Kat’s very being that it would be impossible for her to deny herself. He didn’t think she’d be able to last a week.

But the greater question was, would they? Could he really let her have that kind of freedom? Could he really let her go back to the lifestyle where she fucked some guy on the bus for hours between cities?

And it wasn’t just the sex. In fact, the sex was the least of his worries. The sex was actually an incredible turn on. Even now, he felt a twinge of disappointment that she hadn’t gone up to Vincent’s room—or that they were about to leave this one. No, the sex was thrilling. It was the rest of it that terrified him—the fame, the lifestyle, the thought of losing his wife to a world he wasn’t part of. Would she be able to come back to him after that? Would she want to?

“You’re still here,” Josie said, looking over her shoulder at the two of them. “Does that mean you’re going to stay?”

She reached behind her, unhooking her bra. Julian caught a glimpse of the side of her breast, where her nipple sat hard and high.

“No, we’re leaving,” Kat said. Broken from her spell, she grabbed Julian’s hand and pulled him toward the door.

Julian gave one last look at the blonde rockstar’s half-naked body before he was swept away, out into the hall. Kat only shut the door before she threw herself against him, kissing him passionately.

He held her close, his hands ranging along her body. She was tight and toned, yet still had a butt he could grab, firm breasts that mashed against his chest as they made out.

“Oh, my god,” Kat groaned.

“You want to go back in there? May be a little more private than the hallway.” He looked down the row of closed doors, where anyone could emerge at any time.

“You’d like that, wouldn’t you?” Kat said, half-playful.

“Wouldn’t be the end of the world.”

Kat laughed. She pulled out the room key—Vincent’s key, presumably. He didn’t quite believe that she actually had it. “There’s another room we could go to.”

Julian’s breath caught. It was a joke, he knew, but for a second he imagined it wasn’t. And rather than feel any jealousy, he was turned on.

“We can if you want to.”

Kat pulled back, looking him in the eye. “You’d really be okay with that?”

Julian licked his lips nervously. He was. Or he thought that maybe he was. Josie had broached the subject long before tonight, but he’d kept it to himself as he struggled through the implications. Would he really be fine if she fucked another man? It definitely turned him on, but how would he feel after?

“I think so,” he said, uncertainly.

“Not good enough. Come on, let’s go home so I can fuck you silly.”

*

“What’s the wildest thing you did while on tour?” Julian asked. They were in bed, having just finished a wild bout of sex. Two weeks had passed since

Josie Jones left, and they had about two more before she flew off to California for the first, mini-leg of the tour.

“The wildest?” Kat hesitated.

“What’s holding you back? You know how much those stories turn me on, right? You can tell me whatever.”

Kat traced circles on his chest as she considered. “It’s not...so simple.”

“You sowed your wild oats back then. You were in a rock band. Seems pretty straightforward to me.”

She bit her lip, thought a moment, and sighed. “We all met at Julliard. All of us classically trained. Really talented. I always thought I’d end up in an orchestra. Alyssa actually did do that. For a few years, anyway.”

Julian knew most of this already. They’d gone to one of the most prestigious schools for music in the country and left it playing rock music for the masses. Josie was the most ambitious. Taking her talent and insight of music theory, she studied contemporary music. Their sound was manufactured, in theory, to be popular. It sort of worked, but never carried them into the upper echelons of the music world.

“Anyway, we were pretty popular in New York City, so we made a run of it.”

“And lived the rockstar life, until you eventually broke up.”

“You know why we broke up?”

Julian shook his head. “You never told me.”

“Chicago...” Kat said to herself, then shivered. “Things got...out of hand in Chicago. I actually quit. I couldn’t do it anymore. I looked at myself and didn’t recognize the woman staring back at me.”

“What happened?” Julian asked, his heart thumping.

“You asked about the wildest sex I’ve ever had. That happened.”

“But what happened?” Julian asked, his frustration rising.

“It was Josie who brought them back to our hotel room. Oblivion, the band we were starting for. The whole band was there. Six guys. All young. All super hot, in that rocker way.”

“Who else was there? Just you and Josie?”

“Oh, no. All the girls were there. We were all partying pretty hard. Drinking, smoking... other stuff—”

“Drugs?”

Kat blushed. “Some of that, yeah.”

“Jesus.”

“This is why I never told you—”

“No. I’m sorry. Go on.”

Kat took a deep breath. “One thing led to another and all of a sudden, everyone was naked. We were so out of it, I barely remember the details, but...”

“But you remember some.”

“Some, yeah.” She was back there, far away. “I remember it being rough, and...begging for more. I remember taking on...” She shuddered. “Three guys at once.”

Julian’s eyes flew wide. “Three? How?”

She looked at him, her eyes dark, searching. “You know, one in each hole.”

He gulped, imagining that. Imagining his sweet wife getting double penetrated, a man in her pussy, another in her ass, as she gagged on the third’s cock.

“No way.”

“I know, right? And...and I loved it. I didn’t want it to end. I think I cried when it did, it was so intense. But in the morning, sober...” She shook her head.

Julian released his own breath. He shouldn’t have been so turned on by what a slut she had been, but his cock was hard as steel, despite the sex.

“You didn’t like what you’d become,” he said. She nodded. “And you’re afraid of what you may become now, if you had the freedom to play.”

“Yes.”

“So instead, you’re just going to deny everything.”

“Pretty much.”

“You think it’s going to work?”

Kat sighed. “It needs to.”

“It doesn’t have to be all or nothing,” Julian said. He took her hand and led it down to his cock. She found him hard, looking up at him in surprise. “How about we just play it by ear, okay?”

“I might be a trained musician, but I don’t have perfect pitch. You know I don’t play things by ear, right?” She laughed, although it sounded reluctant. “What do you mean, exactly?”

“Well, you’ll be gone a while.”

“Just a month, probably.”

“Unless the tour’s a real success, right?” Julian smiled. “So... if you find that you need to satisfy certain needs—needs you can’t take care of yourself—then you have my permission to take care of that.”

“But I won’t need that.”

“Okay,” he said, kissing her. Not believing her. Neither of them really did. “But if you do, then go for it.”

He rolled her onto her back, took his cock, and slid it home. “All I ask is that you tell me about it. Be honest with me, okay?”

“Always.” She was so wet.

“Doesn’t need to be at the time. But I need to know after, okay? The truth. No more holding back.”

“The truth.”

Julian grinned. “And if you’ve got pictures, that’s even better.”

“I’ll see what I can do,” Kat laughed.

They rutted, working up a sweat. She wrapped her legs around his back, digging her heels into him. For a moment, he thought she was lost in memory. Then, as her orgasm built, she said, “You really like the idea of me with other men?”

“Other men. Other women—”

“Men,” she said, but the closeness of her orgasm stole the bite from it. She clawed down his back, saying, “Maybe that’s how I’ll satisfy any urges. Renee always did like women just about as much as men.”

Julian thought of the spunky, freckled blonde keyboardist—so cute and sweet that he never would have suspected a thing had he not heard the stories—going down on Kat.

“Really? You and her—”

“It was Alyssa and Renee more often than not, but there may have been a drunken night or two.”

“Oh, fuck, Kat...”

“I’m going to have to shave, though,” Kat said, her teasing driving Julian past the point of no return. “Renee prefers it bald. Says she does her best work with a blank canvas.”

“Uh, fuck!” He unleashed himself, unable to hold himself any longer as the image of Kat with Renee buried itself deeper in his head. The thought must have hit Kat just as hard, because a moment later, she joined him.

Cuddling once again, this time completely spent, Julian said, “That really happen?”

“Are you asking me if I played with girls, while in the band?”

His heart skipped. “Did you?”

“Not very often, and usually, there were guys there and we were all pretty out of it. But... yeah. I did.”

“Well, if that does happen on the road, I’d like to hear about that, too.”

Kat laughed. “Of course you would.” She kissed him. “Deal. Now let me sleep. I’m so tired.”

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Chapter Six

When it was actually happening, Kat could hardly believe it. It took a while to get everything confirmed. It wasn't until the end of October that everything got set up, and they were due to start touring in December—she had hardly any time to prepare. But, prepare she did.

The thing was, this wasn't just about being good. It was about meeting all the expectations. And the last time the fans had seen the Ponytails, on tour or anywhere else, they'd all been ten years younger. Kat worked hard at the gym, and played hard back home, and while she was pushing herself beyond her comfort zone, she constantly had the image in her head of a Kat in her mid-twenties.

By December, though, she was pleasantly surprised how her hard work had paid off. She could look at herself in the mirror and there were no longer those awkward angles from which she'd rather not see herself. She could strip down and turn this way and that in front of the mirror, and everything was where it should have been.

"Jesus, you look amazing," Julian had said on the final night before everyone was due to fly back out to LA for the first leg of the comeback tour.

"Thank you," she said, almost smug. There wasn't much room for modesty here.

Julian was lying on the bed watching her trying on outfits for the tour. She didn't usually let him watch her trying on clothes, but these days she was so full of confidence, she found she enjoyed showing off for him. And the outfits that Josie had decided on for the tour... well, they made her feel super naughty, and that made it super fun to try them on in front of hubby.

There were the leather pants that were so tight that they looked painted on. There were the tiny little skirts that covered almost nothing. The spandex leggings that made her look like some kind of adult superhero.

There were the tiny PVC dresses that pushed up her cleavage so much it looked like a buoyancy aid, while leaving so much thigh uncovered she thought fans in the front row would be able to see her underwear.

Of course, the show was partly for Julian's benefit, too. He wouldn't get to see the shows—he would be home, working. He didn't get to take time off, not with all those household bills to be paid now that Kat was taking time off for the tour, and the tour money wouldn't start coming in for a while with all those overheads to be paid.

She liked how he watched her, the little gasps he tried to stifle, the way his eyes widened when she presented herself to him in all manner of sexy outfits.

"And it's not just going to be you wearing this kind of thing on stage?" he asked her at one point.

"No... all of us. Well, similar."

"You guys never used to be quite so... raunchy."

She smiled. Raunchy. She liked that. "No... but we're reinventing ourselves, right?"

Julian had pulled himself off the bed while she was peeling off another dress, and when she turned away from the mirror, naked once again, he was right there and his hands were all over her.

"Reinventing yourselves as what?" he asked her, pulling her naked body to his clothed frame, kissing her mouth deeply.

"Most of our fans are older now," she said, breaking away from his kiss, but draping her arm around his shoulders to keep him there—she was done with the fashion show. She was facing long weeks away from him, she needed every moment she could get.

"So, they've all turned into horn dogs?" he smiled.

"No, but they've got slightly different tastes now."

She moaned as his hand found its way between her thighs, stroking her there, his fingers quickly finding their way to exactly where she wanted them, coating themselves in her slick juices.

"It was never so much about what you were wearing," he said. "Or... I suppose... not wearing..."

She grinned. "You love it. You love every outfit."

"Only wish I could be there to see them on stage."

"You can. Backstage passes whenever you want them."

"Maybe, maybe."

She leaned back against the dresser, and Julian crouched as he kissed his way down her chest, taking her stiff nipples into his mouth.

“Music acts have to reinvent themselves to stay fresh,” Kat said. “Especially if they’re women.”

“No,” he said, kissing underneath her breasts, breathing in her scent as though it made him high. She knew she’d spent an afternoon practicing guitar, she knew how sweaty it had made her. And yet, she didn’t stop him. Couldn’t stop him. Her body was crying out for his attention.

“You have fans,” he insisted. “They adore you no matter what you look like.”

Kat giggled as he held her hips and kissed over her stomach, tickling her almost to the point that she wanted him to stop. She didn’t, though. She could sense his hunger, sense his desire. She could tell how wound up he’d become from lying there watching her stripping off and trying on outfit after outfit. She liked him like that.

“Josie says we need to attract new fans if the tour’s going to be a success. New fans only know us as a bunch of middle-aged housewives...”

“Thirty-something is not middle-aged,” Julian laughed, his chin now brushing the top of her little patch of dark brown pubic hair. “And none of you are really housewives...”

He picked something up from the dresser. Something that clinked as though made from metal. Kat looked down, and saw him wielding a pair of silver scissors.

“What are you doing?” she asked, but didn’t stop him. She kept her hands by her sides, clutching the edge of the dresser as he knelt in front of her, leaning in to kiss her mound. She felt the warmth of his breath on her sensitive sex as he stroked her pubis with his nose and his mouth, inhaling deeply as he kissed her there.

“You haven’t forgotten, have you?” he asked, smiling up at her.

She was too stunned to move. Too surprised to budge. She just stood there, naked, gripping the edge of the dresser as he trimmed the longer hairs from her bush with a pair of scissors designed to cut nails.

“Forgotten?” she said, as though his question had woken her from sleep.

“You said you were going to have to shave it,” he reminded her. “You said Renee prefers it that way...”

“Renee?”

She seemed baffled, despite what they’d talked about so many times.

He said, "Somebody's going to have to take care of you while you're away, remember? We talked about this."

She seemed to wake up, saw what he was doing. But still it surprised her.

"We're... we're really... doing that?" she asked him.

"Uh-huh," he said. She couldn't believe what he was doing.

She parted her legs a little more. She liked feeling his hands on her body, though it felt a little weird him snipping off her short curls.

"We're going to make a mess out here," she said, standing up. He looked up at her, and nodded, and they moved to the bathroom where she could sit down on the edge of the bath, and he could spread shaving foam over her public hair before running a very sharp razor over her soft brown thatch.

He was gentle, careful. Dedicated.

"I could have done this myself," she said, but she liked his hands all over her, stretching her flesh this way and that to make the skin taut for the razor.

"But this way, I get to see you before you go," he grinned. "Before Renee gets you."

That made her catch her breath somewhat. "Are you... serious?"

"Sure."

She looked at him, and he seemed to be. Shaving her pussy for somebody else's benefit.

"You said she likes it this way."

"We're really... doing this?" she asked again, stunned.

"What goes on tour stays on tour, right?" he grinned. "Except... when your husband gets to find out..."

Then he was spreading lotion all over her shaven pussy, holding up a little hand mirror to see it, all bald and bare and pink like one of those porn stars. He slid his finger inside her and she was almost coming before he'd even had a chance to bury his face between her thighs. Then when he started working her with his tongue...

"Renee's going to love this," he said, gazing up at her killer body, seeing just how hard her nipples were now.

"You're... crazy..." Kat moaned.

"You're going to be away for a while," he pointed out. "And while you're away you're going to be performing virtually non-stop..."

“I can take care of myself,” she insisted.

“You can,” he said. “I’m just saying you don’t need to.”

They showered, and went to bed, and she was on her back with his face between her thighs, licking her soaking pussy as he told her he wanted her to fuck whoever she wanted on tour, male or female. She could hardly believe it had come to this, that her husband was really giving her a break from the traditional confines of marriage.

“You are going to come out and see me, though. Aren’t you?”

He smiled up at her. “Every other week,” he said. “I’ll be there.”

She stroked his hair, worried about the toll all that travel would take on him. “You’ll be constantly on planes,” she said. “And if the first leg is successful, the full tour will be seriously long, honey.”

“It’ll be worth it, huh?” he said, climbing onto her, sliding his hard cock inside her dripping wet sex.

“And we’ll see each other on FaceTime, right?” she said, lifting her feet up to his shoulders. “I’ll call you every night.”

“Call me when you can,” he said, leaning down to touch the tip of his nose against hers as he thrust his stiff shaft inside her. God, he felt massive. “If you have to wait until after a certain... groupie... has left your bed... so be it...”

It was just so hard to believe he was so willing to raise the subject of her infidelity. And yet here he was, and it seemed to make his big, hard cock throb inside her.

“You’re going to get jealous,” she warned him.

“No, not at all.”

“Maybe not now. But later, when I’m gone. When you start thinking that every moment I’m not on stage I could be...”

“I’d hope you would be...”

“Taking some guy from another band into my bed... or maybe a fan...”

“Now you’re talking,” he grunted, and she couldn’t believe how much he was stretching her inside. It just felt incredible, his gorgeous cock rubbing up against every single sensitive part within her pussy.

“You’ll be at home all on your own,” she said, “Thinking about me riding some beefy guy’s big cock on the tour bus...”

“Uh-huh, baby.”

He turned her over onto all fours, and she willingly allowed him to manhandle her until he was ready to slide straight back into her pussy, this time from behind, holding onto her hips as he pounded into her.

“You’re sure... about this... honey?” she asked him in between panting, in between gasping for air.

“Of course.”

“I’ll be... cheating on you...”

Just there—he left his cock inside her for a moment, and she felt it throbbing.

“It won’t... be cheating... honey...”

“It will... I’ll be cheating on you... taking some other guy’s... big... cock... inside me...”

He didn’t last long. It almost amused her how quickly she got him all riled up and ready to explode, just by using certain trigger words. Cheating. Fucking. Cock. Pussy. Only, it turned out that saying words like that riled her up, too. Got her going.

She was riding him, cowgirl-style, and every time she glanced down at herself, she saw her bare sex, and it reminded her that her husband had shaved her, had removed every hint of hair from around her pussy, with the expressed purpose of preparing her for someone else’s sexual enjoyment.

She glanced down and told him how she was going to cheat on him, how her bare sex was the living proof that he was letting her go off and do exactly that. Man or woman, she had the freedom to choose.

And, she thought, if he gets this hard every time she told him about her infidelity... wow. Just, wow.

He exploded inside her, and she was just so turned on by it all that it triggered her own climax. She was riding him and cursing and gasping and crying out, her whole body seeming to bloom into one great fireball over her man.

Afterward, she was just shattered. She just had to lie there a while, sucking in breath.

“How long until we have to get to the airport?” Julian asked her, spooning up against her hot, clammy body.

“Uh... seven hours,” she said, glancing at the alarm clock on her bedside table.

He licked his fingers, and now reached between her legs. She couldn’t believe he was still game. “Why don’t you tell me something hot?” he

asked her.

“Like what?” she smiled, even though he couldn’t see her face properly from where he lay behind her.

“Like... how it was the first time you ever slept with a woman...”

It made her giggle. All guys liked to hear about that kind of stuff, didn’t they? Girls sleeping with girls. Women playing with women. But how many husbands liked to hear about their wives’ dirty pasts like this? And how many husbands wanted their wives to go out and actively create new dirty stories about debauchery like Julian?

“It was... back in college...” she said, moaning as his fingers stirred inside her, and she felt his cock pressing up against her behind, thickening up almost magically as she began to speak. “I went home with this guy from a party... and it turned out he had a girlfriend...”

“And you slept with her?”

“I slept with both of them...”

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Chapter Seven

Julian had never had that bittersweet moment at the airport with his wife before. It wasn't so much that they never took trips away from each other, it was just that they had never really spent any extended periods of time away from each other before. So here, for the first time, Julian took Kat to the airport and experienced a tearful goodbye.

And it actually was pretty painful. He was counting down the seconds until they got to security, and she had to go through, and he wouldn't be able to go with her any further.

She was wearing a tight black Guns 'n Roses t-shirt and jeans, and as usual she made it seem like the sexiest outfit on Earth. Her hair was tied in a loose plait to fall down one side of her head, her make-up applied to the point where her husband was wondering if she was going to ask one of the flight attendants out on a date.

He was missing her before they'd even parted.

"It'll only be a couple weeks, and then you'll be flying out to see me," she said.

"I guess so," he nodded, trying to suck it up, be a man, all that good stuff. "Won't be long."

Meanwhile his insides felt like they were being shredded.

"It's going to be like we have a long-distance relationship," he said, joking but really not.

She smiled, oh-so-sweetly. "We can do this," she said. "We know we can." She hugged him, squeezing him tightly, her breasts crushed against his chest through that thin t-shirt.

"You'll call me as often as you can?" he asked her. "On FaceTime, right?"

"Of course," she grinned. "And you don't need to worry about me at all."

"No, I know that."

Plenty of couples have to go through the Airport Goodbye. Julian looked to the other side of the security line and there was another couple

looking as though they were going through exactly the same thing. Well, not quite exactly the same thing.

The thing was, though, most of these couples, if any, hadn't already talked about the wife going away and acting as though she was single. That seemed like the elephant in the room right now for Julian and Kat.

"You'll tell me everything, won't you?" he asked her, hugging her back as though wanting a promise from her before he'd let her go.

"I will," she said. "But you know, I'll probably be okay without... you know... other people."

"Will you, though?" he pushed his head back, stared in her dark, dark eyes.

She blushed fiercely. "I can... deal with things... myself..."

As much as he enjoyed the mental image of her dealing with things herself, Julian still harbored that powerful fantasy of her not being able to deal with things herself.

He held her gaze, said quietly, "But if you can't... for whatever reason... after a gig... before a gig... in between songs..."

"I don't need it in between songs!" she chided him.

"But... whatever. If you need it, you go out and get it, right?" he said, feeling his heart pummeling the inside of his chest, his cock thickening up stupidly hard.

"Jesus," she gasped, pressing herself up against his hardness, her eyes flicking back and forth between his, trying to understand how her husband could be so turned on just then.

"Say it," he insisted. "Say it."

She gulped. Nodded. Looked him in the eyes and said, "If I need it, I'll go out and get it."

"And you'll do it safely?"

"I'll do it safely."

"And you'll tell me everything."

"I'll tell you everything."

For a moment she put her hand onto his hard cock and stroked it. Right there outside airport security. Then she looked into his eyes and giggled. "Most husbands wouldn't be urging their wives to go out and sleep with other people right about now," she said.

Julian shrugged. "Most husbands don't have sexy wives in rock bands going on tour," he said.

She flung her arms around him again and kissed him deeply. Then a mere whisper, “Goodbye. I love you so much...”

And she stepped back away from him, and he could see her face scrunching up a little as she fought back the tears. That didn’t help Julian. He tried to focus on how beautiful she was. Her t-shirt was riding up a little, exposing a hint of her stunning midriff beneath. Her jeans were so tight, it was close to cameltoe territory. If she sat next to a guy on the flight, he felt certain the guy would fly the whole way with a massive erection.

They smiled at each other, their insides hurting. A little wave, and then she was gone.

*

He was surprised by just how much fear he experienced on the way back from the airport. It was just about enough to get him to pull over the car halfway back to home just so he could breathe. He sat there gasping.

Had he really just told his wife she could sleep with whoever she wanted? And let her go off flying across to the other side of the country?

Part of him felt like he’d been a complete idiot. Sure, Kat had been wild during her band days before, but she hadn’t been married to him back then. What made him think she wasn’t going to just run off and end their marriage after tasting that freedom again? It wasn’t as though they had something like kids to keep them committed. Marriage—well, it was just a piece of paper, wasn’t it?

And yet all the while he felt the fear overwhelming him, he also sat there in the front of his car with a colossal erection stowed in his pants.

His wife was going away to perform in front of thousands of people, dressing up sexy as hell, thrashing the hell out of a guitar, which made her horny enough when she was doing it in the privacy of their own attic room, let alone in front of all those people...

Maybe she would be able to deal with her lust on her own, or in FaceTime calls with him, as she maintained she could. But a big part of him was hoping she really couldn’t. To the perverted side of his brain, the one thing that could make his pretty wife hotter still was if she turned into some kind of adulterous goddess.

Julian had to breathe deeply and accept that he was probably a little unhinged.

Kat would do what she had to do. He knew she'd be responsible. He tried to see their immediate future as win-win. If she coped without being unfaithful, then... he'd just see how strong she was, and how strong her commitment to their marriage was. And if she needed to sleep with someone else... well, if she shared the details with him, it would make their marriage stronger, Julian was sure of it.

*

Waiting, that was what most of the tour would be for him. Waiting. Oh, he could focus on work, sure. Taking things home from the office to tide him over in the evenings, if he had to, even. But it was all still waiting. Waiting for the West Coast to get up in the morning. Waiting for Kat to text him good morning, to send him a photo looking out of her hotel room, to let him know what her day was going to be like. Waiting for her to reply to his texts, waiting for her rehearsal to be over. Waiting for her to have supper, waiting to find out if she was doing anything in the evening. Waiting to see how her night out went.

Waiting to see if she ended up with anyone else in her bed.

The first two weeks the band would be in LA, and their plans were for a fairly rigorous period of rehearsal. Then, the tour would start properly. Julian was going to fly down there to see the first concert and see them off on the road, though he wouldn't be staying more than the weekend, since he had to get back to work.

That was the plan, anyway. Till then he just had to wait for everything to kick off and fall into place.

After her flight into LA, he had nothing but a quick sleepy call with Kat, and then some text messages. The next morning the band went straight into rehearsals. Then it was dinner in the evening. With the time difference, he had to wait until 2am to see her, and that was even with her getting to bed relatively early.

But then, there she was on his computer screen, looking absolutely gorgeous. God, he missed her. She seemed to be dressed down, wearing a thin bath robe, maybe a kimono.

“Hey honey, how are you?”

“Good... sorry it's so late...”

“Oh, no problem.”

“I’ve missed you so much.” Sitting on the couch in the living room, Julian had his laptop perched on the coffee table. Kat looked so pretty on his screen, he could hardly believe it, even though she did seem a little tired.

“I’ve been missing you, too,” he said, his words feeling clumsy, like he couldn’t express himself well, now she was actually calling him in person. “How’s it been going?”

“Oh, good,” she said, so smiley, so upbeat. “We had such a great first rehearsal—it’s like we never even split up. And then dinner...”

“Dinner was good?”

“It was pretty great... but I was missing you. And I couldn’t wait to get back to call you.”

He leaned back, smiling, content that he meant so much to her. “Well, I’ve just been waiting around,” he said. “My whole life now seems to revolve around waiting to see you again, sweetie.”

She smiled and swept her hair out of her face. But Julian sensed something awkward in her manner. Something she wanted to say that was difficult for her to get out.

“You’re on your own, right?” she asked me.

“Uh-huh. Of course.”

“‘Cause you know... doing the whole long-distance thing...”

“Yeah?”

“It’s important to... you know... turn each other on... right?” she said. “Regularly.”

“Of course—very important.”

“Okay...” she gulped. “So... one of us has to get the ball rolling, right? If we’re going to survive...”

He was a touch confused. Only later, after the call, would he realize that actually, she was just horny as hell, really distractedly so, only things seemed too awkward between them to do anything about it at first, because... well, because they’d just never done anything like it before.

It was funny how hard it was to start something as intimate as this, even though they’d been together for so long. They just didn’t do it before via computers.

“I... uh... yeah...” he stammered, not sure quite how to do this.

“Okay, honey,” she said, seeming to take a deep breath. “I want you to unzip your pants for me.”

The resolute tone in her voice was enough to start him thickening up. He did as she asked.

“Put your hands on your... your cock,” she said. He did what she told him, placing his hands on the thickening bulge in his undershorts.

Kat leaned back in her chair, her hands moving to her breasts, her bathrobe falling a little open, and then a lot open.

“I missed you so much, honey,” she said, exposing her gorgeous breasts to him, cupping them in her hands, fondling them.

“I missed you, too,” he said, feeling like he had a frog in his throat.

“Show it to me,” she said in a low voice. “Show me your cock.”

He slipped his cock out of the fly of his undershorts, allowing it to stand straight up for her.

“Oh God...” she said, moaning as she massaged her breasts. “I miss it too much... squeeze it for me, will you? Hold it tight...”

He did as she asked, and on his screen, Kat stood up to show him her bare chest, her flat stomach, her bare midriff, her little white panties and all that smooth, golden skin. She turned slowly and slipped off her kimono.

“Oh honey... you look so good,” he said, not really knowing what to say.

“Thank you,” she said, turning back to face him, but sitting again before he could see anything below her waist. She brushed her hair out of her face again, and told him, “keep your hand on your cock, honey. I want to watch you stroking it...”

He did as she asked, glancing at the little window FaceTime provided to show him what his camera was showing her. From this angle, it was pretty flattering to his size. But she really was getting him seriously hard.

“God, you have a beautiful cock,” she said. The dirty words sounding strange, but wonderfully hot coming out of her mouth. “I miss the way it feels... the way it tastes...”

She closed her eyes and sighed, and it seemed at least one of her hands was in between her thighs right now, even though he could see only her chest, her pert breasts, those stiff little nipples, and upwards.

“...I miss the way you feel in my pussy...” she moaned. “Oh honey... imagine you’re kissing my breasts right now... you’re licking my nipples... oh that feels so good...”

She giggled, a touch self-conscious about what they were doing, but deliciously so. She brushed her hair out of her face again before putting her

hands behind her head to offer him a superb view of her breasts.

“I love kissing your breasts, honey,” he said, trying to keep up.
“Sucking on your nipples...”

“Keep stroking your cock for me,” she said, closing her eyes briefly as she sighed, “You’re making me so wet...”

He chuckled, “I think your rehearsal made you wet, honey.”

“Don’t even joke about that,” she smiled, “I think... the prospect of a tour... well, it’s really got me going, honey.”

“How did you feel after the rehearsal today?” He asked her.

“Just... oh God, I was ready to fuck my microphone stand, or something...” she leaned in to move the camera, said, “hey, check this out, sweetie...”

She moved the camera down so he could no longer see her face. But he could see her stomach... then the top of her white panties, which she pushed down so he could almost see a hint of her pussy. She stuffed her hand between her legs, stirring it up against her sex, moaning as she did so, and when she sat back slightly so that he could see more of her panties, he could see a huge wet patch across most of the crotch.

“You know how horny I get,” she tilted her head and he was able to see her face on camera as well as everything else.

“Oh yes, honey,” he said, slowly stroking his cock so that he wasn’t going to immediately burst.

“But this was like... you know... Jesus, we’re doing a whole new tour! So exciting...” She sat back in the chair now, and Julian could see her from forehead to thighs, her panties hiding her pussy but her hand moving over it to the point where it was clear what she was doing.

“Oh...” she groaned.

“So if you’re that horny in rehearsals,” he said, “how are you going to cope when the shows start?”

Sure, sure, he remembered what they’d talked about easily enough. They’d discussed her freedom to essentially fuck whoever she wanted. But since she’d landed in LA, she’d seemed to talk like she wanted to try holding onto monogamy if possible. And anyway, he wanted to hear her say it. He wanted her to talk about the possibility of her cheating.

“I know I can call you,” she smiled sweetly, and lifted up her knees, her feet resting on the table on which her laptop was sitting. Her panties rode up her thighs closer to her knees as she reached around her legs to

continue touching herself. "I know I can come see your beautiful cock. And you'll stroke it for me and get all hard..." she sighed, "Oh God, I'm so wet for you..."

She peeled off her panties the rest of the way and then opened her legs so he could see her beautiful pussy, all shaven startlingly bare, glistening with her juices.

She had something in her hands now, something purple. He asked her, "What's that?"

"Oh this?" she grinned. "Something new. Maybe even a secret weapon to help me through."

She held it up to show him. A vibrator, but a fairly sophisticated looking one. He felt strangely deflated to see it, though it was kind of sexy in her hand. It seemed to him this was her opting out of their little agreement.

"I wish it was your tongue here instead," she said, stroking her dark pussy lips.

"Me too, honey," he said, feeling his cock softening slightly in his grip. "I love going down on you..."

"And your cock..." she moaned, "sliding into me..."

Perhaps she noticed his cock soften slightly. She seemed slightly confused for a moment, though she hid it well. He increased the speed of his stroking to boost his stiffness, and with her on his screen like that, legs spread, twirling little circles over her pussy with her fingers, he was soon fully hard again.

But she'd noticed that moment, he was sure of it. The moment of disappointment.

"Oh fuck... oh fuck..." she yelped quietly, her body seeming to tense up as her middle finger and forefinger focused on the most sensitive parts of her pussy. She needed release, badly, and staring at her husband's thick cock was going to take her there, along with her expert fingers.

"Oh God, I'm coming..." her body trembled, as though someone had attached electrodes to her skin, shot her with a low voltage.

He was beating his pole harder, wondering if she meant this to be it, the conclusion to their call, but she was crying out, "no, honey... not yet... don't come... I need longer with you..."

She calmed down a little, and brought the vibrator up to her mouth so she could lick its rounded head. It wasn't exactly a realistic dildo, but the

way she licked it made him perk up. It looked enough like her licking some other guy's cock.

"You like that?" she grinned, licking it some more just for effect.

He smiled, and for a moment held up his hard cock for her to see better.

"Where did you get it?" He asked her.

"Oh, online. You can shop very discreetly nowadays," she smiled, sliding the thing over her pussy, switching it on so he could hear it humming quietly. "Uh..." she moaned, "I just wish it was your cock... sliding into my wet pussy..."

He said, "You know, you don't need to use a vibrator to get through the tour."

"No... uh... uh..." she cried, the vibrator doing quick work.

"You know what we talked about," he said, feeling the need to steer things, since she wasn't.

"I know... honey..." she said, panting a little. "It's just... now I'm out here... it seems so strange..."

"Strange?"

"You know... being away from you... and thinking maybe I could actually... you know... see someone else..." she moaned again, long and loud. The vibrator was a shortcut to another climax. "Oh God I'm coming..." She panted a little more and then... switched off the vibrator.

Hot, but... somehow... missing something.

"Fuck!" she giggled, dropping the vibrator. She continued gently touching herself a little as she recovered her breath.

"That did feel good," she beamed.

Then she paused, looked at his soft cock—which he wasn't exactly doing much to conceal from her.

"Wait, did you come, honey?" she asked him.

He felt so weird. It had been hot watching his wife strip, watching her touching herself, watching her make herself come. But they'd come to the end of the road and here it was.

"Uh... I didn't..." he admitted, then added, "Tired, I guess."

Was this vibrator really going to keep her honest on the whole tour? It seemed simpler, and at least part of him felt it was probably a good idea, and ultimately better for their marriage. But if he thought about it, that was the lazy part of him, the part that didn't want to put in any effort, that would

be happy with sitting back and letting Kat handle the hard work of staying away from temptation so that they would never face whether they could cope with her infidelity.

But there was another part of him—what felt like a big part of him—that wanted to take risks. That part of him wanted to roll the dice and see how much fun they could have if... that part was disappointed.

“Josie already has a new boyfriend,” she said, still gently touching herself. “The lead singer from one of our supporting bands.”

“Uh-huh?” Julian said.

“Yeah,” Kat giggled. “And George only lives two hours away. I guess they really do like it that way.”

“Has George... been around?” he asked her.

“Uh... yeah, I guess. He brought us lunch today.”

“So he knows about her new boyfriend?”

Kat nodded. “Yeah, Josie tells him everything. And when he was here today... the way he looks at her...”

“He loves her, right?”

“He adores her. He worships her.”

Julian felt tired, felt like they would probably wrap up the call very soon, and it would end on some kind of a disappointed note. He’d then have to go take care of himself, because even if he was currently soft, he still felt the tension of an unrealized orgasm.

He casually said, “And there’s no one you like the look of in your support bands?”

She shrugged, and sitting up in front of the camera, he saw her blush. “I don’t know...” she said. “They’re all nice guys...”

“Have you seen much of them so far?” he asked her, feeling a little tickle in his loins at just how Kat had blushed at his question.

“Only a little,” she said, pulling her kimono closed. Acting all self-conscious. It only intrigued him more. “We’ve all been rehearsing in the same building... so we kind of run into each other between songs, you know. Lunch time.”

“You seen them play?”

She smiled, “Sure. I mean, I’ve seen them before. One of the bands toured with us once before... the other... well, they’re too young, weren’t around back then... but I’ve seen them on the Internet.”

“You get to watch them rehearse?”

“A little. I snuck in to see one of them for ten minutes today.”

“The older band or the younger band?”

“The younger band.”

“You like them? Maybe one of them in particular?”

It was like some kind of inquisition, but she was blushing, and it made him certain she did, perhaps, like someone from one of the other bands.

She'd been looking away, avoiding seeing him as he questioned her, but now her gaze returned to her screen, and he heard her catch her breath. She said, “I thought you were tired, honey?”

He was gently jacking his cock again—and he was hard, hard as a rock. “I thought so too,” he said. Then he pushed further, “I’m right, aren’t I? There’s someone you like. Already.”

Her blush intensified a little, and she shifted awkwardly in her chair—but as she watched that stiff cock in his hands, one of her eyebrows rose slightly, and there was a glint in her eyes.

Cautiously, she said, “They’re all kinda cute... but today... I guess I ran into their drummer in the hallway and... well, spilled my drink all over his t-shirt... and he was so nice about it...just took off his t-shirt...”

“What’s his name?” Julian asked, continuing to tug on his shaft right where she could see it.

“Uh... Daryl,” she said. He saw one of her arms drop between her legs, one of her hands sink between her thighs, though he couldn’t see what she was doing with it. “When I went to see them play, he gave me a little wave...”

“You think he’s hot?”

For a moment, Kat seemed lost in a world of her own—watching her husband’s huge cock throbbing in his hands, harder than ever. Touching herself again while she watched him.

“Uh... yeah... I guess...” she said, dazed.

“You should talk to him some more,” Julian said. “Maybe see if he’d fancy dinner one evening...”

“You’re so hard, honey,” she said in little more than an awed whisper.

“You saw him taking off his t-shirt?” he asked her.

“Huh?”

“When you spilled drink all over him.”

“Uh... yeah...”

“You liked it when he took his t-shirt off?” he asked.

“Uh... yeah...” she seemed to snap out of it just then. Asked, “Are you gonna... come... honey?”

“I’m close,” he said.

A touch bewildered, she said, “It turns you on that... maybe... I have the tiniest little crush on one of the guys in one of the other bands?”

“Of course. Haven’t we already talked about this kind of thing?” he joked.

“And you want me to... have dinner with the guy?” she seemed almost nervous, frightened.

“Only if you wanted to,” he said. “Maybe you guys would... you know... have fun.”

“And it really wouldn’t make you feel bad... jealous... if I had dinner with the guy?”

“No, honey,” Julian said a touch firmly. “And if you wanted to go back to your room with him... or to his room... you know... for a drink or two...”

She gave a nervous smile. “I hardly know him very well.”

“That’s okay. You have time to kill, right? In the evenings?”

“Uh-huh.” She was transfixed to his enormous erection. He kind of liked it.

“I’m only saying, honey,” he said. “You might have some fun.”

“Yes,” she said. “I guess I might.”

And with that, he came. Kat seemed surprised, but happy her husband had come too, at last.

“You know,” she said after a few moments, “it’s all... a little strange... you know, knowing that you’re happy for me to... well... do whatever I like.”

“Strange for me, too, honey,” Julian smiled as he wiped himself off. “But I guess everything’s going to be a little strange since I’m married to a rock goddess.”

Chapter Eight

Kat felt a little strange the next day. Rehearsals went fine—better than fine, actually—the girls were impressed and she felt pretty good... except... kind of... giddy.

To start the day, she felt that lingering glow she always did after having satisfying sex the night before. It amused her no end, because she'd really never felt that way after mere masturbation. There was definitely something more to it when Julian was involved. Part of her pleasure had been in seeing him turned on—and when he had eventually come, and he'd been so hard for her... well, that was very satisfying, beyond simply enjoying her own self-induced orgasms.

But the last part of her call to her husband the previous night had stayed with her all night and into the next morning. She couldn't stop thinking about it. How stunning his cock had looked, all bulging and throbbing like she swore she'd never really seen it before.

And was all that really from the thought of her flirting with another man? It seemed crazy.

More than anything said in conversation, though, seeing him like that had made her feel deep inside that Julian wasn't simply trying to be nice to her in telling her she was free to fool around on tour. He wasn't just being a pragmatist facing the realities of a long-distance relationship. It seemed to really turn him on. Initially, it had even shocked her, despite what they'd talked about so much before she'd flown out to LA.

He really did want her to be unfaithful, it seemed.

And that thought, that knowledge, led to her feeling like this.

Giddy. Light-headed. Walking on air.

And it really flared up when they walked into the rehearsal building down on North Colorado Drive, and they all walked past the open door to see Blue Tonic already rehearsing. Those boys got going early. They all walked past the door and as Kat walked by, she instantly caught sight of Daryl on the drums, and her heart just about felt like busting out of her chest.

“You are on fire, girl!” Josie exclaimed as they wrapped up Cloaking Myself In You, during which Kat completely nailed her guitar solo. “Did you go out and get laid last night?”

Kat laughed, “Almost. FaceTime with hubby.”

Josie had raised her eyebrows at that. “Wow,” she said. “Well... maybe you will be all right on this tour... you know... without a little strange.”

Kat had shrugged at that, but had just picked up her guitar to get ready for the next track on their list. She’d felt the eyes of the rest of the band taking her in, Renee and Alyssa wondering what Josie was referring to. As wild as things had been back in the day, she just hadn’t talked about the issue of sex on tour with anyone but Josie. Not yet. She didn’t even know where Renee or Alyssa stood on the subject of their own monogamy with husbands back home.

Then during their break, she’d run into Daryl again in the hallway.

“Hey,” he’d said, stepping out of the way so that she could get past.

“Hey,” she’d smiled, feeling her insides melting like butter on a hot stove. “How’s it going?”

He’d smiled, and she felt like swooning for the first time in a long time. “Pretty good,” he said, “but then... we haven’t taken a ten-year break. How’s it going for you guys?”

She leaned casually against the wall, trying not to think about the fact that she could smell a gentle hint of his sweat along with a suggestion of some cologne or other from a while ago. Trying not to glance down to see whether there were any signs of a decent bulge in his black jeans.

“You know, it’s like we were never away,” she said. “Everything’s just picking up just where we left it.”

“That’s terrific,” he nodded, and she saw how incredibly blue his eyes were. “I can’t wait to come hear you guys.”

“Any time,” she grinned. “You know where we are.”

A little sigh. “Our manager has us working nonstop right now.”

“You don’t need it, you sound amazing.”

“David’s... a little paranoid. We never did a tour like this before—not such large venues. I think he thinks this could be our big break, and if we fluff it—”

“You won’t fluff it.”

“Well... next time I have a break, I’ll drop by,” he promised.

“I’ll look forward to it.”

She stepped past him, and his scent wafted into her chest, and she had to actively remember to keep walking, putting one foot in front of the other. Wow. She was going to have to change her underwear—and it wasn't even the fact that she'd been playing guitar.

On the way back to their rehearsal room, she Googled Daryl on her phone. 28 years old, five years younger. That wasn't so bad, was it?

Then she checked herself—my God, was she really Googling a possible fuck buddy? This was getting bizarre. And potentially serious.

Fuck buddy. The word didn't seem right. It wasn't that she wasn't thinking about fucking him—of course she was. Couldn't get it out of her head now that she felt confident that Julian would be supportive, even appreciative. It was just that to her, the term fuck buddy seemed to mean some guy you just kind of fucked occasionally, if you didn't have someone better, some guy who didn't really light your world on fire, but fulfilled a need when you were desperate. She'd had guys like that in college; she'd had guys like that on tour before.

This was a crush, damn it. Felt like every molecule in her body was crying out for him—and she'd only just met him. Would Julian be as supportive if he knew she felt this way about Daryl? He hadn't said anything about who she could, or could not, sleep with. Or how involved she could be. Just that she was free.

When Kat got back, Josie was hanging out with the lead singer of Blue Tonic—Billy Madden—and didn't seem to care if anyone saw her leaning in to kiss his lips. Everyone knew that George let her do it. The girls knew that George liked her doing it, too. Odd to think that Julian might be like that, too.

"He's perfect for you," Josie said as Kat walked around her trying not to react to her and her new boyfriend.

"Huh?"

"Your beautiful drummer boy. Daryl." Kat turned sharply as their lead singer seemed to read her mind.

"What?" Josie laughed, "Renee just said you were talking with him in the hallway."

Kat shrugged. "He's friendly enough."

"You two look good together."

She'd given her bandmate an eye roll at that, before taking her place to resume the rehearsal. But part of her was feeling jubilant that Josie

approved of the potential match. What a weird sentiment that was.

It struck her why it all felt quite so strange about halfway through their rehearsal on the next song, *Take It Away From Me*. It was that she hadn't felt this way since before Julian had come along. Since before anyone in college. The last time she'd had a crush like this, the last time she'd felt all giddy and light-headed about a guy had been way back in high school, for crying out loud.

She felt like a goddamn schoolgirl again.

The more she thought about it, the more she realized it was true. She'd had crushes on guys at school all the time, and then a really huge one on Chris Montgomery, who had actually become her first proper boyfriend. It had taken ages for her to get up the nerve just to go up and talk to him, and then almost the moment she did, and he figured she might be into him, he had asked her out.

Despite the horror stories about losing your virginity, when she'd finally gone all the way with Chris, it had just about blown her mind. Her crush had fueled her desire for him, and then when he actually touched her, when she saw how hard she made him, and when he had entered her, it had all spiraled into one almighty atom bomb of an orgasm.

And this crush that she had on Daryl felt just like that one had.

Now that she thought about it, she really hadn't had a proper crush since high school, either. In college, in the band... she'd vaguely fancied someone, and had been able to get them if she wanted. Julian... well, he had been the nearest it came to a crush since high school. She'd always felt strongly about him, but if she was honest, never quite like this.

She'd been with Julian so long, maybe sleeping with another man would actually be like losing her virginity all over again. Intense. Atomic.

*

Later, virtually at the end of the day, they were wading through the Garbage-like track *Run Around on You*, and Kat was really getting into it. She glanced up to see Daryl standing there at the back, arms folded, quietly nodding his head to the beat as though he thought it was the coolest thing since Nirvana.

Well, if Kat got horny when she played the guitar, and got even more horny when she played in public, on stage or wherever... playing in front of

Daryl made her just about come right there behind her mic stand.

She had to try to keep her eyes away from him while she played for fear of tripping up on some of the more intricate parts—though she couldn't stop from glancing over again and again, just to see if he was still there. He caught her gaze a few times and smiled, and she felt her pussy tingle in response.

At the end of the song, Daryl was applauding, but after she gave him a playful bow, he frowned and pointed to his watch, then gave the palms-up universal signal of exasperation or what-can-you-do? She nodded and smiled, and he had to scamper off.

When he was gone, she realized all her bandmates were staring at her in silence. When they saw her realizing it, they all burst into laughter.

"You two are adorable," Renee said.

"What are you talking about?" Kat snapped, but found herself blushing fiercely.

"You don't need to worry about us," Alyssa said. "You know we have your back."

"What goes on tour stays on tour, right?" Renee grinned.

Josie just folded her arms and nodded, giving Kat an I-told-you-so look.

"I'm married," Kat said quietly.

"I'm married," Josie said.

"You're married to George," Kat pointed out.

"And it seems to me that Julian is wonderfully similar to my George in many respects."

Well, there was no point in trying to keep things from Renee or Alyssa. A band on tour was no place for secrets.

Kat said, "I don't know that for sure."

"Yet," said Josie.

Kat merely shrugged then slouched out of the rehearsal room. It wasn't quite a storm-out, but might have been seen that way by her band mates. She still felt horny, she still felt giddy when she thought about Daryl. But she also felt the gloom of uncertainty when it came to Julian. Sure, he got super hard when they talked about her being unfaithful, but did that really translate to him being okay with adultery in real life? What if his little kinky thing was just that, a little kinky thing. And when it came to her seeing other guys in real life, it shattered their relationship?

No tour—or crush—was worth that.

*

Kat got back to her room and stripped off to take a shower. She relaxed under the flow of the hot water, enjoying the luxury surroundings of a five star hotel en suite. Her mood softened regarding her bandmates' apparent interest in her potential adultery—but then she started wondering if she might have offended Josie, and maybe even Alyssa and Renee.

Now she was nervous about that.

Stepping out of the shower, she wrapped herself in a big white hotel bathrobe and heard a quiet knocking at her door. She went to look through the peephole and saw Renee standing outside.

"Hey," she said, smiling, as Kat opened the door.

"Hey, Renee."

"I just... wanted to make sure you're all right."

Kat smiled to show that she was. "I'm... I'm really sorry I was grouchy with you guys."

Renee shrugged, "It's okay. You know how Josie is. She likes to pry. And she likes to manipulate. She doesn't do it to be mean."

"I know that."

"She just... well, she wants you to be as happy as George apparently makes her."

Kat nodded, and took a moment before realizing she had Renee standing out in the hallway. "Hey, you want to come in?" she said, stepping back to invite her in. "I... I think I was just going to order some room service for tonight."

"I love room service," Renee beamed. "Want some company?"

Kat paused a moment, her natural instinct to apologize and say she felt like an evening on her own, that maybe she would have to call her husband soon so that it wouldn't be so late for him... but then she changed her mind. Perhaps she needed to spend a little time with her bandmates in order to get comfortable with this tour.

"Sure." She smiled. "Sounds good."

Renee ordered them burgers and ice cream on room service while Kat put PJs on, and then the two of them watched *The Notebook* on TV.

"I'm gonna have to call my husband soon," Kat warned as the credits rolled, hating to end their evening together.

"Oh, you want me to go?" Renee asked her.

Kat shrugged. "Not really," she said, even though she'd been looking forward to another sexual encounter via FaceTime with Julian all day. Particularly the way Daryl had made her feel.

"I can stay if you like... or I can go, and then come back when you're done..." The tone of Renee's voice suggested she knew exactly what Kat needed from her FaceTime call with Julian.

Kat sighed. "How are you coping with it?" she asked her bandmate. "With being apart from Nate for so long, I mean?"

Nate was Renee's husband. Renee chuckled, and raised an eyebrow. "I have the most amazing vibrator," she said. Then, "To be honest, the way things have been going with Nate... it's not much different than normal."

Kat frowned. "Oh, I'm sorry."

Renee shrugged. "It's okay. Some people just... you know... don't have sex quite so much once they're married."

"Did you guys talk at all... about how things would be on the tour?"

"Not really. I mean, Nate's not like George... or Julian... apparently."

Kat sighed, and Renee added immediately, "Hey, I'm sorry, I didn't mean to... it's your business..."

"No," Kat said. "It's okay. I should talk about it with someone. Josie seems... biased. Like, she's desperate for me to cheat on Julian, to treat Julian the way she treats George."

"And how are things with your husband?"

Kat said, "Well he says he likes the idea of me... you know... having the freedom to see other people on tour."

"But you don't believe him?"

Kat shook her head. "I don't know... I *do* believe him. Yesterday as we were talking about it... well, let's just say I saw definitive physical proof that he likes the idea..."

Renee giggled. "Okay, well that sounds promising..."

Kat said, "I just... it's so weird, you know? Everything we're taught about dealing with guys... they get jealous at the drop of a hat... when you even look in the direction of another guy..."

"Nate does..."

“...They don’t get unbelievably hard when you talk to them about maybe liking the drummer from one of the other bands...”

Now Renee laughed loudly. “Seriously? You are sooo lucky, girl!”

Kat smiled. “I just don’t want to... you know... go for it, only to find that Julian really only felt that way about it as a fantasy, not real life.”

Renee was fetching drinks from the minibar. She handed a gin and tonic to Kat, while sitting back down with a rum and coke for herself. She said, “You worry too much. If he’s said you can... you should try it. And it’s his fault if he can’t handle it.”

Kat shook her head. “I just think he might suddenly turn around and accuse me of wanting Daryl all along. Wanting to cheat on him all along. Like it was all my idea, not his, this cheating thing.”

“I don’t think Julian’s like that, though, is he? I mean, from what I know...”

Kat sighed again. “No, I know he isn’t.”

Renee sipped her drink. “So just take baby steps,” she said.

“What?”

“Yeah... you don’t have to sleep with Daryl right away, huh? I mean, just take things slow. Dinner one night. Maybe a little... making out... the next night... maybe you give him a hand job the next night... and each time you tell Julian exactly what’s been going on.”

Kat sipped her gin and tonic, mulling over what Renee suggested. She had to admit, it seemed like a good strategy. “I guess... I’m just used to the way it was on tour,” she grinned. “You know... you like a guy... you wait until the next time everyone’s drunk... and then you jump him.”

“Maybe things are different nowadays,” Renee laughed.

Kat did feel some of the worry melting away. Why hadn’t she thought of a go-slow approach?

“You do like him, then?” Renee asked her. “The drummer guy.”

Kat glanced at the door as though she was worried someone was going to burst in and overhear. Then she flashed Renee a wicked grin, saying, “Jesus, it’s like I’m in school and I have a secret crush on some guy in the year below.”

“Scandalous!” Renee beamed, apparently feeling happy that her bandmate really did have a crush on someone “He *is* a hottie.”

“He’s also five years younger than me,” Kat pointed out.

“Five years! Seriously, that’s nothing. Ashton Kutcher was 15 years younger than Demi Moore. And don’t get me started on male celebrities dating younger women...”

“Yeah, I suppose...” Kat grinned. “You know... I think of high school... and if I was a senior, he’d still be in middle school.”

Renee cackled. “We’re not in school any more.”

Kat said, “Seriously... the last time I had a crush on anybody... like this one... I was in high school.”

That only made Renee laugh even more.

“You think Julian would feel bad about me... having a crush like that?” she asked her bandmate.

Renee shrugged, and went up to get them more drinks. “You know, we’re gonna have to order some more booze from room service. This minibar is not well stocked,” she said. Then, “It’s only a crush, right? I mean... it’s not like you’re in love with the guy.”

“No, definitely not.”

Renee smiled warmly, “You’ve just... been given complete freedom by your husband, and you’re not used to wanting a guy so badly and being actually allowed to have him.”

“I suppose that’s it.” Kat felt herself tingling again, merely thinking about Daryl. It made her feel even more so with Renee telling her she was ‘allowed’ to have him.

“It’s exciting!” Renee declared. “You’re just not used to that kind of excitement... as good as things are with Julian, you guys have been married for years.”

“I guess so.”

Renee picked up the phone from Kat’s bedside table and placed an order for Champagne. “We’re celebrating, right?” she giggled as she put the receiver down again.

“Celebrating what?”

“Your seriously hot new boyfriend!”

“He is *not* my boyfriend,” Kat laughed.

“Yet.”

Sitting by Kat’s bedside table, Renee opened the little drawer, only to find Kat’s vibrator sitting in there. Kat gasped and then blushed, but Renee wasn’t teasing her about it. “You have one too! Aren’t they terrific?” she said, pulling it out of the drawer.

It seemed more than a little strange, her bandmate handling the vibrator that had been inside Kat so much, particularly recently.

“I think I could probably cope with it, as long as Julian comes out to see me often enough,” Kat said. The alcohol was already getting to her. She kind of liked seeing Renee handling her vibrator for some reason. Probably some residual lust left over from Daryl and the day’s rehearsals.

“Hmm... well, I’ll be okay. I don’t think Nate’s planning on coming to see me very much.”

“Seriously?”

Renee shrugged. “Maybe he’ll have a change of heart, after a little while...”

“That’s terrible,” Kat said. “He expects you to have no sex life at all?” Somehow it seemed almost like a human rights issue—and yet it really was very unusual that Kat’s husband was letting her have a sex life while away from home, Nate’s attitude was much more conventional.

“Oh, I could probably have a little fun here and there... as long as it’s with a woman,” Renee said. There was a knock at the door, and she picked herself up to go answer it.

It was the Champagne. Renee closed the door again and then returned to pour them out a glass each.

“You would cheat on Nate if... it was with a woman?” Kat asked Renee, and signaled that she was still on her last gin and tonic, and didn’t need the bubbly just yet.

For some reason, Kat’s mind was drifting back to the time when Julian was shaving her pussy, and the two of them had talked about the possibility of her sleeping with Renee again.

Renee did look good. The band’s keyboardist had the classic porcelain skin that went with being a real redhead—and she was real, even if she did always jazz up her hair with luminous, almost neon, red dye—and it always made her seem fresh-faced and ten years younger than she was. Kat thought she’d find it hard to tell the difference between Renee now and the Renee who had last taken the stage with The Ponytails, even if you could compare the two directly.

“Nate doesn’t consider it cheating if it’s with a woman,” she said, coming over with her Champagne. “He never has. Not that I’ve... well, made the most of it over the years...”

“And if you... sleep with a woman, you have to tell Nate all about it?” Kat asked her.

Renee stood there and shrugged. “He’s not really bothered. It’s not that he’s... you know... particularly turned on by the whole girl-on-girl thing. It’s just that... well, the way he explained it was that he doesn’t feel threatened by my being with other women.”

“He can’t imagine you leaving him for another woman?” Kat said wryly, gazing up at her bandmate, and maybe noticing that her nipples were just about visible, pushing against her faded white Led Zeppelin t-shirt.

“Far less marrying one,” Renee laughed.

“So... are you planning on making the most of Nate’s philosophy now you’re on tour?” Kat asked. It felt as though the alcohol gave her the nerve to pop what seemed to her to be a fairly personal question, since the two of them had seen little of each other for so long.

Renee sat down on the couch, purposefully close to Kat, her thighs wedging against Kat’s. “If I can find some willing babes to help me make the most of it,” she said, slinging an arm suggestively around Kat.

Kat felt her body temperature rise by a few degrees, with various wildfires igniting spontaneously inside her. She’d always preferred men, despite her experiences, but Renee was just plain sexy. She’d probably turn entirely straight girls.

“You know...” Kat said, draining her G&T, “Julian and I talked about the possibility of me... you know... being a willing babe for you, Ren.”

“Seriously?” Renee’s face lit up.

“You mean you’ve forgotten—”

“I thought... you know... you’re all married now...”

Kat smiled. She could smell Renee’s perfume, which was all coconut and lemons and not at all conventional, but with the booze streaming around her system, it kind of gave her a buzz. “You know Julian’s talked about letting me see other people on tour...”

“Other guys, sure,” Renee said. “I wasn’t sure about...”

“Well, I can’t say I’m sure about anything...”

Renee leaned in and brushed Kat’s hair out of her face, her hands moving to cradle her head. And then they were kissing, their lips pressing together, moving together, Kat sliding her hand around Renee’s jaw, feeling her oh-so-soft skin as her mouth filled with the sweetness of the other woman’s lips.

It was so soft, so tender, so cautious and yet so very, very sweet. Kat felt as though fireworks were going off all over her body, her heart beating so hard that perhaps it was going to bruise her chest.

Renee tucked a few rogue strands of her vibrant, scarlet hair behind her ear and sucked on Kat's lips as though she'd never kissed anyone sweeter. And for a while, time just seemed to slow to a halt.

"Wow," Renee said, finally, as they parted.

"I'd say so," Kat was blushing. Even with her Hispanic complexion, it was quite obvious, and becoming on her.

Both of them were breathless, their chests rising and falling as though they'd just been running the marathon.

Sure, Kat had spoken of such a possibility with Julian—but even so, she was just shocked by the reality. After so long dedicating herself only to one person, one man, it was startling. And even if she had had same-sex experiences before Julian—with the band, in college—it was just so different to what she was used to—and slightly terrifying.

"I... uh... was supposed to call Julian pretty soon," she said, not quite knowing what else to say. Not even quite knowing what she meant by telling Renee just then. Did she want to use it as an excuse to get Renee out of there? To give herself time to figure out just what she really wanted, and whether she wanted to go there with her bandmate.

Renee nodded, apparently accepting or understanding Kat's surprise. "You... want me to go?" she said.

"Uh..." Kat didn't even know herself.

"Really, it's no problem," Renee said. "I mean... you know... maybe I should get an early night, you know? Another hard day of rehearsals tomorrow..."

Renee pulled away from her on the couch, and Kat felt a throbbing tightness between her thighs. Desire. Longing. Craving.

She suddenly blurted out, "No. You should stay."

Not exactly an eloquent soliloquy laying out all her feelings, but it made Renee pause.

"Uh... sure."

Kat took a deep breath and tried again, "I want you to... stay with me... tonight... uh... if you wanted to... It's just... you know... my husband will expect me to..."

Renee smiled, but Kat detected a slight tremor in her body, and from the energy of her eyes could see that she was just as nervous about this. Well, neither of them wanted to mess up the internal relations within the band—and like Kat, it had apparently been a while since Renee had done anything with another woman.

“Of course,” she said. “You guys have to do your regular call... I could... step out onto the balcony while you guys talk?”

Renee picked herself up, and drew Kat’s eyes right along with her. Kat cleared her throat and felt herself just go with her impulses, not really thinking it through. “No,” she said. “No, I... you don’t have to go...”

“It’s no trouble... nice out on the balcony tonight...”

“You don’t have to go anywhere just because I’m calling Julian,” Kat said, and her thoughts began to catch up with her voice. “I... I mean, I don’t have any secrets from my husband...”

“Sure, of course,” Renee nodded, taking a tentative step back toward Kat and the couch.

“I mean... you know... I should tell him about... well... you know...”

“Our kiss?” Renee prompted her, and smiled as though she was just now reminded how hot that kiss had been.

Kat returned the smile, cautiously. “And if you did... you know... want to stay here... tonight...”

Renee chuckled. “You want to okay it with the hubby, of course.” She nodded, accepting the arrangement even though she didn’t have to. She could have demanded privacy if she was to do anything at all with Kat.

Kat leaned over to reach for the laptop, which sat on a small stack of magazines on the small side table beside the couch. She felt the butterflies stirring in her stomach. Was she really doing this? Calling Julian to tell him that perhaps she really was going to sleep with her bandmate after all, and before the tour even kicked off on earnest.

Was she really about to inform her husband that she was going to fuck another woman?

“You know,” Renee said, dropping back down onto the couch again as close as before, so that her left leg was jammed right up against Kat’s right, “maybe we could see how he responds to the sight of us... you know... fooling around a little... on FaceTime...”

Kat was finishing setting up the laptop on the coffee table in front of them, and now turned to gaze at Renee, somewhat aghast.

“You know... test him out a little,” Renee gave her a wicked grin. “You know, it might not be so hard on him... if you’re with another woman.”

Kat felt a surge of heat blooming inside her. It felt deliciously wicked to think of calling Julian with Renee, the two of them perhaps being a little naughty right in front of him. “I guess... we could...” she said, her heart rate picking up even more.

“And,” Renee said, “I could help you... you know... make sure he’s okay with... you know... you and Daryl...”

“Hmm... I guess so...” Kat said, hitting the mouse to request the call with Julian. “But if he seems in any way reluctant...”

“I know,” Renee grinned. “But I bet he isn’t.”

“I mean, maybe Daryl’s too... you know...” Kat didn’t quite know how to put the power of her crush on the Blue Tonic drummer into words.

“Too gorgeous? Too *completely* fucktastic?” Renee giggled. “You know, if he wants you to sleep with other guys, there’s no way he wants you to sleep with guys you don’t fancy.”

Kat tilted her head, Renee’s point seeming logical.

God, her pussy was just about on fire.

“Hello?”

And there was Julian on screen, looking adorable, the mere sight of him tugging her heart strings like crazy.

“Hey sweetie!” she said joyously. “I hope you don’t mind... I have some company tonight.”

“Hey Jules!”

“Hey Renee! How’s it going?”

Renee said, “Good... great, actually. But I hope you don’t mind... I think we have something to confess...”

Chapter Nine

So strange how anticipation became such a big part of the fun for Julian. Even if he wasn't physically with Kat, even if he wasn't even on the phone with her most of the time she was away, he was still thinking about her, because he was driven to imagine what she might be doing about that little crush of hers.

That was when it got really hot. When she revealed her little crush on Little Drummer Boy. Daryl. Well, he didn't need to disparage the guy, he was grateful Kat had a little thing for him. He actively hoped it would work out. He wanted Daryl to sleep with his wife.

She was so obviously taken with him. That call where he squeezed the guy's name out of her, where she admitted, yeah, she was thinking about him. Thinking about fucking him.

That was so hot.

And then Julian got to spend most of the next day imagining how Kat would be with Daryl. All coy and blushing and heart-fluttering whenever she saw him in the hallway, or when she went to listen to the guy's band rehearse. Or if Daryl went to hear The Ponytails.

He imagined Kat's excitement, her body's response to the teenage-style crush, and it seemed to translate directly into his own excitement. He got hard, for crying out loud, just thinking about Kat flirting with the guy.

It was like Christmas for kids: even if the presents turned out to be lame, the anticipation of the presents, the whole Christmas deal, was one hell of a ride.

Only with Kat, things weren't as predictable as the advent journey toward Our Lord And Savior's Birthday. Like when he spent all day dreaming of Kat being naughty with a younger man, a drummer, getting all wet from talking with him, from hoping so badly that he wanted her like she wanted him... and then at night when it came time to FaceTime with her, there was Kat... sitting next to her hot redhead of a bandmate, Renee, the two of them a little inebriated and, clearly, without a shadow of a doubt, horny as hell as they sat together on the end of Kat's bed.

He smiled, but inside he actually felt his stomach sink. He did well to hide his disappointment, though it seemed almost annoying that Kat would bring her bandmate with her for the evening's FaceTime call, thereby preventing another hot session, he thought.

But then Renee said, "I hope you don't mind... I think we have something to confess..."

And it did make his heart thump a little harder in his chest. Maybe something else was a little harder, too, down below. What had they done? Something significant? Had they fucked already? And if they had, was Renee really going to be here while Kat told him all about it? He'd never really considered the possibility that if Kat fooled around while off on tour, that she would tell her lovers about her need to tell her husband everything. Far less have one of them present when she did so.

"Okay," he said, trying to sound calm, and not like some horny adolescent. "What happened?"

"I'm kind of worried—"

"I kissed your—"

The two women spoke at once, over each other, and Julian couldn't understand either of them as a result—but before either of them said anything significant, both women realized they were talking about two different subjects.

"Okay... okay," Julian laughed, "One at a time, please."

The women were so smiley, it calmed him, reassured him a little that nothing bad had happened to prompt their need for confession.

"You first," Renee said to Kat, sliding a few inches back on the bed, almost off screen.

"No, you can go," Kat said.

"Your choice," Renee giggled. "Your husband."

"You tell him what you were going to say."

Renee slid back into place right next to Kat, her face blazing with excitement. "Just before we called you, I was making out with your wife in a major way," she blurted out, almost stumbling over her words to get them to him ASAP.

She sat back slightly, waiting for his response.

"Really..." he said, his hardness seeming to set as though he'd taken a little blue pill. "Wow."

Well, this was a positive turn. He almost couldn't believe it—up until this whole tour had materialized he'd never really considered that Kat might have a bisexual streak. And ever since he'd started fantasizing about his wife being with other people, it was really mainly about her being naughty with other guys. But Renee looked so delicious on screen right there in front of him, he was both envious of his wife and delighted that she might have done something a little naughty with her.

"You're not upset?" Kat said, looking suddenly more than a little worried.

"No..." he said, breaking out into a smile, his heart beat going all over the place. "No, sweetie, not at all. We talked about this, right?"

Renee said, "You see?"

Kat looked somewhat relieved, though Julian wasn't entirely sure why considering what they had talked about before her flight out.

"We did talk about it, honey, didn't we?" he asked her, for a moment or two half-suspecting perhaps he'd merely dreamt of talking about her fooling around with women like Renee. That they'd shaved Kat's pussy specifically because Kat remembered her bandmate's tastes.

"Uh... I guess so," she smiled sweetly but with a hint of nerves in her eyes. "I just... I just... you know, there's a difference between just talking about it and... you know... actually doing it."

Renee giggled. "You guys are so sweet."

They were both laughing now. Kat brushed her dark hair out of her face. She was apparently wearing PJs, while Renee was in a white t-shirt with faded writing on it, including what Julian thought might be a Led Zeppelin logo.

"You've got my permission to do what you like on tour," Julian said. "And I mean anything. I just... you know... want to hear about it if possible."

The two women looked at each other now, grinning wickedly. "You have the best husband in the world, you know that?"

Kat glanced back at the webcam and said, "Oh, I know that." Then she turned to Renee. "You don't have a problem with me... telling stuff to my husband, do you?"

Renee smirked. "Oh no, you can tell him whatever you like." The woman with the luminous red hair leaned in and Julian saw her hand snake gently around Kat's head. Kat was surprised, but going with it, leaning into

her bandmate, tilting her head slightly, their pert little noses touching gently against each other's cheeks, their lips coming lightly together.

There was even a little tongue going on that he could see, though their kiss was cautious, light, gentle.

Wow. His cock was trying to burst out of his pants. His wife was kissing a beautiful redhead right in front of him.

When the kiss was done, the two parted again and Kat brushed her hair out of her face, looking slightly bashful.

"You like that, hubby?" Renee grinned.

"Uh-huh," he said, again trying to keep calm, one hand subtly dropping between his legs, pressing against his bulge there.

The redhead turned to Kat. "I told you he'd be okay with it."

She leaned in again and the two women tenderly kissed once more, their eyes closing, their lips brushing against each other, pressing against each other, sucking gently on each other.

Julian saw his wife was blushing when the two women parted again, a trifle breathless this time.

He had no idea what to say. About this, about anything.

Renee broke the silence. "So... what were you gonna tell hubby?" she asked Kat.

"Huh?" Kat looked blank.

"Before. Sounded like you had... something different to confess."

Renee gave her a mischievous grin, feeling like she was forcing something out that maybe Kat wasn't totally sure of, though she'd been about to mention something in response to Renee's declaration that there was something for her to confess.

"Oh... uh..." Kat glanced uncertainly at her laptop and Julian.

Then Renee looked at Julian herself, and said, "You know your wife has a huge crush on one of the guys in one of our supporting bands, right?"

He noticed Kat giving her bandmate a sharp look, and Kat was blushing even more fiercely now.

"Sure," he told Renee, as though nothing was amiss at all, though it was fascinating to hear the keyboardist describe his wife's crush on Daryl as "huge". Actually made his hardness throb a little, though no doubt most husbands would be driven insane with jealousy. Then he asked Kat, "Did something happen today, honey? Did you ask him out?"

Renee grinned, as though Kat had kept it a secret that her husband had been actively encouraging her to ask the Blue Tonic drummer out on a damn date.

“Uh... no...” Kat said.

“He came to listen to her play today,” Renee reported. “It’s so obvious he wants her.”

“That’s great, honey,” Julian said, emphasizing his positivity.

“You see?” Renee chuckled, “Hubby is totally on board. You lucky thing.” Then she turned to Julian, said, “So Jules... are you the kind of guy who’ll just turn a blind eye to your wife...”

He was about to answer when Renee answered herself, saying, “Of course you’re not... you’ve already said you want to know everything that happens, right?”

“Uh-huh,” he said.

“The thought turns you on, right? Your wife having as little fun on the side...”

Again, Julian agreed. There was no point in hiding anything from her. She already knew most of it.

Renee put a hand on Kat’s thigh, and told her, “You know, it’s not uncommon. Especially when couples have been married a while. George knows loads of—”

“He’s not like George,” Kat insisted. There was something in her attitude toward George, Julian had noticed. She wasn’t keen on his dynamic with Josie.

“No,” Renee agreed, stroking Kat’s leg as though soothing her. “He’s nothing like George. You’re nothing like George and Josie.”

“No.”

“Josie cheats on George, because most of the time he doesn’t find out about it. Jules... well, he wants to know everything. Like... why are you so worried about Daryl? He’s a hottie.”

Kat glanced at Julian, and gave a little nod, as though admitting she needed to say something. She said, quietly, “I... I kind of like him, honey...”

Julian smiled, but inside the uncertainty was stirring up the butterflies in his stomach. “You’re supposed to... ‘kind of like’ them, sweetie,” he said. “There’s no point... you know... dating them if you don’t... right?”

She nodded, but didn't seem entirely convinced. "I know... but... I kind of... really like him."

Julian felt the butterflies in his stomach start trying to escape. Now here was where the whole risk of his little kink might turn dangerous: what if his wife fell head over heels for another guy? What if the guy couldn't accept her remaining with her husband, let alone telling her husband about their relationship? What if he lost his wife to another man?

"But it's... not like you're in love with him, are you?" Renee asked her.

"No, of course not," Kat said fairly decisively.

"So what's the problem?"

Kat sighed, "I don't know... I've never... really wanted someone like this... you know... since I met you, Jules."

Julian swallowed. "You think you might fall for him?" he asked her.

She shook her head. "No, it isn't like that..."

"You just really, really want to fuck him," Renee giggled. "And what is wrong with that?"

Julian gently stroked himself through his pants, feeling the anxiety subsiding again, the arousal swelling. He liked the idea of Kat really, really wanting someone. Desperate to fuck this other man.

"It's okay, honey," he said trying to put into words what he was feeling. "This isn't just about you... making sure you scratch an itch that needs scratching while you're on tour."

She looked at him, via her laptop, and as he spoke, it seemed to him that some new glint lit up in her dark eyes as she came to understand him more.

"I want you to have fun," he said, "but more than that... I like the idea of you having a... you know... amazing experience. Not limiting yourself... really... going for whatever opportunity presents itself..."

"God..." Renee said, quietly in awe.

"If you have a huge crush on this guy, then that's great—the only thing I ask is that you don't shut me out of your experience." Julian felt himself quoting something he'd read on one of the chat forums devoted to wife-sharing. It was something he'd been looking at, thanks to Google's search results, as he had increasingly been trying to understand his new urges.

"I won't shut you out," Kat promised. She looked well and truly stunned by what Julian had said. He kind of liked that.

“God damn,” Renee said. “Now I feel like I want to know all the details, too, when you bang the shit out of Daryl... so exciting...”

Kat smiled, a little more confidently, and brushed her hair out of her face again. Renee leaned over and pinched her PJ top about the waist, first with one hand and then both.

“This is cute,” she said.

“Thank you,” Kat replied.

“Why don’t you take it off?”

Kat looked at her bandmate, a little surprised.

Renee grinned. “You know what you’re supposed to do to keep a long-distance relationship healthy?”

“What?”

“A lot of phone sex... or FaceTime sex... or whatever the techies are calling it these days...” Renee giggled. “You know... everything I’m not doing with my husband every night.”

“It’s true,” Julian agreed.

“So come on,” Renee tugged on Kat’s PJ top. “Take it off.”

Julian felt a burst of warmth spreading from his loins. “You can take it off, honey,” he urged her, not knowing where Renee was taking this, but feeling that it was pretty hot, the idea of her stripping in front of another horny bisexual woman right there on his screen.

“Really?” Kat said, again giving Julian a mildly uncertain glance.

“Go ahead,” he said.

“Okay,” Kat laughed nervously, and as Renee reached forward to pull her top off, she put her arms up in the air to allow her bandmate to pull it off over her head.

“She’s not wearing a bra,” a clearly delighted Renee pointed out as she peeled the top off her bandmate to expose her bare breasts, and those stiff little dusky nipples.

“No,” Kat grinned, and once the top was off, nervously played with her hair, combing it back with her fingers so that it flowed down her back. They were both laughing as Renee leaned forward to cup and then gently stroke Kat’s breasts. Then she ducked down to kiss her, to suck on her nipples.

Julian just sat back, quietly amazed.

“This is what you’re supposed to do for a long-distance relationship?” Kat quipped as she allowed her bandmate to lick and suck on her nipples,

brushing Renee's hair out of the way to allow Julian to see everything going on.

"Of course," Renee agreed, lifting up in order to move over to Kat's other nipple. "It doesn't matter what kind of phone sex... as long as both husband and wife are involved..."

Kat turned to her screen to check on how Julian was taking all this, and Julian made sure to smile, and show her the bulge he was stowing in his pants. He shared an isn't-this-just-so-totally-crazy kind of a look with her, and then she turned back to Renee.

Sitting up, Renee suggested, "You wanna help me take my top off?" Then after a moment she seemed to remember where she was, since she added, "Oh... unless you didn't want your husband to see, of course..."

Kat laughed, "Oh, I don't mind if he sees you. I mean, fair's fair, right?"

Julian's eyes widened as his wife gave him another naughty little smirk before turning to the redhead, to reach for her waist and start peeling off her t-shirt. Renee had a pale purple bra on underneath, and after shedding her t-shirt, Kat reached around her bandmate to unfasten her bra, looking as though she was embracing the redhead.

This wasn't just his wife having a wicked secret encounter with her bandmate and then recounting some of the details to her husband afterward. She was stripping Renee off right in front of him. It seemed so unlikely.

Now Kat spread her hands all over Renee's breasts, fondling them, giggling a little as she did so in echo of how Renee had treated her.

"Doesn't it seem like a lifetime ago that we last did this kind of thing?" Renee said. "I mean, almost seems like a dream."

"The whole touring thing seems like a dream to me," Kat said, glancing up at the redhead, before ducking down to lick and kiss her pale breasts, and her little pink nipples. Renee glanced over at Julian and the webcam, and now it was her turn to hold Kat's hair out of the way so that he could see her sucking on Renee's tits.

"I think we were all drunk, like most of the time," Renee giggled.

"Or worse," Kat said, but Julian didn't really take in her insinuation.

He'd never really gone for lesbian porn before. He appreciated the beauty of naked women rolling around with each other, but he'd always preferred a guy to be involved, presumably because he could imagine he himself was taking part.

But here were two topless women fooling around, and it was so sensational to watch simply because one of the women was his wife.

He loved how much fun they were having. All the giggling, the laughter. Recapturing their pasts, like some x-rated college reunion. Renee knocking back another glass of Champagne as Kat re-familiarized herself with her breasts, giggling as she dribbled some of the Champagne down over her pale flesh so that Kat could lick it up from her cleavage.

“Are you okay with all this, honey?” Kat said after a while, sitting up again, facing him via the camera.

“Uh... of course,” he grinned. “You know... when we talked about you... sleeping with Renee... I wasn’t expecting... you know... to see it happening...”

Kat shrugged, “I didn’t think it would...”

Renee grinned and hugged her dark-haired bandmate, “Oh, it’s fun, isn’t it? Having hubby along for the ride... and you can finally let all that paranoia go that he doesn’t totally get off on you doing this...”

More tipsy laughter. Julian had noticed that the women were gently slurring some of their words. When had been the last time he’d gotten to see Kat drunk, properly drunk? It was fantastic. She was so smiley and giggly. And horny.

Renee said gently, “Lie back,” and Kat did as she was asked, laying back on the mattress. Renee reached for the waistband of Kat’s PJ pants, and started hauling them down over her hips. Julian watched his wife lift her behind to help the redhead remove the PJ pants, revealing a pair of fairly plain turquoise panties which had a little white bow in front.

“Cute,” Renee said, fiddling with the bow once Kat had cast off her PJ pants. “I like it.”

“Thank you,” Kat said.

“Stand up a minute?”

Kat did as Renee asked, standing before giving a little twirl for Julian to see fully appreciate her in those little panties. Thongs, no less. Not Kat’s usual mode of underwear, at least at home.

“You wear thongs when it’s just you going to sleep alone?” Renee asked her, tracing her hands delicately all over the curves of Kat’s behind as the brunette stifled more giggles.

“I do when I’m trying to impress my husband,” Kat grinned, turning back to face the camera.

“And are you impressed, hubby?” Renee asked him.

Julian chuckled, “Oh, yes.”

The way Kat was standing, the view was completely filled by her body, from navel to upper thighs. Then suddenly Renee whipped his wife’s underwear down, and there was her spectacular hairless pussy, right in front of the webcam.

He heard Renee catch her breath at the unveiling.

“You shaved it?” she said softly.

“My husband shaved it for me,” Kat said with almost a hint of pride as she stepped out of her panties.

“Because you’ll be wearing tight clothing on stage?” Renee asked her.

“Because he thought you’d like it,” Kat said. “And anyone else who gets to sleep with me on tour.”

Renee laughed gleefully. “You really do mean business, Jules! My God, it’s so... beautiful.”

Kat sat back on the mattress, and stroked Renee’s thigh. “It feels... kind of naughty,” she giggled. “And... you know when I am in those tight clothes for our shows? It really feels kinda hot when I’m wearing those...”

Renee laughed, “And you really thought you’d cope on this tour with only a vibrator?”

More slurps of Champagne, and then Julian watched Kat helping Renee to remove her jeans and pale purple panties. The redhead had a tidy bikini line, but otherwise she had a nice patch of coppery curls down there, showing that other than the luminous red dye, Renee was a natural redhead.

“Don’t I feel out of touch?” Renee grinned. “I guess I wasn’t really expecting much action on this tour....”

“Oh, I like it,” Kat said, stroking the soft ginger down.

Julian was just stunned. Hard to believe, but there was his wife, naked on a bed with another naked woman. Her wonderful golden skin contrasted with Renee’s pale complexion, her bright scarlet hair with Kat’s near-black locks.

“Can I touch it?” Renee asked, her hand venturing over Kat’s stomach, down one of her thighs.

“Uh-huh,” Kat said.

Julian watched the redhead’s pale fingers caressing his wife’s hairless pussy, tracing shapes around her dark labia, feeling out the softness of her folds.

“Are you okay, honey?” Kat asked her husband, looking over at him on the computer screen.

Julian had to shift to remain comfortable, the way his pants were being filled out. Had it just been his wife stripping off, playing with her vibrator, he’d have long since removed his pants. But it was a different matter with another woman in on the call, even if she was now naked along with Kat.

“Definitely,” he beamed.

“You’re not... having second thoughts about everything?”

“Oh no, not at all.”

“I guess you probably wouldn’t get... as jealous... if I’m with another woman?”

“Maybe not,” he said, and sure enough though he’d never actually seen or heard of Kat being with another guy—yet—there wasn’t that same tightness in his chest, the squirming sensation in his stomach as when Kat had been talking about her crush on Daryl.

“But you like it?” Kat asked him. “Me... playing with a girl?”

“Who are you calling a girl?” Renee giggled.

“A woman,” Kat corrected herself, before Renee said it was okay, she could call her a girl if she so wanted.

“I love it,” Julian said. “You guys are so... beautiful...”

What could you say, really? He thought. Words didn’t do them justice.

Kat said, “Show me, honey. Show me how much we’re turning you on.”

Julian felt the nerves jangling again at the thought of exposing himself on a webcam to one of Kat’s bandmates—in fact, he almost wondered if his wife had forgotten that if he pulled his equipment out, Renee would see it all as well.

“Are you... sure... honey?” he said.

“Please...” Kat moaned, as Renee leaned over her to kiss her way up her thigh.

“But—” he said.

“She doesn’t mind,” Kat said. “Come on... I want to see it.”

Renee looked up from between his wife’s legs, and grinned, “I wanna see it too. Probably the only one I’ll see this whole tour.”

“As if,” Kat cackled.

“No—I swear, my husband will be so pissed if he even suspects I’ve gone anywhere near another guy. It’s not even worth trying,” Renee said.

“But... you know... seeing one on a computer screen... it’s no worse than porn, right?”

Kat moaned again as the redhead sank her head down, wedging it against her pussy, before kissing it loudly. “Come on... honey... show me...” she pleaded with him.

Julian pulled open his fly, and stood to pull down his pants and boxers, freeing up his large erection.

“Mmm... lovely,” Renee cooed, turning to gaze at Julian as he made himself comfortable on the couch again, his exposed hardness in full view of the webcam and its audience.

“Isn’t it?” Kat giggled.

“You’re so lucky,” Renee said, but then her attention returned to Kat’s pussy. Kat looked up at her husband, giving him another isn’t-this-crazy expression before closing her eyes and succumbing to the sensation of another woman eagerly eating her out.

Renee was kneeling in front of the bed in between Kat’s legs by now, at an angle so that Julian could see a fair amount of what she was doing—sucking on Kat’s pussy lips, sliding her fingers inside her, nudging against her clit or flicking the tip of her tongue over it.

It was crazy hot. But above and beyond the thrill of seeing two attractive naked women playing with each other, Julian found that a lot of his enjoyment came from seeing just how much pleasure his wife was receiving.

It was one thing to see Renee going down on Kat, it was quite another to see the two of them changing places, and now his wife was kneeling in front of another woman, kissing her way down from her navel to the neat patch of copper hair over Renee’s mound—and then spreading her bandmate’s pale pink pussy lips with her fingers, before beginning to lick her there.

There was a sight he’d been pretty certain he’d never see ever.

It was the hottest thing ever. Kat seemed to go at it cautiously, like she needed time to adjust, to get used to being with another woman again after all this time. There was a lot of stopping and starting, and giggling and laughing, more slurps of Champagne, and tumbling all over the large bed. Then the two of them seemed to get more focused on what they were doing.

Julian felt himself being almost forgotten as the two women ended up eating each other simultaneously, in a full sixty-nine.

Watching them come together like that was something seriously special. The gasping, panting, moaning sounds they produced, the way their bodies writhed together.

The only thing that topped it was when Renee retrieved Kat's purple vibrator from the bedside table drawer, and started using it on her bandmate, firstly with Kat lying on her back, and then on all fours, facing away from the webcam so that Julian could see the vibrator sinking into his wife's pussy.

"You imagining it's Daryl, hon?" Renee said suddenly while she penetrated Kat with the vibrator. "I bet he's at least as big as this..."

Kat only moaned as her bandmate fucked her with the phallus.

"Doesn't it look like another guy's fucking her?" Renee asked Julian, then turned to see his response. The redhead gasped. "God, have you seen how hard your husband is?" she said.

Then, to Julian, "You really love it, huh? Your sweet wife being filled by another guy's big, hard cock... look at it stretching her... and she's so unbelievably wet for him..."

Kat had to flip back over onto her back to watch Julian stroking his large erection, the thing throbbing in his hands as he watched Renee sliding that thing into his wife's pussy again and again.

"She's gonna fuck him, Jules," Renee said. "Trust me. By the end of the week, she'll have him in her bed, shoving his big, fat dick so deep inside her..."

Julian couldn't last long at all after that. Kat came hard, and it seemed to trigger his own climax, and he just about managed to avoid shooting his seed all over the damn computer, thankfully.

By then it was getting seriously late on the East Coast, so he had to excuse himself from the call.

"You don't mind if Renee... keeps me company tonight?" Kat asked him.

"Of course not," he grinned, watching Kat taking over possession of the vibrator in order to use it on Renee. "Remember to get some sleep, though, huh? You do have rehearsals tomorrow..."

Chapter Ten

Those first few days of rehearsals, aside from getting it together musically, Kat was distracted, realizing she was out of practice being a rock musician.

“Oh... hey! How’re you? I... well, I wondered... if you felt like getting a coffee... some time...”

Back when The Ponytails were a force to be reckoned with, there was dick just about everywhere you looked, and she hadn’t had to work hard to get any that she wanted. She hadn’t had to actually pursue a guy since high school. In college, as in the band, they’d all come to her.

Now she was worried, because she’d been married so long... that things were done differently these days. People didn’t ask people out any more. People went on Tinder or Grindr or Tumblr or whatever other god-awful get-fucked-now app, and she had no clue what the protocol was.

She had so lost her way as a rock musician.

“No... I... I wanted to know... you know... if you wanted to get dinner sometime...”

She worried that because Daryl was a younger man... five *years* younger... he’d be familiar with the new approaches, and maybe think her crusty and old for coming straight up to him and asking him out.

“I just... you know... look... how about we go somewhere and just fuck?”

And now she was standing there in the bathroom, staring in the mirror, giggling at how lame she was for practicing asking Daryl out, just like she was in high school all over again. Trying to pull the courage together to go get him, while worrying whether he might think her an idiot for doing so. Weren’t you just supposed to swipe right on somebody on the screen of your smartphone? Or was it left?

Now she had the definitive go-ahead from her darling husband to chase the gorgeous object of her obsession, Kat was nervous as hell, and almost dreaded running into him in the hallway, or having him come into the rehearsal room to listen to them. What the hell did she say to him?

Her phone alarm sounded. Break-time was over.

She prized the door of the women's room slowly open and poked her head outside. Coast clear. Jesus, look at her. She was sneaking out of the restroom, scurrying along back to the rehearsal room, hoping that Daryl was busy with his own band, Blue Tonic. Not because she didn't obsess about him all the time, not because her heart didn't jump every time his face reappeared in her mind—or that ripped chest of his—but because it just seemed so impossibly complicated for her to run into him.

It wasn't just that she liked him so much she felt her heart nearly seizing up every time she laid eyes on him. It wasn't just that she worried so very much that he didn't feel the same way about her—even though he always smiled at her, maybe he considered her some kind of kindly spinster aunt because she was so much older than him—she worried she was going to make a fool out of herself if she suggested any kind of get-together. What if he already had a girlfriend somewhere, back home, wherever?

It was also the fact that she had a husband herself. Did she tell Daryl that her husband knew about all this, that he approved of her dating other guys? What about—dear God—her need to report everything that happened directly to her husband? What would glamorous, lively, popular Daryl think about that weirdness?

Because it was weird.

As hot as it was that Julian was so engaged with the idea of her having fun with other guys, it really was so unconventional. Was it unethical if she just dated someone and didn't tell them she was talking to her husband about every detail of their dates?

It would be simpler if she was single. But back then wouldn't she sometimes tell her girlfriends about her dates? Particularly if those dates had turned out terrible for any reason. Some of the stuff she'd revealed had been hardly ethical. It hadn't bothered her then. Perhaps she was too old now, she'd matured, she'd developed a set of serious ethics.

She made it back into the rehearsal room without Daryl being there. And now as she meandered her way through the various chairs, the microphone stands, the amps, the cases and so on, she started to regret the fact that she hadn't seen him all day. What if he forgot about her? If any mild interest he might have had in her wore off because she wasn't there in front of him all the time?

“No, look, it's very simple. If you can't keep up with the beat, you're going to pull us all down. We lose the whole energy of what we're doing.”

“I’m not, Josie. I’m right with you—you guys are just racing ahead too much.”

“We’re doing it the way we’ve always done it. And we’ve been doing it for years.”

“I’m keeping to time. I’m not the one who’s...”

Josie was having a stern talking to their replacement drummer. Kat kept away, grabbing a can of Red Bull before leaning against a radiator well off to the side. The tension had really been rising between their lead singer and the replacement drummer that morning. The trouble was, Lisa was such a nice person. The first day or so, they’d just given her the benefit of the doubt—she was new, she’d never played with them before, she just needed to get the hang of it. But when it continued on the second afternoon, you could hear Josie getting steadily more and more wound up.

This morning, Josie had begun to show her irritation. The rehearsal had been so awfully stop-start, because Josie kept ordering them to go back to the beginning again, because no one was in time. Well, Lisa wasn’t in time.

Now things were boiling right over.

“You’re *kidding* me...”

Kat just wanted to keep out of it. She supported Josie, she agreed with their lead singer that Lisa wasn’t keeping up. But she half-wondered if they did need to give her longer to let things click—and they did have two weeks to get things where they needed to be.

However, if Josie had made up her mind, she wasn’t always great about listening to other point of views.

Right now, she was having a semi-whispered argument with Lisa that was getting quite angry, despite their attempt to keep the volume down. Kat felt that gloomy sense of disappointment in the pit of her stomach, that maybe this tour wasn’t going to happen after all, despite all the preparations.

“Well, maybe we do need to find someone else...”

Kat’s ears pricked up at that. Had Josie just fired Lisa?

She looked over, open-mouthed, and saw a very irate—yet clearly embarrassed—Lisa picking up her bag and then quietly winding her way out of the room, not even looking back to wave a quick goodbye to anyone else in there.

Jesus. What the hell were they going to do without a drummer? Where were they going to get a replacement at this late stage?

“Josie, what the—” she said, putting her energy drink down on the radiator, nervously picking herself up.

“She was bad, Kat. You know it, I know it.” Josie sounded as though her blood was boiling. As though you might burst her if you jabbed her gently with a pin.

“But—” Kat didn’t quite know what to say. It seemed insane to get rid of their drummer at this late stage. “You weren’t going to talk it through with the rest of us before—?”

Josie scowled, “What would’ve been the point?”

Kat felt a little stunned. Oh, she was well aware of Josie’s legendary temper. Her fiery nature had been part of the reason she was so damn good as a singer—but it had also been part of the original friction that had ended things for The Ponytails in the first place. In the intervening years Kat had thought their lead singer might have learned to control it a little, that she’d matured, that they could let bygones be bygones. But this was a disturbing return to form for the beautiful blonde.

“Look,” Josie sighed, and said more quietly, “It’s still early. But she wasn’t improving. And we’ve got a limited time in which to find someone who can do this.”

Kat nodded, and glanced over at Alyssa, who was quietly twanging away on her bass without connecting it up to an amp. Their bassist nodded, agreeing with Josie but also flashing her eyes at Kat to remind her how Josie could be, and that it was probably better for them to let the blonde take the lead here, as she had in setting up this whole tour in the first place.

“Okay. Well, I guess this is LA, right? There has to be someone around here who can play the drums,” Kat said, suppressing her urge to demand to know if Josie was crazy, doing her utmost to be diplomatic.

“Right,” Josie said, and the tension levels in the air seemed to drop considerably. “I’ll just give Andrew a quick call... then we can work on some of the solos.”

Andrew Mulligan was their new tour manager. He hadn’t been around when The Ponytails had been originally in business, but with Josie calling most of the shots creatively, he had so far been good at pulling together the logistics for what she—and they—needed.

The rest of the morning, they did their best to rehearse without a drum backing. It was okay... they were all decent enough musicians to keep to a beat even if it wasn't actively being stamped out by a drummer. But it wasn't quite the same—and it made them feel like they might miss a trick if they weren't fully up to speed on putting the whole song together.

Lunch time. Rather than ordering out for pizza or the whole band going out somewhere to each lunch, for the first time since they'd landed in LA, the band just kind of fell apart and each member went off to get their own food, with the intention of being back promptly at 2pm.

"Hey, you want to go look for the greasiest burger in town?" Renee said, coming up to her after Josie and Alyssa had drifted away to do their own things.

"Uh... sure," Kat smiled, feeling a welcome nugget of warmth ignite inside her chest at the offer of companionship.

"How're you feeling... this morning?" Renee asked her as they headed out of the rehearsal room.

"Good—apart from... you know... the whole Lisa thing."

"Right," Renee nodded. "But you know Josie. There's no point trying to force her to accept something she believes isn't right."

"No."

Renee put her arm affectionately around Kat's waist, and Kat felt an unexpected hint of arousal, no doubt at the memory of the night before.

"You think we'll be okay?" she asked Kat.

"Oh, sure. Josie's from around here. She'll know somebody. Or Andrew will—he's in the business full-time, right?"

Renee laughed, though a little nervously, "I guess so... I think part of me thinks... sometimes... that really, the chances of pulling off a reunion tour like this... well, it's very unlikely, don't you think?"

Kat frowned, but silently shared her bandmate's doubts. After returning to 'normal' life for so long, it was hard to believe they could simply pick up where they'd left off, for The Ponytails to just go back to the way it was.

"I don't know... I think we're still doing pretty well. Everything seems to be moving forward."

Renee nodded. "You think people will buy tickets for the shows?"

"Of course they will. And you know they've purposefully started us off in relatively small venues, right? Even if the first show or two are a little

light on numbers... it'll be okay."

"Right," Renee said, giving her bandmate a little squeeze as they headed into the lobby of the building. "I don't know... I'm just kind of thankful for what we've already done, you know?"

"Of course."

"A nice trip to LA, a great meet up with everybody, some jam sessions... a little... fun in somebody else's bed..."

The redhead gave Kat a mischievous sideways glance as she recalled the previous night's adventure.

"Well I'm pretty thankful for all that, too," she grinned, feeling a little tingle starting up between her legs.

"I mean, for my marriage... it was like finally swimming to the surface, coming up for air, you know?"

Kat felt a warm surge of arousal wash over her. "You know if all this... doesn't work out..." she said, "We're only a two-hour drive from you, Renee, right?"

"I guess."

"You could always come... hang out..."

"Maybe fuck you in front of your gorgeous husband..."

They both looked around themselves to check no one might have overhead after she'd said that. Then they were opening the door to head out of the building, hit by a wall of hot Californian air as they stepped out of the air-conditioned lobby, and suddenly Kat noticed a familiar younger man leaning up against a shiny black soft-top Mustang, drawing on a cigarette.

There was no way they'd be able to get out of there without Daryl noticing.

Kat's heart jolted and bounced as his eyes found their way straight to her. He smiled, gave her a little nod.

Renee said loudly, "Well, I'll see you later, hon."

And the redhead skipped off as though she'd never asked Kat in the first place if she wanted to go find somewhere for lunch. Kat felt a trifle confused, and then a trifle terrified now that she was suddenly on her own in front of Daryl. She felt mildly annoyed at Renee, though she understood why she'd fled the scene, and appreciated her good intentions.

"Hey," Daryl said, and she loved how his eyes briefly dropped down, to take in her whole body, before returning to her face, his smile spreading further.

“Hey, how’re you doing?” she smiled back, approaching him slowly, attempting to portray confidence, though her nerves were jangling so.

“Not so bad,” he nodded. He was wearing jeans and a simple gray t-shirt with some kind of faded black graphical design, but it was a little tight on his body, and just made him ooze sex appeal. Kat felt her own eyes dropping to take in his body. Was there something of a nice bulge in his jeans? “The rest of the boys are practicing vocals this afternoon, so... you know... got a little time on my hands.”

“Funny,” Kat said, with a nervous laugh, though she felt happy to have found a way to bring the conversation to something she could actually talk about, rather than being forced into some awkward attempt to ask him out, “and here we are without a drummer now...”

She didn’t even make the mental connection until the words had fallen out of her mouth.

Daryl seemed sharp to the issue, however. “What happened?” he said. “New girl didn’t work out?”

She shook her head, and kept calm though she felt mildly pleased with herself that perhaps she might have struck upon a clever idea: Daryl was a drummer. Daryl must know other drummers. Maybe he’d be able to find someone to replace Lisa.

“She’s very nice and all,” Kat said. “But from the start she kept... you know... falling behind. And then...”

“That’s no good for anyone, huh?” Daryl agreed.

“We thought we’d give her a few days to see if she improved, but then... well, I guess Josie’s just had enough. Says we need to find someone else, quick.”

Daryl drew in another toke on his cigarette, and Kat breathed in the sharp scent of tobacco smoke. It suddenly struck her how clean and well-behaved everything was with the band this time around. Unlike the last time The Ponytails had been together, this time the building they were in—every building in the damn state—had ‘no smoking’ signs up everywhere. And it actually seemed that all of them—Josie included—had given up smoking in the intervening years.

Kat had given up just before meeting Julian. Josie had once told her she’d given up because it was just so difficult to smoke anywhere in California any more. Neither Renee nor Alyssa had craved a smoke since arriving in LA, either.

Daryl offered Kat a puff on his cigarette, and it suddenly struck her as strangely desirable. She accepted, clutching the filter between thumb and forefinger, placing it to her lips, inhaling.

It had been so long since she'd felt the heat in her throat like that, the burn in her chest. Back home, whenever she had caught a whiff of cigarette smoke it had smelled bad to her, dirty. She'd never regretted giving up. But now... it seemed different. She was with the band again. It was a rock band, for god's sake. They weren't there to be goody-goody two shoes, acting like some small group of Girl Scouts.

And it seemed kind of intimate in a way, sharing a smoke with Daryl. Sexy, even.

"I'd have to agree with Josie," Daryl said, taking another drag on the cigarette himself. "If she's not able to keep up by now, she's not going to suddenly get it by the end of rehearsals."

"Right?" Kat felt suddenly much better about Josie's snap decision.

"Better off looking for someone else," he nodded. "You've got some days, right? Better to get someone who can keep up, even if they're not so hot on the drum solo."

Kat smiled, and accepted another drag on his cigarette. She liked sharing it with him, rather than having him simply offer her a cigarette of her own. It was like she wasn't really going back to smoking... she was just sampling it a little. Recalling how it used to be when the band had toured.

"You don't think you could..." she said, breathing out a plume of smoke and trying not to cough like some kind of complete amateur. In her head, she wanted to ask him if he might know somebody, if he might recommend somebody for them.

But Daryl predicted a slightly different question from her, and immediately smiled, and said, "Sure, I can probably step in this afternoon, help you guys out."

Kat felt surprise, and even a little shock at the thought of him joining them for a whole afternoon of rehearsal. She hadn't meant—

But it was a great idea, wasn't it? He was knocking around anyway that afternoon... they needed a drummer.

"You'd be able to do that?" she asked him.

Daryl shrugged. "Sure. Why not?"

A whole afternoon with Daryl. Watching him going at it on the drums just feet away from her. She felt her pulse quickening, and the warmth of

arousal blooming between her thighs.

“You guys have all your stuff online nowadays, right?” he asked her, and from a pocket produced an iPhone and a pair of white headphones.

“Uh... yeah, I think so,” Kat nodded, then grinned. “They had to pull it off MySpace, can you believe that?”

Daryl chuckled. “Come on,” he said, standing up, dropping the near-finished cigarette before stepping on it. “Why don’t we go get something to eat, and I’ll check out a few of your tracks.”

“Wonderful,” Kat said, her body trembling a little at the fact that she was going to get something to eat with Daryl. And she hadn’t even had to ask him.

“You know what you guys’ll be working on this afternoon?”

“I think so. I can give Josie a quick call, though, to make sure...”

*

They found a diner not too far away, where Kat ordered a cheeseburger and Daryl a plate of eggs and ham and french fries. It seemed so very easy to spend time with him.

“You guys are amazing, you know that?” he said, looking up at her as he listened to the tracks they would be rehearsing that afternoon on Apple Music.

“Thank you,” she smiled, feeling that blissful warmth inside her bubbling up a little at his praise.

She was being almost entirely silent over their meal, letting him focus on the music, and somehow decipher exactly what the drums were doing through the songs. But it meant she felt less pressure to impress him with her sparkling wit than she might on an actual date.

He said, “I mean, I kind of liked your stuff at the time, but I was... you know... so hung up on the whole emo thing when I was in high school...”

High school?

Kat did the math, and figured that perhaps she was wrong in thinking Daryl was about five years her junior. Maybe that was more like ten years. God, was she some kind of evil cradle-snatcher, wanting him so badly? A wicked, wicked cougar on the prowl.

It would make him more like 23, 24, for goodness’ sake. She’d have put it at late twenties. Well, rock musicians did often seem older than their

years. All the partying, the substance abuse...

"God, I seriously missed out," he exclaimed.

She liked how much he was suddenly into their music. Whether he was playing it up a little to give her confidence in his potential contribution, it seemed genuine.

But... ten years.

Well, maybe she'd been an idiot for thinking she had a chance with him in the first place. At least she hadn't made a fool out of herself by asking him out. Imagine it, the surprise on his face when someone so very old thought she might date him. She'd lucked out.

Disappointing. But perhaps it was for the best, if he was going to spend all afternoon rehearsing with them. She'd be able to concentrate better on her own performance knowing there was no chance, knowing that it wasn't worth even wondering about.

The rest of the meal was enjoyable, maybe even more so because Kat felt the pressure melting away from her since she was no longer actively hoping to date him. He listened, carefully, to their music, and made complimentary remarks about their material, their abilities, their creativity. And Kat sat back and relaxed, a little amused that she'd thought she might sleep with the guy, even if she did allow her gaze to roam over his body a few more times, taking pleasure in her appreciation.

Outside, they shared another cigarette, and Daryl apologized because he didn't have any more left to offer her a whole one, and she didn't care, it was kind of nice. Friendly.

And at least for that afternoon, they had a drummer.

"You think you can really do it?"

"Sure, no problem."

"Oh, I was going to ask..." she remembered her original question she was going to put to him. "Do you happen to know any drummers... we might be able to use a little more permanently?"

He shrugged. "I could make some calls. All of us... Blue Tonic... we're all kind of New Orleans, born and raised... so I'm not sure I'll know many folks in LA... but maybe we could fly someone out?"

"I think we'd have no option if it comes to it."

Josie and the rest of the band were delighted that Kat had found a replacement for the afternoon. But as Daryl came into the room, and she officially introduced him to everybody, she found she had to quietly fend

off all the sly nods and winks from Josie, Renee, and even Alyssa, who were all apparently under the impression that Kat was either already sleeping with him or certainly moving toward that eventuality.

Daryl climbed behind the drum set and adjusted his seat, and Josie asked him if he needed a little more time to listen to the next track they would be rehearsing. He shook his head and confidently said he was fine, and that was that. They all launched into Lost in Your Surprise, and it seemed to all of them that the guy had been playing with them for months and months.

“Jesus Fucking H Christ,” Josie said to him after the first run through. “You been secretly practicing our stuff at home?”

Daryl chuckled. “No, Ma’am. But I listened to it plenty over lunch.”

“Jesus Fucking Jumped-up Christ,” Josie blasphemed yet again.

He really was that good. Kat felt a curious kind of pride in his obvious talent—that she’d spotted him, that she’d brought him in to help out their struggling band. And The Ponytails sounded simply supreme with Daryl there behind the drums.

Kat just had to try not to stare at him too much as he worked up a sweat back there, his muscles all flexing and rippling and glistening as he thrashed out the beat to amazing effect all afternoon.

Now where was she going to find herself a man to equal him? A man of the right kind of age. Josie had already taken the pick of the crop from the other band on their ticket. If she was going to make the most of her freedom—and, what she wanted more than anything, to test out her dear husband’s powerful fantasy—she was going to have to keep an eye out for a fan, or a roadie, or some random stranger in a hotel.

It didn’t seem much of a comparison, somehow.

In the mid-afternoon break, Daryl apologized for having to go out and buy cigarettes, but as he left the room Kat saw him putting in his headphones, diligently putting in the time to listen to the next tracks they would be working on. Kat went out to the bathroom, feeling the eyes of her bandmates digging into her, wanting to ask her what was going on between her and their hot-shot replacement drummer.

Now she felt like going out to the parking lot, to lean up against a Mustang and share a cigarette with an attractive younger man. Instead, she stood in the bathroom and splashed cold water on her face, trying to

dampen down some of the lust she felt playing guitar with Daryl on drums just behind her.

She was going to have to change her underwear.

The door to the bathroom burst open, and there was Renee.

“Hey, how’s it going?” she grinned.

“Hey,” Kat said, shrugged.

“So...” Renee said, searching for an in for Kat’s latest. “Your man is... quite the talent, huh?”

Kat sighed, and brushed her fingers through her long, dark hair. “He’s not my man, though, is he?”

The positivity in Renee’s face collapsed into concern. “Oh... what happened?” she asked. “Something over lunch?”

Kat shrugged again. “He was in *high school* when we were putting out records,” she said.

“So?”

She looked at her band mate, emphasized her point: “He’s, like, ten years younger than us.”

Renee broke out into laughter. “What does that matter?” She stepped behind Kat, and wrapped her arms around her waist affectionately, looking at her in the mirror. “Look at you, honey bun,” she said. “You’re flat-out *gorgeous*.”

“I’m 33 years old,” Kat said.

“You look 25 at most,” her bandmate said, running her hands through Kat’s hair, and then stroking her cheek. “I bet he doesn’t even think you’re in your thirties yet.”

Kat sighed. “He can Google me, easy as pie.”

“And who cares if he does?” Renee said. “You’re not hoping to marry him, are you?”

“Of course not.”

“You just want to bang his brains out, just like every woman who lays eyes on him, I’ll bet. Age doesn’t matter—”

“That’s not the point, is it?” Kat said. “It’s him who has to want to bang *my* brains out.”

Renee laughed again, scoffing at her for denying her chances. She said, “You know he went up to Josie the first day we all got together in the hotel... you know what he asked her?”

“What?”

“Whether you were single.”

“Seriously?” Kat’s eyebrow shot up. And something warm and syrupy-sweet gently exploded between her thighs. She glanced down, wondering why Daryl hadn’t simply looked at her wedding ring for some kind of answer, before being scared away. But as she glanced down, she saw that her fingers were bare.

She’d forgotten: she’d taken off her rings in order to get them re-sized, because all her training and exercise had meant they were now too big, and might easily slip off and be lost.

Julian had never insisted she put her wedding ring back on. But then he probably wanted her to appear single...

“Uh-huh,” Renee said, nodding as though to urge her to go right out there and bang Daryl right in the hallway.

“What did Josie say to him when he asked?”

“She said you were married, but available.” Renee smirked.

Kat felt arousal glowing between her legs. She said, “So what am I supposed to do with that?”

Renee stepped to the side, and leaned her butt up against the sink. “You just keep doing what you’re doing,” she said. “He’s preparing to make his move, you don’t see that?”

“I don’t know,” she shrugged.

“Come on... he’s making sure he runs into you in the hallway whenever you’re off on a break. He comes in to listen to us play when he gets a rare moment off from his rehearsals... and then when our drummer gets fired for being total bullcrap, who is right there to step in and spend a little more quality time with you?”

Kat felt a little tremor of desire wash through her. Was Renee right? Was there really a chance she could have Daryl?

“You’re not put off because he’s a few years younger, are you?” Renee asked her.

“No, I don’t think so.”

“I mean, it’s not like he’s under age. And you know what it means if he’s not even twenty-five yet?”

“What does it mean?”

“It means he’s probably got the stamina of an Olympic marathon runner.”

Kat smiled, but underneath the surface all kinds of wildfires were being lit within her body. If this had been high school, she would probably wonder if a girl like Renee was simply leading her on, setting her up to make a fool of herself in front of the popular boy. But they weren't in high school, and Renee was her friend. Renee was forbidden from going near other men herself—it seemed to Kat she had something of a desire to live vicariously through Kat.

“So I should just... wait?” she asked.

Renee tilted her head. “Just see what happens. If you get the chance to spend a little more time with him, go for it. Hey baby, this is a goddamn rock band! Just give him a few drinks and take him back to your room!”

“Sure,” Kat laughed. If only it was as simple as that.

*

They all had something of a spring in their step as they reconvened after the break. Daryl was on the phone as he returned into the rehearsal room, smelling faintly of a fresh cigarette—something that, rather surprisingly, seemed to attract Kat.

As he took his seat at the drum set, he hung up the phone and said, “Okay... if you guys need me the rest of the week, my guys have said they can probably just about spare me in the afternoons. How does that sound, until you find someone else?”

Josie glanced at Kat and then the others, and then said quickly, “That would be unbelievable, Daryl. You'd really do that?”

Daryl smiled, and when he glanced specifically at Kat, it suddenly seemed like a real confirmation of what Renee had been saying in the bathroom. Kat felt her pussy tingling a little more.

“It would be my pleasure,” he replied to Josie.

“Fantastic!”

Then something else unexpected happened: two guys appeared at the doorway, carrying a cardboard box each. Daryl seemed to know what was going on—he directed them to place the boxes down by the side of the room.

“Thanks, fellas,” he said. Then, to the confused women around him, he explained: “You guys not gonna have a beer or two while we rehearse?”

It was like he was pointing out why the reformed Ponytails were not yet a fully-fledged rock band. It seemed so simple all of a sudden. They needed to loosen up. They all cracked open beers instead of the energy drinks they'd been loading themselves with all week—and suddenly they weren't just good musicians, they were good rock musicians. As they loosened up, the music just flowed.

*

The rest of the afternoon Kat felt jubilant that she was getting to spend more time with Daryl—and the alcohol softened the pressure of doing so. She also felt herself looking forward to getting back to the hotel at the end of the day and calling Julian to tell him the news. It was funny how exciting it was to think that she could tell her husband all about the potential the situation was setting up for her to sleep with another man, and that she would be turning on her husband by talking about it, as well.

And that really was the icing on the cake. Because as much as she wanted to sleep with Daryl, she also wanted the opportunity to tell her husband about how it was to sleep with Daryl. She had a strong idea, by now, that Julian would probably come like crazy when he heard all about it.

The afternoon rehearsal was just brilliant. With Daryl there behind them, The Ponytails sounded just incredible. Kat was playing guitar and checking out their hot new drummer, and noticing that he was checking her out every moment he could.

By the end of it, she was getting seriously hot around the collar. And soaking between the legs. She could hardly wait to get back and call Julian.

Only, as Josie and Alyssa made their way out of the room, and Renee quietly stowed away her keyboard, Daryl strolled over to Kat and said, “Hey. How do you feel about doing a little overtime this evening?”

Kat stifled a gasp, and felt a jolt of fire shoot through her heart.

“Uh... sure,” she said, looking over to see if Renee had heard what he'd asked her. Renee had heard, and when Daryl wasn't looking, she gave Kat a broad grin and a silent thumbs-up, making Kat blush like a nun in a strip joint.

“I just thought... you know... I could run through the tracks with you one more time, and... you know... check a few things...” Daryl said.

“Great idea,” Kat said, though she kind of felt a little like a loaded gun with no safety catch. She was so very horny already, from the afternoon’s rehearsals...

“And maybe we could go get something to eat later?” Daryl asked.

Kat felt her mouth move before her brain had a chance to consider what she said, her lips forming the words: “Okay, so it’s a date.”

She felt somewhat horrified as she realized what she’d said, how obvious she’d made it all sound when Daryl had given them just the cautious set-up to spend time with each other without anyone having to resort to asking the other one out, or calling it something so blatant as a ‘date’.

But now she had said it, Daryl beamed warmly, and said: “Wonderful.”

Kat felt fireworks going off inside her chest. Wow. Wow. Wow. It was a date?

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Chapter Eleven

Ten days until he was going to see her again in the flesh. Two hundred and forty hours. Okay, so he wasn't exactly counting down the hours, but sometimes it seemed like it. He'd sit there at work staring at the clock on the wall above the office printer, and he'd work out how many hours left in the day, and how many to go until he was on the plane to LA to see his sexy wife again.

Wednesday.

But it wasn't just the flight to California that he was waiting for. All the time he was waiting around he was really waiting for some little text message, or an email, or a call or a FaceTime message, revealing that finally Kat had taken the bold step of sleeping with another man. Okay, so she didn't really do email, and she was so busy with rehearsals that there really wasn't time for a phone call or FaceTime until she finally got back to the hotel at the end of the day.

She could text, however, and occasionally dropped a little affectionate line like,

[Kat]: Thinking about you! Xxx

Or perhaps some random update on her current situation:

[Kat]: So hot and sweaty. Can you believe the air conditioner in our room isn't working properly today? Nobody can fix it :-(

Or a nugget of tour news:

[Kat]: So Josie fired our drummer :-(She wasn't all that great, tho. Gonna be tough to find a new one.

Julian enjoyed knowing he was in her thoughts every now and then, enough so for her to remember a little text update. But it also kind of made him feel like he was some kind of emergency doctor, on call. But rather than waiting for an unexpected alert to some patient in trouble, he was tense to the possibility of a sudden text message from Kat announcing that she'd done something naughty.

Now that she'd confessed her attraction toward the drummer from Blue Tonic, Julian felt more on edge than ever, nervously waiting for that

bombshell of a text.

Kat had been so reluctant to actually take advantage of her new-found sexual freedom, so nervous about offending her husband even if they'd talked and talked about his fantasy. But now that they'd had the whole thing verified by an independent third party—after Renee had come in and talked it over with them on FaceTime, suddenly it seemed to Julian that Kat was open to the possibility of actually going for another guy on tour.

So here he was in another boring Wednesday afternoon meeting, and maybe half of his attention was on the phone he had secreted in his palm.

“Julian, what do those numbers say to you?”

“Uh... well, Marty, I have to say they're not as rosy as they have been in previous years, but if you adjust for the state of the economy, it's really not too bad, considering.”

He was surprised how effective he was at his job using only half his attention, but maybe that was more a reflection of how mindless the job was. It paid well, but it really was only pushing papers around an office. Maybe he needed to find something different.

One benefit of Kat being in California, however, was that the time difference meant that for most if not all of the morning, he knew there was zero chance of her texting him. It meant that if there was actually a project where he needed more than an ounce or two of focus, he would be able to get it done before lunch.

“Well, let's keep an eye on them, and if anything changes for the worse next month...”

“I'll follow up in a week, Marty, just to make sure.”

“Perfect. Okay. So, we need to look at the reciprocals, I think. Judy, you got something on that?”

And here just in time to keep his eyelids from voluntarily sealing themselves together, his phone did actually vibrate quietly in his hands. It was still very early days on the tour, so he didn't get his hopes up despite what Renee had encouraged them to think about the previous night.

He glanced around the room quickly to ensure nobody would notice him dwelling for any length of time on his cell phone. Apart from Marty, their boss, who had his head turned constantly toward the PowerPoint presentation up on the drop-down screen, everyone else seemed to be unashamedly gazing down at their laps, and their own damn smart phones. Ah well.

A slight rise in his heart rate as he peered down at the screen of his phone.

[Kat]: So guess who's going to step in to help with the drumming the rest of the week, while we find a replacement?

He felt a slight note of disappointment as he saw that it was merely tour news she was sending. How was he supposed to know who they had filling in for pregnant Jacqueline this week? He didn't know any drummers.

[Julian]: Phil Collins? Dave Grohl? Lars Ulrich?

He was running out of famous drummers.

[Julian]: Ringo Starr? Charlie Watts?

Kat was seemingly not amused.

[Kat]: Har, har. Ain't you the comedian.

But he was about to tap out his point about not being expert in the world of drumming when she came up with the answer:

[Kat]: Daryl!

Julian caught his breath.

"Everything all right, Julian?"

He looked up, mildly shocked that he'd been busted for looking at his phone. Everyone was looking at him. Jesus. What was he going to say? He had no idea what everyone had been talking about for the past few minutes. All credit to Judy and her expertise on the reciprocals, but Julian had no idea and even less care in the world about any of that.

"Uh... yeah, sorry," he said, sitting up a little straighter in his chair, as though it would distract from the blush that he felt heating up his cheeks, the sweat oozing out of his hairline.

"You have something to add?" Marty said, sounding like a teacher demanding to see the secret note he'd been caught passing around.

"Uh..." Julian felt horrified. What on Earth could he say? He shrugged and blurted out, "I just think there's gotta be another way, Marty."

A gamble. Everyone else, apart from Judy, who had been halted in mid-presentation and looked more than miffed about it, was looking at him and Marty as though they were watching tennis at the US Open. All of them seemed thankful they hadn't been discovered fiddling with their smart phones, but all were riveted on what Julian had said in order to get out of trouble.

Marty stared at Julian, his face fixed in a terrifying countenance.

Then their boss seemed to suddenly relax, turn to Judy and say: “Well, is there, Judy? I mean it’s a perfectly reasonable question considering the extent to which the numbers stack up.”

Judy gave a silent “fuck you” stare to Julian for messing up the flow of her presentation, and now had to pick up on Julian’s suggestion. Poor thing.

Julian went back to subtly scoping out his smart phone for anything Kat might have sent him further, resolved to not exposing himself so stupidly again.

[Kat]: Okay... so right now I’m having lunch with him! It’s not really like a date or anything, but we were talking about our drum situation, and Daryl just volunteered to help us out.

Having lunch with him—well, that was progress, wasn’t it? Enough to give Julian a semi right in the middle of the meeting, at least. A quick look around to check he was safe—and he was, Marty was grilling Judy on this mythical alternative approach Julian had just suggested—and he tapped out a reply to Kat:

[Julian]: That’s great, honey! Sounds to me that he’s interested in a certain guitarist...

Okay, now his semi was thickening a little further, since he’d just effectively hinted to his wife that some guy might want to sleep with her.

[Kat]: I don’t know... he’s good at playing things cool... right now he’s sitting across from me in a diner, listening to our back catalog on iTunes.

How long did it take to track down a replacement drummer in LA, anyway? And how long could Blue Tonic just loan out their drummer? Julian hoped it was a few days, that maybe Daryl would find himself irresistibly drawn to Kat... Boy, was it exciting. And he wasn’t even there to see it happening.

[Julian]: And yet he’s volunteered to do extra work for you guys until you find another drummer... sounds like he’s preparing to make a move...

But Kat didn’t reply to that text, and suddenly Julian felt the cold frosty chill of fear that he had somehow offended her. He told himself it was just the fact that she was having lunch with someone, a guy she had a crush on, and maybe now they were talking again, and she was distracted from texting her husband. He took the positive view, though he couldn’t quite shake the nerves that she was spurning him because he’d been so crass

in suggesting this new friend of hers might want to do wicked things with her.

They came out of the meeting, and there had been no more texts from Kat.

Indeed, there were no more texts from Kat that afternoon, and Julian tried to take that as being a fantastic state of affairs—assuming that she was completely consumed with Daryl temporarily joining The Ponytails that she had no time to text home with an update.

Deep breath, deep breath.

He headed home after work and dialed out for Chinese food. Being on his own at home while Kat was away did make him feel a sense of independence, of freedom. It wasn't anything major, but it meant he could be lazy about tidying up, about making sure he was dressed around the house, about eating whatever crap came to mind instead of the more balanced diet Kat preferred—and all those fruits and vegetables she'd been into ever since the new tour had been announced.

He could go out if he liked, watch a movie at the theater and buy all kinds of terrible snacks, and he wouldn't have to explain anything to his wife. He could go sit in a bar and watch sports over a huge plate of nachos. He could go visit college friends he hadn't seen in ages.

Only, the thing was, it didn't compensate for the big hole he felt in his existence with Kat gone away. He might be free to do what he liked without asking Kat what she wanted to do, but it felt kind of empty when he did it.

Over Chinese food and an On Demand movie on the TV, he found himself gazing at his phone, wondering what Kat was getting up to with Daryl. Hoping that the rehearsal was going well, and that maybe something might happen afterward.

Eight o'clock. In California, it was the end of the working day by now. Nerves jangled and rustled inside him. Had he really offended her with that innocuous text message earlier?

Or had Kat been enjoying her time with Daryl so much that they were shooting off to some motel somewhere to bang the living daylights out of each other?

Julian's semi-erect cock certainly had ideas.

Then, finally, a text message:

[Kat]: Rehearsal was great—Daryl wants me to stay behind with him and run through a few more songs! And then he said we should go get

dinner!

Julian felt a surge of heat flush through his system, and his semi became a full erection, his heart palpitating inside his chest. He texted her back:

[Julian]: That's terrific, honey! Seems like he wants to spend every possible minute with you ;-)

As soon as he'd texted her with a wink face emoticon at the end of his message, he regretted it again. Text messaging was so dangerous.

But Kat came back:

[Kat]: I think he might :-) Accidentally told him it's 'a date' when he suggested we go for food later, and was so scared he was going to think I was a freak.

[Julian]: I bet he didn't. Bet he was over the moon.

[Kat]: He said 'wonderful'.

So, the drummer from Blue Tonic was hoping to date Kat after all. Julian felt his hard cock throbbing away. Then his wife signed off quickly:

[Kat]: Gotta go, honey. Love you xxx

He responded with his own farewell and wished her luck, but he sensed she'd probably put away her phone by then, ready to rehearse on her own with a handsome, fit, younger drummer.

Wow. He was so turned on—how could he be quite so turned on, when he wasn't getting any sex? There wasn't even a semi-nude woman on screen to get him going. Kat was thousands of miles away on another coast, about to spend time on her own with her crush. And Julian was hard just from waiting to find out what was going on, and maybe from imagining what might be happening between them.

How could waiting be so thrilling?

If you were waiting for your wife to do something naughty, that was how it could, apparently.

Chapter Twelve

It started off well—that is, professionally.

Kat came out of the restroom, where she'd hidden herself away to briefly update her husband via text, to find Daryl alone in the room, drumming away. She recognized it, vaguely as being something Jacqueline played—that had been attempted this week by Lisa, albeit more slowly. Daryl picked up their material quickly.

“So, is it that you're fantastically good at picking up new music... or that our music is so horrifically simplistic that it's just easy to learn?” she said as she waltzed back to her place and picked up her guitar.

It wasn't that she was feeling confident—quite the opposite, even if they'd been drinking beer all afternoon at Daryl's prompting. She just found that if she could keep the subject on the music, she could distract herself from the... naughty thoughts.

“It's not simplistic,” he grinned, placing a hand on one of his cymbals to silence it now she had returned.

“So what you're saying is... you're pretty good,” she laughed at making him sound conceited.

“I'll let you in on a little secret,” he said. “People can't tell much difference if you simplify things on a song, not when it comes to the drums. As long as you play loud and you get the right beat...”

They picked up where the last rehearsal had left off, and went on to the songs Josie was planning on working on the next day. Useful for Daryl, since as well as her regular guitar part, on most of the songs Kat could play guitar and just about pull off a passable impression of Josie's singing at the same time—at least enough to make the music sound something like the real thing.

After an afternoon of drinking, they both continued into the evening as the beers were right there, still in the ice bucket. And while Daryl might have his own reasons for drinking, Kat found it easier to cope with her feelings if she was a little tipsy. It did slow her down after a while, however. That and the heat.

“God it’s sweltering in here,” Daryl said at one point, and she noticed that his t-shirt appeared soaked.

Not just her, then, finding it hot.

“Oh, the air conditioning’s broken,” she remembered.

“Broken?”

She shrugged. “It comes and goes—sometimes it’s too fricking cold in here, would you believe it. Then an hour or two later it’s hot like the mid-day sun.”

“We should go in the Blue Tonic room,” he said.

She said, “Your band mates wouldn’t mind?”

He shook his head, and they swanned out of there, clutching Kat’s guitar and a few beers each. Kat glanced at the clock as they were leaving, and it was almost nine o’clock. Jesus—had they been at it that long?

It was just as hot in the Blue Tonic rehearsal room.

“Jesus, nobody we can call to fix it?” Daryl said.

“You wanna call it a day?” she asked.

He smiled and cracked open another beer, before making himself comfortable behind his usual set of drums. “One more song,” he suggested. “Then we can go eat. How about it?”

She smiled, not wanting to end their little practice session despite the heat. “Sounds good,” she said.

Daryl pulled off his shirt, exposing his bare chest—his ripped bare chest. Kat felt her heart almost lose its rhythm. And despite all the alcohol in her system—or maybe because of it—she felt arousal blooming inside her.

“You drummers,” she teased him. “Always so quick to rip off your shirts.”

Daryl laughed. “It’s cooler this way. You should try it.”

And she was tipsy enough to do that. She felt his suggestion was almost a taunt, that a woman couldn’t pull off her shirt because of her gender. She wasn’t sure if that was it, but something in there tweaked her inner sense of feminism.

So she pulled off her own shirt, leaving her in a black bra and nothing else above the waist.

Daryl whooped at her bravery, or her exhibitionism, or both. “You see? Isn’t that better?” he asked her, tapping out a little quiet rhythm on the snare drum.

“Uh-huh,” she grinned, throwing her shirt away as though she didn’t ever need it again. She loved how he looked at her now that she was almost topless.

He was interested, there was no doubting it. It made her wet to know it. As did watching him play without his shirt on—seeing his muscles rippling, glistening with sweat. Yet as much as she liked to ogle him playing without a shirt on, it seemed he liked to do the same with her—and a day’s slow but meticulous drinking meant he wasn’t so worried about hiding his attention.

The sexual tension was positively crackling in the air as they went through that last song—but they managed to get through it. Though interested, Daryl seemed ever the gentleman, always bringing things back to the music and the rehearsal if there was any hint of the flirtation getting out of control.

“I’ll be with Blue Tonic tomorrow in the a.m.,” he pointed out once it was all done, “but this way we can just pick up at lunch time like I’ve been there all day.”

“Makes sense,” she said, unplugging her guitar, switching off the amp. “So, are we... going to get something to eat?”

She tried to be calm, to ask her question as though it wasn’t anything special, as though it was just one rock musician asking a co-worker if they happened to want to eat food at the same time in the same place, rather than suggesting something more, which might make her seem like some kind of idiot. She so desperately wanted to give the right impression to him—not that she was some silly girl with a crush on him, wondering if he was interested in her or only the music.

Daryl didn’t seem to care about impressions. What did anything like that matter to a rock star?

He walked over from the drum set, stooped to pick up her shirt, and as she looked on in mild astonishment, he put it to his face and breathed in her scent.

“You mean our date?” he smiled.

She caught her breath.

He stepped up to her and she could smell his perspiration. It made her feel light-headed, a little dizzy, flustered. His bare chest was inches away from her.

“Is that what we’re calling it?” she smiled, trying to act cool.

“Uh-huh.” He didn’t get awkward, he didn’t get flustered, he didn’t back down. His self confidence simply strengthened her desire for him.

“I haven’t... had a date in quite a while,” she said, not sure if she was attempting to warn him off, to lower his expectations or to test whether he really wanted this.

He smiled. “We don’t have to call it a date if you don’t want to.”

“What would we call it instead?”

God. Her heart was beating a thousand times a minute.

He shrugged. “We could call it ‘two people who really need to get laid go get food together’.”

She hesitated. A good girl, a God-fearing married woman away from her husband would have jumped right in and denied categorically that she really needed to get laid. But after a meaningful pause, she found herself giggling, and saying, “Okay.”

A moment later, as she saw a knowing twinkle in his eye, she felt herself blushing profusely yet again, the heat seeming to explode inside her, particularly between her legs—knowing that she’d essentially just confirmed that she did, indeed, really need to get laid.

“Come on, then,” he said, stepping back to invite her along.

She felt as though the ground was moving under her, as though the area was being hit by a silent earthquake. Was she really doing this? Going to get dinner with this gorgeous younger guy—with both of them putting it right out there that they needed sex. She could hardly believe it.

Well, they were both in rock bands. Rock musicians didn’t go for coy first dates. They went out, satisfied any need for food and/or drink, and then found somewhere suitable to satisfy their other needs.

As they walked out of the room, Daryl put his arm around her waist and she very nearly melted.

*

They found a steakhouse down a street off Sunset, recommended by the taxi driver despite the fact that it might mean a lower fare for him for the night. It was good, it was dark, they both felt like they had some privacy.

“Celebrities go there all the time,” the driver had said, sniffing as though he dealt with so many famous people, they were a dime a dozen.

Kat was kind of surprised he knew who they were. When she made the point after they were dropped off at the restaurant, Daryl chuckled, “He thinks we’re famous. Probably doesn’t know who we are, but he doesn’t want you to know that.”

“Why does he think we’re famous?”

“Because you’re insanely hot, and I probably look like an arrogant prick, and we’re both walking out of that building—a recording studio which belongs to a fairly decent record label.”

She smiled that he didn’t simply come out and say they both looked like rock stars—because rock stars don’t say such things, right? But her pussy throbbed at the way he said she was ‘insanely hot’.

Inside the restaurant, it was so dark it took a moment or two for their eyes to adjust.

“This way sir, madame.”

A booth at the back seemed perfect, but the place was fairly empty. They both talked about the music while they ordered, and while they waited for their steaks. More beers, but this time craft beers rather than the mainstream kind. They talked about the rehearsal, about the music. Daryl asking about who wrote which song, about why the need for this, why the need for that.

Funny how the music—that which brought them there, the day job, the thing that had to go right if they were to continue the tour—seemed like mere small talk. But it did. Once the food came, and the waiter left them to themselves, the need for small talk appeared over.

“So, your friend Josie said you were ‘married but available’,” Daryl said.

She smiled, and felt butterflies in her stomach stirring up at his sudden change of subject, at the intimacy of the topic compared to their conversation so far.

“That’s what she told you?” she smiled, and took a drink, playing for time to figure out what to say to him.

Did she tell him the truth and hope that he wasn’t put off by the thought of Julian waiting around back home to hear all the details? Or did she deny Josie’s claim and insist she was single, which might make a quick fling more likely, but might ruin their relationship as soon as the truth came out?

“I don’t know... bandmates always try to mess things up for you, don’t they?” he grinned, shrugged off what he’d heard from The Ponytails’ lead singer.

Kat saw that he was giving her an out. It only made her like him more, as distinct from lusting after him. But it also kept her choice open. She squinted briefly. What kind of a person was he? If they had a fling, would he get jealous about her husband back home? Would things get awkward when Julian came to visit?

She the heat building inside her. Men were often accused of thinking with their dicks, but just then, sitting across a table from the most gorgeous specimen of male beauty she’d seen in a long time—with apologies to her husband, but seriously—Kat was very, very driven to think with her pussy.

She sighed, but after a sip of beer—as another delaying tactic—she decided the friendly relationship with a member of their support band was more important to secure than a quick fuck. No matter how much she craved him physically, she was mature enough these days to see that in the long-term, she didn’t want the ignominy of a blatant lie to hang between them for the rest of the tour.

“Josie’s right,” she said, expecting Daryl’s face to suddenly sour, and maybe for him to groan and pull himself out of the booth altogether, ready to make a quick exit, stage left.

But Daryl just nodded quietly, calmly. “Married but available,” he said. Not quite a questioning tone, but inviting an explanation.

She took another sip of beer. Now she had the problem of how much did she tell him. “My husband... lets me do whatever I want with other guys... while I’m away from home,” she said. She could probably have left it at that, right? She’d told him the truth. She didn’t have to tell him any more. But was it ethical to leave him in the dark about the other stuff?

Her obligation to share details of her encounters with Julian, for example. Suddenly that obligation seemed like a bit of a yoke around her neck.

“That’s nice of him,” Daryl smiled, keeping calm, apparently not reacting to news of her husband’s generosity. “You let him see other women?”

She thought for a moment of the previous night, when she’d stripped off Renee’s clothes right in front of her husband’s view on the webcam. Technically, he had seen another woman. But not quite as Daryl meant. Kat

thought about Julian going off on some business trip, hiring a hooker. Or taking some business contact back up to his room after a conference. It made her feel mildly nauseous. It made her feel homesick. It made her feel quite seriously betrayed. No, Renee was a different ball game.

“No,” she said. “No, he doesn’t see anyone else.”

Daryl raised an eyebrow. “But you two... still...” he did a little hand gesture that seemed like the international sign for sex.

Here was another point where Kat could have lied, or stretched the truth. Maybe Daryl would be put off by knowing she still slept with her husband in a biblical sense. Maybe he would be more attracted to her if she said she no longer had sexual relations with Julian.

But where would lies get her on a potentially lengthy tour?

“Oh yes,” she nodded. “Very much so.”

Again, she waited for Daryl to get up and leave. Or even just say something to take the heat out of their conversation, turn relations with her platonic.

But he only smiled, said, “Interesting. I guess that’s the answer to my question, ‘what does he get out of this arrangement’—he gets to have you.”

Kat saw the easy logic. It wasn’t even a logic she’d thought of when Julian had first revealed his desire for her to sleep with other men. Her logic had suggested maybe Julian was bored of her, maybe he wanted her to give him the justification to cheat on her.

But to suggest that Julian could only have her by letting her see other guys... made her seem like a monster.

“Oh, he gets to have me even if he didn’t let me see other guys,” she said.

Daryl said, “He likes you... seeing other guys? Or does he prefer to pretend you don’t?”

“As far as I know, he likes me seeing other guys. He certainly doesn’t do any... pretending.”

“As far as you know?”

She smiled, and felt those nervous butterflies flapping around in her stomach again. Was she making a big mistake, trying to make Julian’s strange fantasy a reality? Would it harm their marriage after all? She told Daryl, “It... kind of... hasn’t really happened yet.”

“Seriously?” Daryl raised his eyebrow again. “Tell me it’s because you haven’t met the right guy yet... I mean... it’s not because guys don’t want

you, right?”

She smiled, and felt that line in the sand being crossed again—she liked him as a person, rather than just lusting after his body. It felt almost as though she was in danger of falling foul of the hard and fast rule for all this, falling for another guy rather than just fucking him. But maybe she needed to feel this way about a guy to sleep with him. She needed some kind of emotional connection.

“Julian... only told me how he felt... recently.”

“When he knew you were going on tour?”

“Yes, something like that.”

Daryl nodded. “He knows how it is on tour, then.”

“I’m not sure he does. Not fully. But it seems to fit into his fantasy...”

She regretted her use of the term ‘fantasy’ the instant it came out of her mouth. Too much information. She could have been satisfied with telling Daryl that Julian would know about any guy she slept with, that he’d know she was sexually active while away from him. She didn’t have to tell him that Julian would enjoy knowing she was sexually active while away from home.

“So, this is a sexual thing for your husband?” Daryl said, sharp. Picking up instantly on that word. “He gets off on knowing you’re... fooling around?”

She gazed at him, anxious, but increasingly he gave her the confidence to tell him the truth. He wasn’t shying away from any of this.

“He’s curious... to hear about... anything that happens to me,” she said, speaking slowly as she considered her words carefully.

“He gets off on you fucking other guys?” Daryl grinned.

His grin caught her off-guard. Suddenly she thought he was making fun of Julian, or making fun of her, or making fun of them both. That he really thought it was pathetic, weird, freaky, after all.

“That puts you off?” she asked him, feeling a flicker of butterflies as she said it. She was laying it all out there.

He laughed. But then he said, “God, no. I don’t care that you’re married. I don’t care what you’ve got going on with your husband. I just care that you’re the most beautiful woman I ever saw.”

She smiled and felt her heart just leap. “Thank you,” she blushed, feeling like all kinds of sweet music was playing inside her chest.

What had she ever done for this gorgeous guy to like her?

“Just telling it how it is,” he said. “No point in doing anything else.”

He took another bite of his steak, and Kat saw that he’d finished his. It made her tremble. God, was this all going the way she thought it was? Were they going to go back to the hotel and... well... do naughty, beautiful, wonderful, wicked things together?

She pushed her half-eaten steak aside. She wasn’t hungry. The disco inside her stomach was taking care of her appetite.

Almost in slow motion, it seemed, Daryl leaned forward across the table and reached for her hands. She looked uncertainly in his eyes a moment, and then gave him her hands. She felt a sweet buzz as he touched her, the warmth and the roughness of his hands.

“So, I don’t need to worry about your marriage,” he smiled. “If we were to... you know... sleep together... would it be a problem later on? When we’re on the road together?”

She looked into his eyes. Pretty, blue eyes. She hardly knew him. She couldn’t love him. She felt certain about that.

“It would just be sex, right?” she said, and the casual nature of it all just startled her, though she did well to hide it. Jesus. She was really going to do it with him?

“Just sex,” Daryl nodded.

She said, “It wouldn’t be like we were... you know... together.”

“No,” he agreed. “Just... friends, right?”

She grinned. “Friends with benefits.”

Once again, she felt the alcohol breaking down her inhibitions, removing her sense of awkwardness, her fears and concerns. She slipped off one of her shoes, and now quietly lifted her foot, up to the seat Daryl was sitting on. Between his legs.

She did her best to look as though nothing was happening above the table, but beneath it, her foot stroked his inner thighs, and then glided up over his crotch to gently explore the bulge in his pants.

And boy, what a bulge in his pants.

He gazed into her eyes and smiled, trying as much as she was to look as though nothing was happening, nothing for the waiter or any of the other restaurant customers would be able to see. But he sat there with his legs spread, letting her stroke his hardness with her foot.

“Do you have a girlfriend?” she asked him.

He shrugged. “Somewhere,” he said. Ordinarily, she might have thought ill of somebody with such a casual attitude toward his girlfriends. But tonight, with Daryl, she didn’t care so much.

Then he said, “We’re on a break. She decided she wants the kind of guy who can buy her a house in the suburbs—and stay with her in it. Raise kids, a mortgage, and so on. I let her go off and find one.”

Kat felt better about it, nevertheless. She wasn’t a home wrecker.

“She’s crazy,” she said. “Letting you go.”

He shrugged. “You came along. I probably would have cheated on her anyway. Or broke up with her.”

She grinned. “Just so you could have me?”

“No one else I’d rather have right now.”

They were both silent for a few moments. Kat stroked him, feeling out the size of his erect cock. Marveling at it. Was that all him? What would that feel like inside her? Wow. Just, wow.

She felt her hand automatically drop between her thighs—and jolted in surprise at just how damp she was down there. Would he think ill of her? Would he think there was something wrong with her? She was so wet...

“Let’s get out of here,” he said, signaling for the waiter.

Kat withdrew her foot from between his thighs. She felt all giddy again. The schoolgirl who’s won over her high school crush, who knows pretty much that he’s the one to take her cherry. Only, this wasn’t the cherry that made her no longer a virgin. It was the cherry that made her no longer a monogamous, married woman.

Was this really what Julian wanted? It wasn’t as though it was reversible. They could both try to forget about it if things turned out badly, but they probably both knew that it would be impossible to entirely forget something like this.

They split the bill—or at least, both of them put down a fifty each, knowing it would more than cover the meal, and neither of them felt like waiting around for change. Then they were outside the restaurant, waiting for Uber to send them a car.

Waiting outside, despite the restaurant’s offer of a seat inside while they waited for the car.

There on the curb, Daryl pulled her to him. Kat felt bold, and now her hands were on him, sliding up to cradle his jaw, and she was pressing her

lips to his. Pressing her body against his. Pressing her crotch against that great thing in his pants.

It felt so very strange, kissing a man who was not her husband. Sucking on his lips, slipping her tongue in his mouth. Breathing in his smell, running her fingers through his hair. It was all so different from Julian. So thrilling.

A police car went by, and whether or not it meant to specifically, turned on its siren just as it cruised past them—making the two of them nearly jump out of their skins in shock. But it wasn't stopping, there would be no police warning about public displays of affection that evening. They broke apart, laughing together a while.

Then they were together again, and he was kissing her neck, his hands moving to her breasts, while hers slipped down to his fine derriere, pulling him to her so that his large erection was crushed against the burning need between her legs.

Oh, it felt good. So tender, so sweet, so perfect. Daryl wasn't too rough, he wasn't too impatient, he wasn't inept like so many guys she remembered from college. He was just incredible, so composed, so calm and confident, intuitive about what she wanted, what she needed.

She felt like an inferno inside.

She was going to fuck him.

As she thought about it, she realized she hadn't texted Julian for ages. Part of her thought, to hell with it, she didn't need to tell him anything until later, until after. Yet part of her felt she owed it to her husband. This wouldn't have happened without him willing it. She would just have to find a moment to text him. In the taxi? At the hotel? In Daryl's bathroom?

How would Julian react?

Part of her still felt worried that he'd freak out, that he'd flip. That he'd feel jealous after all, that he wouldn't be able to deal with her transgression even if he'd urged her into it. Most of her, though, felt a quiet confidence that this was exactly what Julian wanted. That when she finally revealed all to him, he would be turned on like never before.

Then Daryl's phone rang.

He pulled apart from her, and apologized, pulling it out of his pocket with the intention of turning the damn thing off. Only, he saw who the call was from, or he saw a brief text from the caller trying to get hold of him, and he didn't turn the phone off.

“God damn,” he hissed.

“What is it?”

“I’m so sorry,” he said, looking up at her with agony in his eyes. “I think something’s happened to Billy.”

Now Kat’s own phone started ringing. It was Josie. Well, since Daryl had interrupted their little bit of passion for his phone call—and now he was calling whoever it was back—Kat felt she wasn’t being rude accepting Josie’s call.

“Hey, Josie,” she said.

“Kat... you’ve gotta help... he’s... unconscious...” Josie was terrified, struggling to get words out past her tears.

“What is it? What’s happened?” she asked, trying to get her head around what Josie was saying.

“I think we might be in trouble... he’s got blood pouring out of his nose...”

Chapter Thirteen

Waiting, waiting, waiting.

Julian found himself watching his clock closer than he had ever watched it before. He was very nearly tracking the seconds as the big hand went round and round and round.

So, ten minutes after her text announcing her exclusive rehearsal with Daryl, Julian sat there wondering if ten minutes might be enough time for them to sit alone in a room—alone in a building perhaps—before wanting to tear each other's clothes off.

Oh. He tried to watch the latest Star Wars spin-off movie on demand, and as much as he loved Star Wars, he couldn't pull his eyes away from that clock.

Half past eight. Was half an hour enough time for them to say 'to hell with this rehearsal' and just get down on the floor and rut like animals? Maybe not. They were both in rock bands, but Kat was 33 years old, if anything she'd drag him back to the hotel if he was willing. And it was what, ten minutes in a taxi back to the hotel?

He also imagined how it might be for the two of them, each probably a little nervous, since they weren't just banging fans or groupies or roadies or hookers, or whatever. They were both in the bands, and for the next few days they were even both in the same band. Neither wanted to sour their relationship with something slipshod and trivial.

This was an affair between co-workers, not a one night stand between strangers who met in a bar.

And Julian got the sense that both Kat and Daryl were dedicated to the music. Kat, he knew full well was going to want everything to be perfect ahead of the tour starting. Daryl—well, if the guy could listen to a few songs in a diner on his iPhone and then go into a room and just play with the band as brilliantly as Kat had described—then he had to be all about the music, too.

The road to nine-thirty was awfully slow. A watched pot never boils and a watched clock does just as little. Julian tried to relax and tell himself

that Kat and Daryl were probably immersed in the music, having so much fun playing guitar and drums they probably forgot the need to break for dinner. Ten-thirty, would be seven-thirty in California with the time difference. Not even particularly late for dinner.

The clock started moving a little more quickly as he managed to turn more of his focus to the Star Wars movie Rogue One. Eleven-thirty came along, twelve. That would be nine o'clock on the West Coast. Maybe they'd call out for pizza, continue rehearsing. Maybe Kat was having such a good time with Daryl that she simply forgot to text him to let him know how it was going. Julian didn't want to text her in case he interrupted anything.

Around 1am, he found himself nodding off to sleep. He picked himself up and staggered upstairs to get ready for bed.

Finally, at half past one—half past ten California time, he heard the familiar beep-beep of an incoming text message.

[Kat]: Hey honey, sooo sorry I haven't texted you this evening—everything suddenly went completely crazy... one of Daryl's bandmates got in trouble... we're in the hospital right now, so I can't text too long since we're not supposed to use our cell phones in here...

How about that for an intense message. Julian felt his eyes spin a little. Things were going well between her and Daryl... that was great. Then another member of Blue Tonic 'got in trouble'. What did that mean?

If they were at the hospital, then it had to be some kind of medical emergency, some kind of injury or health issue. Had one of Daryl's band mates had a car crash? Surely Kat would have just said he was in a car crash. The word 'trouble' kind of inferred that whatever had happened was of the guy's own making, he had been doing something a little wrong or even illegal, when some accident occurred.

Had the guy been doing some kind of extreme sport in the hills or mountains around LA? A sky-diving misadventure? Paragliding or scuba diving or something like that.

Why so vague about what had happened?

This was a rock band, though, so Julian's mind turned toward more likely culprits: drugs, alcohol. Some kind of overdose, perhaps. Kat wasn't going to state something like that explicitly, especially if the guy was using coke or some other illegal substance.

He felt somewhat disappointed that Kat wasn't going to call him that night—although he had something to hang onto, that it had been going well

with Daryl. Had they done anything? Had they slept together before news of Daryl's bandmate had filtered through?

So many questions, but he didn't feel like Kat would have time to deal with them just then. He texted her:

[Julian]: Sorry to hear about the problem, hope he's okay. Glad to hear it went well with D. Are you okay yourself? Miss you xxx

With that, he lay down in bed, even thinking twice about sticking on the television for a last-minute glance at some news or something before sleep arrived.

Then after a while,

[Kat]: I'm fine... but I'm sooo sorry I'm not going to be able to call tonight.

Julian had already made the assumption that Kat wouldn't be calling tonight. She had a good enough reason, it didn't phase him, although the long wait for her had not exactly paid off.

He replied to her:

[Julian]: It's okay, honey. I understand—how's he doing? He's not in any danger now he's in the hospital?

Kat came back:

[Kat]: I think he was lucky. The hospital wasn't far away and I don't think it was quite as bad as it could have been. Josie just got really scared, and needs me with her right now.

Julian felt suddenly very tired, as though someone had switched the off button on his energy levels. Most likely, he'd been keeping himself awake with the adrenaline of anticipation—and now it was clear that his wife's date was basically over, that adrenaline had evaporated.

[Julian]: I'd probably better leave you to it, honey, and get some sleep.

[Kat]: Thanks, honey. I'll call tomorrow, promise xx

And with that, Julian collapsed into sleep, somewhat disappointed but feeling that he had no right to be. He just had to hang on to the thought that until this crisis, his wife had been getting on very well with her potential new lover.

Chapter Fourteen

For a few days, it seemed hit or miss whether there would be a tour at all at the end of the week. They all had a day off to allow Josie to get over the shock of what had happened to Billy, and for Kat to help her.

Kat didn't even get to spend any of that day off with Daryl, since he went with Billy to the rehab center just out past Palm Springs. And none of them really wanted to leave the safe confines of their hotel with the media camped out outside demanding soundbites about Billy's situation.

The day they returned to the rehearsal room, Josie was still pale and quiet. The search for a drummer had been going about as well as the press coverage of their upcoming tour, so they had to do their best with an empty chair behind the drum set.

It was a serious low point. Blue Tonic had temporarily ceased to be, and the band had been the tour's key to gaining younger fans who weren't necessarily into The Ponytails or the surviving support band Viking Hoard, whose average fan was even older than that of The Ponytails. Along with the press coverage of Billy's health problems, the tour was also hit by the various rumors surrounding Blue Tonic itself—whether the band had split up, whether its members were basically facing the ends of their musical careers. The number of times TV news saw fit to interview distraught young fans who seemed willing to do themselves injury as a result of the possibility of Blue Tonic's end was astounding—they were hardly Justin Bieber or One Direction, for goodness' sake.

"I don't know," was all Josie could say to any question about the tour being actually viable. To give her credit, she still drove them on to get through the rehearsals, to practice and get the songs where they needed them. But it was hard work, seemed doubly hard work with the demotivation setting in.

Andrew, their tour manager, ducked his head in from time to time during the start of that second week—doing his best to keep them motivated by constantly insisting that ticket sales were still healthy in the run-up to the first gig on Saturday night.

Outside of rehearsals, none of them really felt like partying. Josie went to a couple of parties she was obligated to attend, but didn't get any favorable press to distract from the continuing headlines about Billy's brush with death and his tragic descent into addiction. Other than that, however, most of them spent time by hanging out at the pool, chilling out. There wasn't much of a celebratory atmosphere any more, despite the fact that the tour was apparently still happening.

Kat's evening FaceTime calls with Julian were simply affectionate updates on rehearsals, without the kind of sexual aspects they had been before Billy's crisis. She could tell he was disappointed that things hadn't progressed with Daryl, and that she basically wasn't having the riotous party lifestyle they'd expected in the run-up to the tour starting. But he was never anything but supportive of her.

They almost ended up talking more about Julian's work than of Kat's time in LA those few days, as astounding as that might seem, since there was nothing really to say about the wonderful world of paperwork. Kat didn't even understand what it was Julian did, although she knew it was something vaguely to do with vehicle insurance.

If things were bad for The Ponytails, then things were far worse for the remnants of Blue Tonic, who had been on the up and up before Billy had taken a dive. With their lead singer officially going into rehab for some extensive straightening out, all Blue Tonic had was a sketchy promise that once he was back to full health, the band would be re-joining the tour. Without Billy or Daryl around, the other two members, Paul and Raj, drifted around the hotel, or the rehearsal studios, like tumbleweeds in the desert breeze.

Things were looking bleak.

Then a funny kind of turning point seemed to occur, and none of them quite figured out how or why.

The Ponytails, much more than Refract, who had always kept to themselves a little more during rehearsals, no doubt since they were a little older, ended up almost adopting Paul and Raj. Alyssa had come to befriend Raj to some degree, although with her wedding ring firmly front-and-center, she always denied to gossip-hungry bandmates that there was anything other than a platonic understanding between bassists. Paul was also a really nice guy, although he didn't gravitate to any one member of The Ponytails. Nevertheless, the two of them spent more time hanging out with the

Ponytails during their rehearsals than not, and it almost seemed inevitable that they were allowed to join in when the women were not working hard on a particular sticking point in the track list.

The Ponytails and Blue Tonic kind of merged—and as well as the Blue Tonic members coming to know some of The Ponytails songs, the Ponytails started fooling around playing some of Blue Tonic’s back catalog.

It all seemed like a bit of fun until Josie had made the point that if Paul and Raj were still contracted—and paid, up to a point—to be part of the tour in its early stages, then there was no point why they couldn’t still be there during the early performances.

And by the middle of that week, it seemed that the two Blue Tonic members fitted so well with The Ponytails that it made sense that the two of them might join the established line-up for a few numbers during the performance—it might be a nice little surprise for Blue Tonic fans who still made the effort to attend the show.

Daryl returned overnight on Wednesday, and with no new drummer yet found for The Ponytails, he had simply returned to his seat behind the drum kit for them on Thursday morning, to a cheerful welcome from the others.

Andrew had come in that morning to find that The Ponytails had become a seven-person line-up.

“Since when did you guys become the Dave Matthews Band?” was his first question.

Then, “So... wait, wait, people. Are you The Ponytails... or Blue Tonic?”

But there was a crazy little smile on the man’s face as he watched the seven of them plough through some of the best-known Blue Tonic songs, and some of the better known Ponytails numbers, too.

Maybe he just sensed the new sense of brightness and energy in the room. They all noticed it, and it wasn’t just the energy between Kat and Daryl as they picked up their flirtation again. Josie seemed to gain a renewed mandate to drive the rehearsals forward, suggesting that they could stagger through the early stages of the tour until Blue Tonic was ready to return to form at some point before the tour reached the East Coast.

For those last few remaining days of rehearsals, however, Josie imposed a rigid schedule and restrictions on going out in the evening.

“Sleep, that’s what we all need more than anything now,” she said, looking particularly at Kat and Daryl. “And by that, I mean proper sleep.”

That evening, Kat had called Julian straight after rehearsals to update him on the latest goings-on, and while he'd politely asked after Daryl's wellbeing, and whether Kat might be spending a little more time with him personally, he hadn't pushed her on it when she'd said that Josie had all but ruled out any fooling around ahead of their all-important first gig.

Once the call was over, she'd donned her bikini and grabbed her towel to head down to the pool again, which had become something of a routine. Renee and Alyssa were already there, but so too was Raj, who seemed to be getting on well with Alyssa.

"The lovely Daryl was here looking for you," Renee said as Kat laid her towel down on a sun-lounger beside her.

"Oh," she said, feeling butterflies flickering in her stomach for the first time in ages. "What did you say to him?"

"That you were probably calling hubby. Was that wrong?"

"Oh, no," Kat shook her head, although inside she felt some slight concern that Daryl might have been given the impression that she was now off-limits to him and back solely in the possession of her husband. She tried to dismiss it as paranoia, the inevitable kind of worries when dating someone gorgeous was interrupted by some unforeseen crisis.

"Does Daryl know about Julian?" Renee asked, lying on her side to face Kat, and talking under her breath so nobody else could hear—but in doing so, making her question seem so very scandalous.

"Of course he does," Kat said, laying down on her towel, while taking a quick look at herself in her bikini to check things were as she'd want in case Daryl happened to return.

"But you didn't tell him... everything?" Renee grinned.

Kat smiled, getting the sense that Renee enjoyed knowing everything, that she alone was aware of all aspects of her relationship with both Daryl and Julian.

But, it was nice to have someone to talk about all of this with.

"I've told him most of it," she said, putting on her sunglasses as she lay back to soak up some of the evening rays. "I told him that my husband lets me do whatever I want with other guys..."

"Okay," Renee said. "But that's not all there is to it..."

"I've told him I'm still very much in love with Julian, and that we're still... very much... you know..."

"Fucking."

“Intimate.”

“And that didn’t put him off?”

“Nope. I told him Julian enjoys knowing I’m with other men, too.”

“Even though it hasn’t happened yet?”

“You know what I mean. And anyway, Daryl… figured it out.”

“That it’s a turn-on for Julian, your cheating on him?”

Kat smiled again, “It’s not really cheating if he lets me do it,” she said.
“If he knows I’m doing it.”

Renee nodded, and took in a deep breath of hot Los Angeles air. The pool was wonderful, surrounded by palm trees and lush green foliage, it made you almost forget there were more than six million vehicles driving around the city.

She said, “So are you gonna go find him? I’m sure he’d be up for a little… fun. Tonight.”

Kat felt the glowing embers of her desire stirred up within her chest, and between her legs. At the same time, she liked thinking that Daryl was in the process of looking for her, that she didn’t need to dash off searching for him like some desperate maiden. Even if she was desperate.

But she said, “We’re banned, remember? Sex ban. Dating ban.”

Renee giggled. “When did Josie ever stop you from fucking whoever you wanted?”

Chapter Fifteen

Julian was just lying down ready for sleep when his phone rang once again. It was unnerving because it was entirely unexpected. He'd already talked with Kat that evening, and signed off for the night. He was also well aware of Josie's sex ban, since Kat had moaned about it enough over the past day or two—particularly with Daryl back in town.

Unexpected phone calls could mean something bad had happened. And despite Kat's maturation and her clean living since the old days, one member of their support band had already gone to the hospital after an overdose. Julian's mind leapt to the possibility that Daryl the cute drummer might have led Kat into doing similar drugs—particularly if they weren't allowed to sleep together.

It was Kat calling, of course, according to his phone. He picked it up, though, and found an unfamiliar voice on the other end.

"Hey, Julian? You still awake?"

His heart sank at first, from jumping to the conclusion that if someone was using Kat's phone and it wasn't her, something bad must really have happened, she must have been incapacitated.

Then after a moment, he recognized Renee's voice, and that the tone of her voice was not upset or somber.

"No, this is a voice recording speaking," he said in his best imitation of a robot. "Please leave a message after the beep..."

"Oh, very droll. Touché, hubby, touché."

"You like stealing your bandmates' phones and dialing up their husbands?" he asked her.

"Well, beats the hell out of calling mine," she replied with a chuckle.

"What can I do for you?"

"You could get that beautiful cock out for me... tell me how it feels..."

Julian laughed. "Kat give you permission to sexually harass me on the phone?"

"Oh, well, okay then. Hey, look, I just wondered if you'd like to know what your darling wife is currently up to in the hotel swimming pool?"

Julian's ears pricked up. And his prick... well, it was up too.

"What?" he said, a frog in his throat. "What's she doing?"

"Well, let's just say a certain young drummer has entered the scene..."

Renee said, winding him up mercilessly. "And right in front of everybody... well... hey, you want to see?"

"Of course."

"You have FaceTime on this thing?"

"Sure—just use the app."

Julian felt his heart thump-thump-thumping at an increasingly rapid pace. A FaceTime call request came through on his phone, from Kat's account. He accepted the connection, and there he was, looking up into Renee's face and a very blue, cloudless sky behind her.

"Hey," he said as her pretty mouth curled into a warm smile.

"Hey, honey-bun," she said. "Okay, now I'm not supposed to be doing this, but if you don't say anything about it..."

The image flipped over as Renee pressed the button to switch to the camera on the back of the phone, and now he was looking at a cool blue swimming pool, as inviting as the blue sky overhead and the palm trees standing overhead. There were a few people dotted about on the sun loungers around the pool, but not too many. Behind, he could even see a hazy Los Angeles backdrop.

And there in the middle of the pool, he could see the recognizable form of Kat in her tiny blue bikini, standing several feet away from a dark-haired man, his upper body totally ripped, a Maori-style tattoo on his back, another on his right arm.

"You see?" he heard Renee's voice, barely more than a whisper, off-screen.

"Uh-huh," he said, not sure if she could hear him.

Julian couldn't hear what they were saying to each other, but Daryl was wiping water off his face and Kat seemed to be laughing at him.

Now Kat splashed water at him, once, twice, three times. It might have seemed aggressive if she hadn't been smiling broadly, flirtatiously. Daryl held a hand up to block the worst of the water, and chuckled, though Julian couldn't hear what he said. Then Kat suddenly launched herself through the water, front crawl, and Daryl took off after her—chasing her as she let out cute little squeals of delight.

They were like teenagers flirting on spring break.

Julian felt his hardness throbbing as he watched them. The clear delight on Kat's face as the younger man caught up with her, picked her up with strong arms around her near-naked body, and hurled her back into the water as some kind of sanction for splashing him.

She didn't give in, however, splashing him some more, pushing him to pick her up again.

Julian felt himself shiver at the physical contact between his wife and this other man, and yet it was so thrilling. He was so hard watching the two of them frolicking in the pool together, their attraction for each other undeniable, though they were apparently forbidden from consummating it—at least until the first show was over.

"You're really okay with all this?" Renee asked him, without moving the phone's camera away from the pool.

"Of course," he said.

"She's totally into him, you know."

"I know. I can see."

"She's gonna find it hard to keep him out of her bed before the first show."

"Maybe."

"And then after the show... well... she's gonna be all over him."

"Hopefully."

The view switched back to Renee's face—mouth open, eyes wide, eyebrows raised in half-serious surprise.

"You really don't have any reservations about this?" she asked him.

"Nope," he said. "Really. She can do as she likes."

"But she's got to tell you all about it."

"Uh-huh. That's the deal."

Renee sighed. "Where can I get a husband like you?"

"You'll have to get rid of the current one first, right?"

Another sigh from the pretty redhead. "Finding someone like you might even be worth all the hassle of ending things with the current one," she said, then seemed to remember that she was supposed to be showing him what was going on between Kat and her prospective lover.

The two of them were now standing much closer together in the pool, and apparently talking more seriously, no longer playing the flirty splashing and chasing game. What were they talking about?

So close to each other. They were looking into each other's eyes, totally absorbed by each other. Made Julian feel a little giddy again.

There was fire in Kat's beautiful dark eyes. And with the impressive resolution of the top-of-the-range cameraphone, Julian could see his wife's eyes flicking between Daryl's eyes and his lips. The two of them were moving together, their hands clasped. Noses just inches... just an inch apart...

They kissed.

Julian felt his heart skip a beat or two.

"God..." he heard Renee sigh in awe. "They are so good together..."

Kat draped her arms over his shoulders, wedging her face against his as she sucked on his lips, then her hands were moving up to run through his short, dark hair.

It felt so strange to watch—his natural jealousy welled up, and yet it only seemed to add spice to his arousal. As the guy moved one of his hands up to hold her head, and then started to kiss her neck, Julian felt the clear clutches of fear around his heart—and yet it was so exciting, it was such a turn-on to watch.

"How does it feel?" Renee said. "Watching them?"

Julian was almost too stunned to answer. That, and the fact that it was hard to put exactly what he was feeling into words.

"I don't know..." he said at first.

It was almost like sitting down to watch a horror movie you know is going to be seriously good. It's an undiscovered Stanley Kubrick movie. Or David Fincher has turned his hand to directing a Stephen King adaptation. And on your lap is a big box of the sweetest candy. There was trepidation, nerves, anxiety. And yet it was as though Christmas morning had arrived.

And while it was frightening to see the woman he loved in the arms of another man, it was so very delicious to see how excited she was, how ecstatic and nervous and fired up she was by the attentions of a new man.

"Are you... turned on?" she asked him.

He could see how his wife was pressing her breasts against the man's hairless chest, and knew just how small that bikini was.

"Yes," he told Renee.

"Are you... hard right now?"

He cleared his throat. "Yes."

Kat leaned back in the water, and Daryl was kissing down her chest, over the upper reaches of her breasts.

“But aren’t you... a little jealous?”

He said, “Maybe a little.”

Then she was up and kissing him again, arms wrapped around him, sucking on him so deeply, so passionately, with such need.

“Aren’t you worried... she might fall for him?”

He felt a slight tremor sweep through him at that question.

“A little,” he admitted.

“But you let them anyway?”

“I trust her,” he said.

And then as though fearing that she was going to spoil things, Renee seemed quick to add, “She’s not going to, by the way. She’s so in love with you... and he’s... well, he’s just a toy, isn’t he? A hot new toy...”

The hot new toy had his hands all over Kat’s breasts, and then they were sliding down into the water, over her butt, and perhaps even between her legs.

“People can see them,” Julian said, definitely worried about that.

“People are very discreet around here,” Renee said.

The way Kat was pressing herself against him... could she feel his hardness? Could she feel how big he was? His huge cock pressing against her almost-naked body?

Julian could hardly breathe, watching them. And they weren’t even doing anything all that scandalous yet.

“Are you stroking it?” Renee asked him quietly.

“What?”

“You know...”

He had been. Difficult not to, with what he was watching. And yet...

“Renee, you’re a bad girl, you know that?”

She giggled. “A girl’s got to try, though, right?” she said. “I mean, over-the-phone is, like, the closest I can get to a real live cock. The way my husband is.”

“Why don’t you just... you know... cheat on him?”

“He’d hear about it. Oh, somehow. He’d hear about it. Or he’d just ask me, and I’d be all blushing... I can’t lie to him.”

Was Daryl touching her? Sliding his fingers inside her? But they were in the middle of an open, public hotel swimming pool—even if it wasn’t

particularly well-attended.

Maybe they would move upstairs soon. Then the show would be over—it wasn't as though they'd take Renee with them.

“Okay... okay... show's over...”

He heard Renee groan in disappointment just at the same time that he heard the voice—and recognized it as Josie's—call out across the pool.

Kat and Daryl broke apart and looked up toward her, and Renee helpfully steered the camera phone so that Julian could, indeed, see that it was Josie who had just come out to the pool and decided that her lead guitarist was not going to do anything more with their new drummer that night.

“Uh-oh,” Renee cackled. “They're in trouble...”

Josie was giving them a real talking-to, though Julian couldn't quite hear what she was saying. The camera view switched back to Renee, or in this case her pale breasts, all bound up in a fetching bright red bikini top. Not an unpleasant view at all, though it made him wonder what was going on.

“Well, that looks like the end of it for tonight,” Renee said into the phone.

“They're getting out of the pool?”

“Well, Daryl is. Kat's started doing some actual swimming, like she was going to before Daryl turned up...”

“Can you get her to call me when she gets out?”

Renee laughed. “God, no. I wasn't supposed to show you that. Wasn't supposed to use her phone. As far as you're concerned, if she wants to call you... for her own reasons... well, she might.”

“Thanks, Renee,” he said, half gloomy she wouldn't do as he asked, half thankful that she had given him a glimpse of the developing love affair between his wife and her younger man.

“I think Josie's going to post a police guard outside your wife's door tonight,” Renee joked. “I guess the passion's over for now...”

The redhead was joking, and yet serious. Julian got the sense that the passion was probably over for the night. And if it wasn't, then it would be Kat's duty to reveal what happened. For now, he was going to get some sleep.

Chapter Sixteen

She couldn't sleep after that, she was so fired up.

Horny. As. Fuck.

How could Josie have busted them just at that moment? Admittedly, they'd been so close to actually fucking in the middle of a swimming pool, with strangers all around them, watching, it probably hadn't been the greatest idea. But maybe they'd have had the sense to go up to one of their rooms...

After that, though, Daryl had kissed her and left her with the view that "it's not worth upsetting Josie". And with everything that had happened to Josie recently, in terms of her new boyfriend's overdose, Kat was in full agreement with him. Unfortunately.

So here she was, up in her room, still wearing her bikini with just a tiny scarlet tank top slung over the top—her whole body on fire, pulsating with need for that goddamn sexy hunk. There was no way she was going to be able to get to sleep. Even masturbating in the shower wouldn't give her the release she needed after that.

After his oh-so-sweet kisses in the middle of the pool.

After the feel of his strong hands all over her body.

After pressing her body up against that big hard beast slumbering between his legs.

After two hours of tossing and turning, she felt she was going to either have to creep into Daryl's room, wake up Renee... or perhaps wake her husband.

In the end, she decided that although Julian had a very long day ahead of him, he would be able to sleep on the flight out to LA. Maybe being tired would even help him to sleep on the plane.

And maybe she did feel a little guilty, making out with Daryl and then failing to call Julian as soon as she got back to her room. It wouldn't have been so late for him if she'd called then.

"Hey honey... I'm so sorry to wake you..."

“Oh, it’s okay...” he was groggy, unkempt, still half-asleep, but he was far from angry that she’d woken him. He even smiled his delight at seeing her—something that reassured her no end as she perched slightly anxiously on the end of the bed in front of her laptop.

“I... you know... couldn’t sleep... and I thought I’d tell you what happened at the pool tonight,” she said.

“What happened?” he asked immediately.

Kat felt her guilt flaring up, and the fear that Julian would suddenly change his mind about her fooling around with another man. But she just had to persist at this stage.

“I was in the pool... and then Daryl came in with me... and then we were making out...”

“That’s great, honey!” he said, genuinely enthused, not at all upset. “You enjoyed it? He was... good?”

“Oh, God, yeah... he had his hands all over me... and I had my hands all over him... oh he’s so hot...” she looked suddenly apologetic, as though she’d forgotten it was her husband she was talking to.

“It’s okay, you can tell me,” he prompted her.

“Are you sure? It feels... strange...”

“It’s hot, hearing. You know it is. He’s a good kisser?”

“Very. It was... oh, so soft... and sweet... and feeling all his muscles... his body pressing against me...”

“Was he hard for you? Could you feel it?”

She smiled, and felt herself warming up considerably between her legs, just from remembering it, the feeling of Daryl’s huge, hard cock pressing against her, only a pair of swimsuits in the way. The knowledge that she was making him that hard, that someone so hot wanted to fuck her so badly. She felt such a craving for him now. For any guy, perhaps.

“He’s big?”

“I think so. I think very big.” Again, she flashed him another apologetic glance, but Julian was smiling boldly.

“I bet that got you going,” he said, beaming ear-to-ear.

“Uh-huh,” she said, feeling herself getting wet.

Julian was just sitting there.

“So... you’re okay with me kissing him?” she asked him, putting a slight edge into her voice to tease him, maybe even provoke him. Oh, she’d

asked the question before enough times to know the answer, even if she couldn't fully understand why he was so turned on by her infidelity.

"You know I am," he said, pointing out exactly what she was thinking.

"Show me."

"Huh?"

"Honey... I need to see..." she felt so dirty, begging him, but now she had a craving that needed some kind of release.

On her screen, her husband pulled the bedsheets off his body, revealing his bare chest, his boxer shorts. He wasn't exactly ripped like Daryl, but he wasn't too out of shape—in fact, he was more in shape than she remembered. Had he been working out? Even without the improvement, though, he had always been able to get her going.

Was there a tent in his boxer shorts already? She'd never known him quite so horny, all the time. Even when they were dating, it had taken her nudity plus a little touching or flirty talk to get him going. Ever since he'd revealed this most unlikely fantasy of his, it didn't take anything to get him going. She could have been wearing a boiler suit.

Was that the key to getting men going? Find out their kinks, their fantasies. Then, never mind all that makeup or perfume or expensive clothes, they would be putty in your hands.

Did Daryl have a secret fantasy?

"You know, I'll be with you in less than a day." Julian lay back against the pillows, a little awkward, not quite knowing what she wanted from him, plus a touch self-conscious at exposing himself on camera, even now. But still, delicious. She would have jumped him had he been in the room. Couldn't have contained herself.

"I know, honey," she said, "but he had his hands all over me..."

"Where?"

"Uh... you know... all over..."

"He was touching your breasts?"

"Well... through my bikini..."

"The one you have on under that top?"

"Uh-huh," she said, pushing out her chest for the benefit of the camera on top of her laptop. Enjoying how he looked at her with such lust. She peeled off the tank top, and true enough, the bikini top really didn't cover very much.

"Was he touching you in other places?"

“Uh-huh.”

“Your stomach?”

“Uh-huh.”

“Your butt?”

“Oh, yes.”

“Between your legs?”

“He was.” She stood, as though needing to show her husband, loving how he looked at her body, her bikini bottoms covering very little of her golden skin. “Through my swimsuit, though.”

On screen, her husband grabbed his package through those loose boxer shorts, and she felt envious that he could take hold of it. Now he was teasing her.

“Show me,” she insisted, swinging her hips a little as though dancing for him, as though she needed to entice him to take his cock out for her, like some kind of snake charmer. Spinning slowly around to show her butt in that tiny bikini.

He gave her a dry, amused grin. Guys weren’t usually so objectified by their women. They weren’t used to it. He grabbed his bulge again, through his boxers, and gave a confused frown as though to ask her, “this? Seriously? You want to see this?”

“Please?” she said, and reached behind her to unfasten the catch on her bikini top, allowing it to drop and then covering her breasts with her hands as though offering her exposure as some kind of reward for his.

He shrugged, and peeled off his boxer shorts, lying back again with nothing on, his substantial erection just waiting there, so hard, so ready, and yet so far away from her. She felt ripples of energy spreading out through her body, the desire quivering in her every muscle.

“So this sex ban of yours,” he said, putting a hand down to the base of his cock, holding the thing upright, stunning her with the size of it now it was no longer foreshortened by the perspective of the camera angle.

“Yeah?”

“It ends on Saturday night, right? When you play.”

Now she stooped to pull off her bikini bottoms, unasked. Hoping to get him going, to stir him to stroke that big, beautiful thing on her screen. He did so.

“That’s right,” she said. “Saturday night.”

“So what’s the plan for after the show?” he asked her.

She danced for him a little more, naked, enjoying his attention and the way he casually pumped his shaft to the sight of her.

“What do you mean ‘what’s the plan’?” Sitting back in front of the webcam, she had to catch her breath a little.

He said, “I’ll be with you until Monday morning.”

“Yeah,” she nodded, and now lay back on the bed, almost the same way he was, showing him her bare body, her breasts, her stomach. Shifting back, then parting her legs so he could see her pussy.

So she could see him reacting to seeing her pussy.

She said, “We need a plan? I’ll hang out with you. We’ll grab a late dinner or something, some drinks. Or we could just go back to my room.”

She slid a hand down over her stomach, over her bare mound, over the slippery wet folds of her sex, thinking about her husband coming to see her in LA, thinking about meeting up with him after the first show, as horny as she was now. Thinking about how they’d agree to abandon dinner or drinks or anything, except to head back to her hotel room to fuck each other’s lights out.

She stroked two fingers over her pussy lips thinking about how that delicious cock now in Julian’s hands would be in her hands soon enough. She’d take it into her mouth, and into her pussy...

“But Daryl will be around too, right?” Julian asked her.

“Uh... I suppose so.”

“You wouldn’t want to see him after the show?”

“Uh... oh... I don’t know... sure, maybe...”

She was finding it difficult to concentrate on the conversation now that her fingers were getting into the right rhythm, hitting exactly the right parts to get her on the road to climaxville.

“But I haven’t seen you in ages,” she said. “I don’t need him—just you, honey.”

He chuckled, “But you haven’t been with him at all. And you can.”

She looked at his stiff cock, and up at his excited face, and realized what he was hinting at. “You want me to see Daryl while you’re here in LA?” she asked him.

“I think you should,” he said.

“But I’d get to see you as well?”

He smiled, “Of course. It’s not an either/or proposition.”

And now she was touching herself while thinking about what her husband was actually saying. Thinking about spending time with Daryl—fucking him!—and then going back to her husband on the same night.

“You’d want me to... see him... and then you, the night of the show?”

“Sure. If you wanted to.”

She saw his cock twitch. The sight of it stoked the fires between her legs. “You want me to hang out with him for a while... and then maybe... sleep with him?”

“Sure.”

“And then after that... I’d come see you?”

He was really pumping that thing now. She loved it. Her words were making it twitch, throb, buck in his hands.

“Uh-huh.” Now he was finding it difficult to enunciate. She wanted to step it up—make him come with her words.

“I’d go back to his room, let him tear off my clothes,” she said, her lust making her feel bold, combined with the way he responded to what she said. “I’d pull down his pants and grab hold of his big, hard cock, suck it into my mouth...”

Julian was going for it, lying back and squeezing his shaft, wrestling with it, as he listened to her predictions about cheating on him with another man.

“I’ll bet he’d want to shove me back onto the bed and slide that huge thing inside me,” she said. “He’d push into me, stretching me with that thing. Filling me up... Mmmm....”

She giggled, “And then when we were done, you’d want me to come straight back to you, right? To tell you what happened?”

Julian grunted, and she watched him lose control of himself. So sexy. Why didn’t she do this more often with him? Particularly when it was him going away on business trips. He lay there and his cock was shooting out white cream all over his chest, all over his stomach.

And now she felt close to orgasm. It came almost from nowhere, a great shaking mass of warmth and energy, detonating between her legs and blossoming outward through the rest of her body—so intense, so powerful, so burning hot, and she hardly realized how frantic her hands were moving over her pussy, quivering against her clit, jamming in between her slick, wet pussy lips, plunging deep into her pussy.

She watched her husband squirting out his sticky white come all over his body in response to her informing him of her imminent adultery—and it all just seemed to overwhelm her.

Suddenly, she was bucking and writhing, and there was an intense jolt between her legs. And another. Cramps, almost. Spasms in the muscles of her sex. She looked down and saw unexpected movement between her body and the laptop. It happened again, and she caught sight of it—a little sprinkle of liquid shot out from between her legs.

“Oh God...” she wailed, thinking that something serious was happening, something wrong. She’d overdone the arousal, and now her body was broken. She’d have to call 911, get to a hospital. Maybe she had some terminal disease...

“Honey!” Julian was laughing.

“What is it?” she cried, desperately afraid all of a sudden. “What’s happening...?”

There was a moment where she thought she was even in pain—something had ruptured, something had burst, her pipes were leaking, her body ruined...

“You squirted!”

Squirted. She’d heard of that. Mythical, though, right?

She breathed, and strangely realized that it wasn’t pain she was feeling—but intense pleasure. She’d been taken somewhere she’d never been before when it came to sexual pleasure, and it was all from the thought of her husband actually wanting her to fuck another man, and that he would want her desperately afterward.

The sight of her husband so turned on by the thought of her adultery, and the fact that it could all be happening soon—it had taken her over the edge into sexual insanity.

“I don’t... squirt...” she insisted, breathless, gasping for air. Her crying had turned to laughing.

“Uh... you do. Saw it happening.”

The bedsheets were wet between her legs, and she could see patches of wetness on the carpet beneath.

“I can’t believe it...” she was saying, over and over.

“How did it feel?”

She turned her head this way and that, and the room seemed to spin a little around her. So light-headed. She felt suddenly drained, as though

some Vampire had come along and sucked out all her blood.

“I... I think I need to lie down,” she said.

Now covered up by bedsheets, Julian was chuckling, his amazement turning into amusement now that the moment had passed somewhat. “You need to get some sleep,” he said. “Only one more day of rehearsals, right? And then you have the show...”

“You’re coming to see me?” she asked him, suddenly worried that he might decide now she had Daryl in her life, he wasn’t needed.

“Of course,” he said. “I’ll be there really soon.”

“I can’t wait to see you.”

“Me neither. You’ll have to show me that new little trick of yours.”

“I... I don’t know... if I can...” So weird, what had happened. She was a grown woman, for God’s sake. Proceeding through her fourth decade. She should know her body from top to bottom, know exactly how it worked, how it responded, how it reacted. There shouldn’t be any new sexual discoveries left for her to stumble upon.

“We’ll see. Well, get some sleep, honey. I love you.”

“I love you too.”

“I’ll keep you updated on my flight...”

And then she was on her own again, and she found she had just enough energy left to pull herself back on the mattress, wrap herself in a bed sheet and collapse on a pillow before the sleep claimed her.

What was it going to be like, sleeping with Daryl? A new man. A stranger.

How was it going to be between her and her husband?

Chapter Seventeen

Friday evening. Julian had an eight o'clock flight from Logan Airport, and with the rush hour traffic it was a struggle to make the flight after work. Thankfully he'd packed fairly light, expecting warm California weather over the long weekend, and on this occasion he'd opted for business seats, which meant he could go through the express line at security.

Unlike the usual business flight, which he sometimes took when head office demanded his presence, this time he was accompanied by the most wonderful undercurrent of excitement.

It wasn't just that he was flying out to see his gorgeous wife after spending two weeks apart from her, although that was part of it. It wasn't just the thought of fucking her after two weeks of intense rehearsals—and with the big night not far away at all—that must make her so insanely horny.

No, it was also the fact that she was dating a hot young drummer, and although the two of them had only got as far as making out on their dates, something more adult was close by. These were rock stars, after all. Rock stars didn't keep their clothes on and quietly enjoy the conversational offerings of the opposite gender. They ripped off their clothes and fucked by the light of the moon.

"Can I get you something else to drink, sir?"

The flight attendant kept smiling at him in quite a flirtatious manner. It wasn't a very full flight, and in particular there weren't many people in the Business section, so he thought she had a little boredom to kill over the six-hour trip. As a younger man, he might have seen how far a little flirtation might take him in response—but something like this had never happened when he was a younger man. Frankly, he'd never been in Business when he was a younger man.

"Uh... sure. Just an orange juice, please."

"A drop of Champagne in there, sir? Something stronger?"

"No, thank you, just the juice would be wonderful."

A polite smile back at her, but Julian was remaining sober tonight. He was also keeping his eye closely on his phone, which thanks to his Business class seat was currently hooked up to the aircraft's Wi-Fi connection, through which he was able to receive text messages.

Sitting there in his private little business class booth, he was even quietly stowing a semi between his legs, and still he was all but ignoring the flight attendant, despite the fact that she'd unfastened yet another one of her shirt buttons to put a little more cleavage on display.

Shortly after they'd settled at 35,000 feet, Kat's text came in:

[Kat]: Going out with Daryl after rehearsal. Dinner, maybe more xx

Oh, he could have avoided reading anything into it. Maybe more. Maybe she was going to take him to bed, finally. Just before her husband turned up for a weekend visit. Julian kind of hoped so—after a couple of weeks of getting close to this guy, he was starting to worry that Kat might be entering the Friend Zone with Daryl. Maybe they wouldn't end up connecting on a sexual level.

And yet Kat had such a sweet crush on him.

Julian liked the idea of being there in LA when Kat took the final step toward becoming a shared wife, and actually became consensually unfaithful. But at the same time he worried that it might not happen at all—and maybe if she was scared away from it once, she might be always too frightened of the risk factor to embrace the sexual freedom he was offering her.

He texted her back:

[Julian]: You nervous?

It wasn't something he'd really asked her before, not when she'd spent time with Daryl before. Perhaps it reflected his own feelings just at that moment rather than the likelihood of hers. But, he also thought that if she did get the feeling they were headed for friendship territory, rather than bedmates territory, she would tell him she wasn't nervous at all.

[Kat]: Uh... yeah!!

He felt his manhood stiffen a little. Had to adjust his position in the seat as the blonde flight attendant—Mary, according to her lapel badge—returned with his orange juice.

While he waited for Mary to scurry away again, Kat seemed to feel the need to explain her previous text:

[Kat]: I am going out with another guy who is not my husband ;-)

Julian smiled, and replied:

[Julian]: It's not like you're doing it behind my back.

It wasn't as though he was a luddite, but he was so impressed how easy it seemed to communicate with his wife when he was 35,000 feet up and flying at 600 miles an hour.

[Kat]: No, but you have to admit it's a little scary.

[Julian]: Why?

[Kat]: Because you might not like it after all, after it's happened.

[Julian]: You really think that's likely by now?

There was a pause, and Julian wondered if she was with him right now, if they were perhaps just about to head out to dinner somewhere.

[Julian]: Where are you right now? Just wondering...

As Kat's silence continued, he actually started worrying that he was texting her too much, that she might find it difficult to conduct an actual date with such oversight.

But after ten minutes, she came back without seeming upset that he was firing off so many messages to her.

[Kat]: Just about to jump into a taxi to head to a nice seafood restaurant Daryl knows in Beverly Hills.

Then, after another moment:

[Kat]: You do know you're the best husband in the whole world? Xxx

That made Julian smile again, and his cock throb a little. Wasn't that part of this whole thing? The feeling that he was being generous to her, giving her a wild experience. He was living a little through her, vicariously, sure, that she was getting to live the excitement of dating all over again, and the thrill of a new sexual partner. But it was also the thrill that he was the cause of her excitement, and when another man made her feel good, it was really Julian making her feel good.

It wasn't too strange a thing. Most men—those who weren't completely narcissistic, anyway—gained pleasure in sex from making their partner satisfied. Sex was somewhat flat if your partner did not enjoy it as well as you did.

This was like making sure Kat was satisfied sexually, and then swooping in to enjoy her himself.

He sat there on the plane trying to think what a modest, and yet truthful reply might be. He could have just signed off and wished her well for her date—but he wanted to keep texting with her, and leave it to her to

decide when she needed to stop and focus on her date. The best he could do was change the subject slightly:

[Julian]: You think you might be out with him late? Or you might need the room—because I can just get my own room when I get to the hotel

[Kat]: Josie's banned us from late nights and dating before the first show—she wants total focus on the music—so it should be okay, honey :-)

[Julian]: Banned you from dating? That's disappointing.

[Kat]: And sex. Can you believe it?

[Julian]: How does she define 'sex'? Maybe you can get away with third base? ;-)

Once again, Kat didn't reply immediately to that suggestive text of his—leading his paranoia to imagine all kinds of situations where he might have offended her. He just had to keep calm and realize that she was on a date with another guy now, she could hardly keep texting him non-stop.

Was she in the taxi with him now? Or in the restaurant?

Deep breath. Mouthful of orange juice. Maybe she had only been teasing him with the thought that something other than dinner might happen between the two of them. He felt the need to temper his expectations.

Then, at last,

[Kat]: In the restaurant, waiting for food. Seems like a nice place :-)

Julian texted her the question on his mind:

[Julian]: Does Daryl know you're texting me right now?

Her reply came quickly:

[Kat]: Sure, he knows. He doesn't mind—I can talk and text pretty much at the same time.

Julian wondered if she was just being nice, making him think it was okay for her to text him as much as she was doing. Maybe it wasn't even for his benefit, but to help her deal with her nerves. Texting her husband seemed safe when she was out on a date with someone else in a manner that some might suggest risked her marriage.

[Julian]: He really doesn't mind?

[Kat]: Really. He thinks it's kind of cute I'm keeping you in the loop.

Julian scratched his head. The guy thought it was 'kind of cute'? For a moment, he sat back in his comfortable Business seat and closed his eyes, trying to imagine how he might feel to be going out with a beautiful, married woman who had every intention of keeping her husband updated on her date.

He tried to imagine how he might have felt being younger, being in Daryl's position.

Kat was undoubtedly attractive, much more attractive than most. A lot of guys would probably give their right arms to be able to sleep with her. But more than that—Kat was out on a first date, or at least an early date. Pre-sex date. She was nervous, excited, bubbly in her anticipation of possibly getting laid. It probably made her extra beautiful. And her excitement was possibly contagious.

Maybe it would be kind of hot that she's sitting there across from you at a restaurant table texting her husband about potentially going to bed with you.

[Kat]: He says to tell you thank you for letting him date me ;-)

Julian felt a sudden burst of heat inside his chest, and his cock swelled inside his pants. God. He texted her back:

[Julian]: Thank him for me for taking such good care of you :-)

[Kat]: He says you're welcome :-)

[Julian]: So do you think you two are going to try to flout Josie's dating ban?

[Kat]: I don't know. Josie's pretty scary when you break her rules. Sorry... food's here.

Julian smiled, and managed to hold himself back from touching the sizable bulge in his pants. The flight attendant, however, had been dealing with one of the two other people in Business Class and now glanced back at him, and he swore she saw the tent in his pants.

"Would you like something to eat, now, sir?" she said as she approached him.

He sat up and pulled the table over to conceal his anatomy. "Uh, sure."

"Did you get a chance to look at the menu?"

He ate, feeling a sense that he might as well eat while Kat and Daryl ate. He wouldn't be missing out on too much. The questions continued to swirl around his head—would the two of them do something that evening? Was Josie intending on maintaining her sex ban beyond the first show?

It was half an hour before Kat's next text.

[Kat]: Daryl's so nice, I think you'd like him if you met him.

[Julian]: Maybe I will some time over the weekend.

[Kat]: I can't believe Josie imposed a sex ban on us.

[Julian]: Can't you just get a room in another hotel?

[Kat]: Not with the media running around looking for us at the moment :-)

After pausing to allow Mary to remove his plate from dinner, Julian was about to text to suggest Kat sneak away to some unused part of the hotel—perhaps there was a conference center, but it was far too late for conferences. But Kat came back:

[Kat]: We're back at the rehearsal studios, Daryl left his favorite drumsticks behind.

It seemed perfectly innocuous—so much so that Julian hardly gave it much thought as he fended off the flight attendant's attempts to get him to order some kind of dessert.

Then:

[Kat]: Don't laugh, but I'm so wet right now. Had to go to the restroom to sort it out.

Julian was certainly not laughing. He was suddenly peering closely at his phone while pulling a blanket over his lap to hide the signs of arousal down there.

He texted her back:

[Julian]: Any media staking out the rehearsal studios?

[Kat]: No, none. It's too late. They think we're all at the hotel. Studios are a little creepy this late. Daryl's found his drumsticks. Don't think we can stick around here long before Josie starts getting suspicious—she already tried calling me just now.

[Julian]: She won't mind if you're a little delayed because Daryl couldn't find his drumsticks?

He felt his pulse racing—if Kat was so horny, and the two of them were alone in the rehearsal studios, surely it was an okay place for something fun to happen? It felt weird just to be suggesting it to her, though.

[Kat]: I might have to keep him from leaving for a few moments...

[Julian]: Have fun, honey xxx

[Kat]: I love you. Are you sure you're okay with this?

[Julian]: Of course. And I love you too xxx

[Kat]: I don't have to do anything with anyone if you won't want me to.

[Julian]: I'm probably more excited than you are at the moment!

[Kat]: I can't believe that! ;-)

[Julian]: Go get him xxx

And with that, there were no texts from Kat for a little while. Julian felt strangely light-headed, but in a good way. Elated, he would have said. The flight crew had turned down the lights in the plane to let those customers who wanted to sleep to get some shut-eye. Under his blanket, Julian quietly stroked himself, very gently, as he imagined what might be going on between Daryl and his wife in that rehearsal studio.

Was he taking her standing up, against a wall somewhere? Lying with her on a sound stage. Sitting while she bounced up and down on his lap?

Julian's phone buzzed, and he lifted it up to find that Kat had not only texted him, but had texted him with a picture—a picture of a big, hard cock with her hands wrapped around it. He nearly came right there and then. They were unquestionably her hands wrapped around the cock in the picture. Kat hadn't taken her wedding rings with her on tour, but Julian knew every inch of his wife.

Oh God...

Julian texted her:

[Julian]: He's big, huh?

If he was honest, he really didn't know what to say. He felt aroused like never before—like he'd attained some level of sexual energy that made him into some kind of master. And yet, he resisted whipping his own cock out right there in Business Class—even with the blanket concealing it.

A short while later, his phone buzzed again.

Another photo. Julian gasped.

This time, there was that same large fully-erect cock, but this time Kat's lips were touching its tip, kissing it or just about to slide it inside her mouth. Wow. In the photo, you couldn't see much of her face—only her mouth and a little of her jawline—but there was no way it could have been anyone else. And he recognized her shirt, too.

His wife was sucking on another man's cock. Did this make her an adulteress? At what point did you call it adultery?

He glanced around the plane, even peered around the corner of his booth to catch a glimpse of people sitting back in economy plus. He felt strange, buzzing, feverish almost. His wife was cheating on him. His wife was having an affair. His wife was unfaithful. Could anyone else tell that about him?

For a moment he felt dizzy, even out of control. Like someone who had just jumped off a skyscraper and then moments later changed his mind

about killing himself. No way to back out now.

It seemed like a major—and yet subtle—shift in his whole life.

And yet, there was no anger. He wasn't really jealous. There was plenty of fear, but when he thought everything through once again, he started to calm down again, he started to come to terms with it. The arousal, the exhilaration started to rebound, to surpass the negative feelings.

Another picture came through.

This time, Kat's lips were stretched around the man's dick, he was inside her. Julian felt his own cock throbbing inside his pants, desperate for escape, but while he was so very excited, it was also shocking to him. It made his heart thump like bad dance music, and suddenly it seemed difficult to breathe, as though the oxygen was too diffuse in the air.

Wow, wow, wow.

It was only sucking a man's cock, but it was so insanely powerful an image to him. He'd seen plenty of pornography in his time, and this just made everything else pale in comparison. It was like he'd only ever seen charcoal drawings of sex before, and now for the first time he was seeing full color, high-definition photography depicting it.

His wife. Katalina Dennis née Espinoza. Sucking a man's cock, and it wasn't her husband's.

Here was another picture, this time of her licking that huge thing, its tip shiny with her saliva. Her hands were holding its base—it had to be Daryl taking the pictures for her. Jesus. He really was complicit.

And now, another picture. Her hand squeezed around his girth, just beneath the head of his cock. And... was that come? Dribbling out, a last trace of white cream.

[Julian]: Did you swallow, honey?

He wondered if she was even registering his text replies. Maybe Daryl was just firing off pictures, and sending them to her husband.

He waited, hardly daring to look back at the pictures she'd sent, in case Mary or another flight attendant—or even a passenger—might see him looking at them.

Then, at last, a text message from Kat:

[Kat]: No more time left, gotta get back to the hotel! You still love me, sweetie?

Julian chuckled.

[Kat]: I swear, I actually came just from sucking it.

And then, as though she needed to underline why:

[Kat]: His cock is so unbelievably big :-)

Julian looked at his flight map on the screen in front of him. Two more hours' flight time.

[Julian]: Of course I still love you. I can't wait to see you... flight has two more hours to go.

[Kat]: Two hours... I'll be waiting for you, sweetie. Are you hard for me right now?

[Julian]: Very.

[Kat]: Mmm... can't wait to take that in my mouth. And in my pussy. I'm so wet right now

[Julian]: You can't take him back to your room?

[Kat]: My room's too close to Josie's!

[Julian]: Or some shady corner somewhere?

[Kat]: I'll just have to wait until after the show.

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Chapter Eighteen

She met him at the airport, something she hadn't done in a long while. Looking absolutely gorgeous in a denim mini skirt and a skimpy pink top, with thigh-high boots. She was glowing, even with the lateness of the hour, even with the fact that she'd had a busy day, a busy evening. She'd sucked on another man's cock.

And wasn't that last thing what was on his mind as she met him? As she flung her arms around him? As she pressed her lips to his, and he swept her up into a passionate, urgent kiss?

She'd showered, she smelled fresh, citrusy, the unmistakable fruitiness of shampoo. But those lips had stretched around another man's cock earlier that evening. She might not, technically, be unfaithful yet, but her pretty mouth was. Julian felt his erection rise so full inside his pants as he kissed her, it was hurting a little.

Her eyes were blazing as they finally parted—or at least, parted at the lips. They continued to hold each other. And it wasn't so long before Kat realized what he was concealing inside his pants—and now she was pressing herself against it.

"You don't hate me, then?" she asked.

"Of course not," he chuckled, and kissed her again. "Why would I possibly hate you?"

"Because another man came in my mouth a couple hours ago," she said, catching Julian somewhat off guard by such a blunt response.

"Shhh!" he said, glancing around them in case anyone had heard. No one had, apparently. Everyone else was too busy in their own stories, embracing loved ones or just pushing on toward their own routes home.

"What, you embarrassed that your wife just sucked another guy's cock?" she said, grinning at the horrified expression on his face.

She giggled, "Hey, it's okay. Nobody cares."

She locked her arm in his and now led them away toward the short-term parking lot. He said, "You won't be talking like that at the airport later in the tour. When you're filling stadiums."

“Stadia,” she corrected him. “I doubt we’ll actually fill them, though. Even at the end of the tour.”

“You’ve got to have confidence. You guys are amazing.”

“But we’ve lost Blue Tonic.”

Julian chuckled, “They’re just a support band. Can’t you find another?”

“We were lucky to get them—they have a pretty crazy fan-base, you know that? Grass roots movement, almost.”

“Maybe Billy will get out of rehab in time.”

“We can hope.”

For a moment, he noticed just how tired she was. Then she looked at him and broke out into another big smile, as though she’d just reminded herself that he was here, and that even if things didn’t turn out the way everybody hoped, it was still something of an adventure compared to being a music teacher at some high school in suburban Kingston.

“The important thing is,” he said, “You have Daryl. Right?”

“That’s the important thing?” she giggled. “I thought it was more like, we have each other. You know, you and me. A sweet marriage.”

“Oh, that’s important,” Julian chuckled as they headed through the automatic doors out of the terminal building, heading toward the concrete parking garage. “But it’s not the important thing about this tour of yours.”

“And here I was thinking this tour was all about the music!” she laughed out loud.

“It’s about the music,” he nodded, smiling himself. “Just not all about the music.”

“You are just a big, horny man,” Kat said, totally amused, and thankfully diverted from the gloom.

“So you think we should get back to the hotel and deal with that?”

“I’ve told you,” her eyes blazed. “I’m not allowed to.”

“Tell that to the cock you just enjoyed.”

She rolled her eyes at him, but he could see just how buzzed she was, just how completely hyper she was about the whole strange cock thing. Wasn’t that what all this was about for him?

It was a nice, warm night. Julian felt seriously tired after a long day, and considering the time difference, it was well into the early hours for his body, even if it was only midnight or so for Kat. So when they got to the

hotel, and up to the room, and Kat was showing him where everything was, Julian just ended up collapsing on the bed, anyway.

But, even with sleep hitting him so hard, he was thrilled to be there. Thrilled to be with her. Thrilled that they were on this adventure—that she was now virtually confirmed as a naughty wife.

*

And then came the day of the first show.

To start with, Kat and Julian were woken by a hammering on the door. Julian pulled himself groggily out of bed to open it, only for an excited redhead to bound through into their room.

“It’s today!” she was squealing, and Julian found her rolling around the bed with Kat, excitedly.

“Renee, are you serious?” was all Kat could say, although the excitement of her luminous red haired bandmate was infectious.

“Are you kidding?” Renee said, “Don’t you know what day it is?”

She made it seem like Christmas morning, and she was seven years old again. In a way, it was like Christmas morning. Julian felt it, too, though he wasn’t playing in the band. For him, the excitement stemmed from the possibility that after the show, his wife would be free to engage in a little naughty fun with her new lover.

Still a little tired, he slumped by the room phone and ordered breakfast via room service, for three. Once done, he returned to the bed, to find Kat and Renee by the wardrobe, apparently trying on outfits. They were a similar size, so the outfits were interchangeable.

The surprise was the willingness of Renee to strip in front of him, right down to her birthday suit.

He had to cover himself up in the bed sheets to avoid revealing his response to the sight, but when Kat laid eyes on him, he could only look at her back, wide-eyed and open-mouthed.

“It’s nothing you haven’t seen before,” his wife told him. Julian chuckled—this was his wife explaining why he should be allowed to watch another woman strip naked in their room. Things had gotten strange in this marriage.

He supposed there had been all that FaceTime stuff with Renee. Even so, this was in real life.

“You should be giving me a show, too,” Renee complained, peering at his loins, and the way he was obviously covering something up with a mound of sheets. “Fair’s fair, right?”

But Kat handed her some more clothes to try on, and distracted her.

Breakfast arrived, and Julian had to carry a pillow to conceal himself from the room service guy as he opened the door for him. Renee wasn’t worrying about covering herself, however.

Then they were all sat on the bed, tucking into a spread of fruit and pastries and pancakes, and it really did feel like Christmas without the presents.

“So what’s the plan for tonight?” Renee asked them.

“Tonight?” Kat prompted her.

“You know...” Renee’s eyes glimmered, “after the show.”

“After?”

“With a certain... drummer?”

Kat looked at Julian, and then laughed. “I don’t know,” she shrugged, and Renee’s clear disappointment brought out a broad smile across her face. “I guess we’ll play it by ear...”

“But you are seeing him, right?” Renee inquired, not worrying about the niceties. “I mean... tonight’s the night, right?”

Kat looked at her husband again and shrugged. “We’ll see what happens.”

“Seriously?” Renee was finding it hard to conceal her frustration. “But you guys... are going to... you know... aren’t you?”

“Maybe.”

“Maybe?” Renee rolled her eyes and whimpered. “If it was me... I’d already know exactly how it was going to go down.”

“You should ask your husband...” Julian suggested.

Renee gave him a sharp look. “I’ve told you about him,” she said. “He’s not much like you, honey. It’s why I have to live vicariously through you guys...”

Kat sighed, “I don’t know what to say,” she said, feeling Renee’s frustration. “I guess... if we have enough energy left after the show... maybe tonight might be a good time...”

“Are you kidding? You are always so buzzed after a show,” Renee grinned wickedly. She looked at Julian, “And you’re still okay with all of this? With your darling wife submitting to another man?”

Now it was Julian's turn to shrug. "Sure," he said.

"Seriously?" Renee yelled at no one in particular, steaming up with pure frustration that she was not blessed with a husband with a wife-sharing fantasy.

Julian, though, felt a little of the frustration that Renee felt about not really knowing whether, or when it was all going to happen. When was Kat really going to go all the way with Daryl? Surely she had no reason not to, now?

After breakfast, the two women were getting ready to go out, and though Julian felt a little shut out of it as they were talking clothes and makeup, when Kat hit the shower, and Renee ended up joining her, he was at least offered a fairly sensational show.

Oh, they weren't getting affectionate in there, but here was Renee helping Kat to shave her pussy, and it wasn't for her husband's benefit.

"You've got to make sure," Renee was saying as her attentions with the razor made Kat giggle.

"It tickles!"

"You want him to spend time down here, right?"

"I don't know..."

"You do, trust me."

Julian just felt speechless watching them. She really was going to fuck someone else, right? It was really going to happen.

Then the two women were finally gone, bearing suit carriers in which their chosen outfits were kept for the show itself, climbing into limousines for once, heading off for final rehearsals and soundchecks and then the show itself.

Now Julian felt really nervous—the next time he would see his wife would be at the show, and the next time he would actually speak to her, face-to-face, would be after the show, and that might be when she decided to go off with Daryl.

Was he going to find out what it truly felt like for his wife to be unfaithful? What if he hated it after all?

Chapter Nineteen

What a show. Afterwards, during a quiet moment, Kat told him that the addition of the members of Blue Tonic to The Ponytails had just given them a more powerful, sophisticated sound than usual. It had even given Josie pause for thought in terms of their permanent line-up once Blue Tonic was fully back to business.

It was only an extra guitar and an extra bass in Paul and Raj, since Daryl was effectively replacing Jacqueline on drums—but somehow it was like swapping out a string quartet for a full orchestra.

The fans had gone nuts for it during the show. Even the long-term purist stuck-in-the-muds, the kind who only listened to Led Zeppelin on vinyl. Even the younger fans, who had presumably bought tickets because of Blue Tonic, were suddenly into it.

Julian had spent the show out in the crowd, enjoying the music from where it was supposed to be enjoyed. In that tiny theater there weren't any seats, but it was all worth the hardship of standing throughout. The vibe among the crowd—even though it was a fairly small crowd—started fairly neutral, but quickly grew to superb heights as The Ponytails came on.

The band played for ninety minutes, took a break, and then a final 45 minutes stretched to more than an hour with all of them having fun.

Flashing his pass in the faces of the burly security guards, Julian went backstage during the break to catch various members of the band floating around, seeming high as kites on the raw excitement of it all. There was Kat, who pounced on him the second she saw him, her eyes blazing with excitement and, no doubt, lust. She kissed him frantically before finally coming up for air. He looked her up and down, she was looking amazing wearing a barely-there leather mini skirt and a glittery camisole top with high-heeled ankle boots.

“Jesus, I needed that,” she said, wiping her lips. “Sorry I’m a little sweaty.”

“Oh, it’s okay,” he said with a huge grin. “Show’s going well, then?”

She nodded, and gave another broad smile, “We’re having a ball,” she said. “I guess there’s a kind of sense this time that it might not last, so we’re just having fun in the moment, you know?”

“It’s working,” Julian said.

“So it looks okay from the fan’s POV?”

“It looks amazing. Incredible. And I’m not just saying that...”

Julian saw Josie storm over to his wife, looking not entirely as contented as she might. The blonde flashed him a mild apologetic glance for interrupting them, but then said to her bandmate, “The audience are all holding up cameraphones.”

“Yeah... I guess some of them are,” Kat said, warily like she hadn’t really thought about it.

Josie gave a fierce sigh, “There’s clips going up on YouTube already.”

“Seriously?” Kat looked at her husband and gave a slight shrug, in surprise but also kind of ‘what am I suppose to do?’

Josie said, “You think we can get Andrew to order YouTube to take them down? Maybe some kind of legal threat...”

Kat said, “It’s really not going to affect much...”

Josie gave a pained expression and shook her head, “If everybody’s watching it on YouTube, what’s the point of going to our next show? Any of our shows?” she sighed again, angrily. “It’s all those Blue Tonic teens.”

“Well, there’s nothing much we can do right now,” Kat said, a little concerned that Josie was going to pull down the mood of the night. “Even if Andrew gets some kind of response from YouTube, it’s not going to happen before tomorrow. Maybe even a few days.”

Josie said, “Maybe I should make an announcement? Like, we’re not going to do any more songs unless everybody puts their phones away?”

Julian turned at the sound of an excited squeal, and was a little surprised to have someone else pouncing on him—after a flash of bright red, he quickly came to discover that it was Renee.

“Well we can’t all have delicious husbands here to keep our spirits up,” she said as Julian, laughing, asked why she had to pounce on him and hug him like some long-lost lover.

He glanced over to Kat, who was still in fairly serious conversation with Josie, and his wife briefly turned to flash him a smile, clearly amused at how much attention he was getting from the red-headed keyboardist.

“So how’re you feeling?” Renee asked him, speaking suddenly more quietly, almost furtive.

“Oh, great,” he said, “I’m having an amazing time—the music is just —”

“Not about the music,” she shot him a sharp look. “Tonight.”

“Tonight?”

“After the show.”

“After—”

She rolled her eyes at him briefly. “You know... there’s a party after the show, remember? And then after that... Kat gets to finally go... you know... hang out with Daryl...”

Julian felt a sudden burst of heat swamp his chest, his stomach burning with a touch of acid. He knew what Renee was talking about—but had something been agreed? He’d thought Kat hadn’t decided what was going to happen that night.

Oh, it wasn’t a bad feeling he got, overall. It was intensely exciting to think that it really might happen that night, and his cock suddenly seemed to wake up within his pants.

But he was filled with more than a little trepidation along with the arousal.

“You mean they’re...” he said.

Renee immediately said, “Of course I do—she’s been banned from anything for days, and now they get to be together?”

Julian raised his eyebrows and sucked in a chestful of air that smelled vaguely of sweat and dry ice. “I guess... that’s great,” he said, cautiously.

“So what will you be doing while they’re... you know...?” Renee asked him.

He looked over at Kat again, but she was too focused on what Josie was saying—and now Andrew the tour manager was with them—that she didn’t look back at her husband this time.

“I guess... I’ll wait for her... back in our room...”

“On your own?” Renee looked concerned.

He shrugged and smiled, and embraced the warm, exhilarating feeling that was stemming from his thickening cock. “It won’t be that bad,” he insisted. “I mean... you know... this is what I want.”

“Jesus,” Renee hissed. “Why could I never get a husband like you?” Then she added, “I’m going to make sure you’re okay. Right?”

He wasn't sure what she meant, but he nodded and thanked her for her concern. Then they were all going back on stage, and with people all around him moving this way and that, Julian felt as though he were caught in an eddy in the middle of a fast-flowing river.

Finally, it was all kicking off again. He pulled out his phone to look up what was going onto YouTube, and sure enough there were plenty of clips going on. Loads of views, too, and shares.

"What do the numbers look like?"

Julian looked up from his phone to see Andrew standing next to him, as things were finally quietening down backstage.

"The—?"

"The numbers... on YouTube," Andrew prompted.

"Uh... looks like... thirty-four thousand and something on this one..." he wasn't sure if it was best to round up or round down on the figures—whether Andrew wanted a big number or not judging by his face.

"Thirty-four... are you kidding me?" the tour manager's face was like thunder for a few moments.

Then he broke into a huge great smile. "That's great!" he said.

"I thought Josie said..." Julian was confused.

Andrew shook his bald head. "No... she's wrong. We need all the attention we can get, I swear. All these people whipping out their phones... they're telling other people what a wild time they're having here..."

"Great," Julian said, unsure if this was real, or if Andrew was looking for some silver lining.

Andrew stomped off, and Julian found himself suddenly remarkably alone—it felt as though he shouldn't really be there. Nobody was monitoring him, no one making sure he didn't suddenly run out onto the stage or something. Well, he was a trusted family member, he supposed.

He could hear the sound of Alyssa and Raj warming up their bass guitars, and the crowd certainly sounded expectant. The music was about to get going again. But then just before he darted out of there to return back to the main floor to catch the rest of the show, he leaned back to look out onto the stage from the wings—and he saw a couple just off-stage, clinched in a passionate kiss.

It was Kat and Daryl.

Julian's heart started thumping, hard. Hard enough to make him question whether his diet included too much cholesterol. Wow. He'd seen

the two of them kissing before via a mobile phone, but this was real, just yards away. His cock was suddenly granite-hard.

The guy was handsome, even as a heterosexual male, he could appreciate why his wife might have a crush on the drummer. But the way they held each other, their bodies somehow fitting together perfectly like they were made for each other—it was both beautiful and terrifying for Julian.

Was this how it looked when he kissed his wife? He couldn't help but feel that when he kissed her, it wasn't quite as intense as this.

Was the guy hard for her? Could she feel it pressing against her?

Then they parted, offering each other dazzling smiles before they finally broke out into the lights of the stage and full public view. Julian watched Daryl taking his place behind the drum set, while Kat returned to her place next to Paul-from-Blue Tonic and picked up her guitar. And it was as though nothing odd had just happened at all.

But Julian could feel it. He could feel the inevitability of Kat wanting to be with Daryl later that night, and it both thrilled him immensely and terrified him to his bones.

Chapter Twenty

The second half was even better than the first half, if that was even possible. At least as far as Kat was concerned, anyway. And it was only partly due to that incredible kiss she'd stolen from Daryl just before they'd gone back on stage.

He was just incredible. As a drummer, and as a kisser. He made her feel all melty and syrupy inside. He gave her those light-and-airy butterflies in her stomach, the fluttering of their wings sending little pulses of energy to her stiff nipples, and down between her legs.

It was like she'd felt when she'd first met her husband. Or when she'd first properly discovered boys back in school.

Back on stage again after the break, that oh-so-brief taste of Daryl had her feeling all buzzing and fizzing—but beyond just being horny as usual, somehow it turned the playing of the music into a sexual thing for her. She wasn't just turned on, she was being sexually pleased while in the middle of all that music, the lights, the vibrations underfoot, the adulation of the fans. She'd never quite known anything like it.

And there were even couple of minor orgasms in there—once at the bombastic peak of Everything's About You, and then once again at the very end as she wrapped up the show with the band's most famous guitar solo as part of their biggest hit of all.

She caught sight of Julian in the audience, seemingly having a fantastic time himself, and somehow felt so connected to him just then. She felt such a strong bond, and had no doubt that part of it was the fact that he had given her all this—not just by allowing her to take time away from her day job to attempt a band revival, but also by insisting she enjoy herself with Daryl, and whoever happened to come after him on tour.

This sexual pleasure might have been drawn out by Daryl, but it was ultimately sparked by Julian.

And at the end of the day, she knew—or strongly expected considering what he had been saying over and over—that after she had been with Daryl,

she'd go back to her husband and he would be ecstatic about her adventure with another man. His one big sexual fantasy would be coming real.

It was the thought of going with Daryl—and then afterward, of seeing Julian—that meant that when the show finally came to a close, Kat was still buzzing as though it was still only the beginning of the night. She came offstage and there was a whirl of energy around all the people there, the friends and relatives, the tour crew, all totally delirious about how everything had gone.

Even Josie was happy, with Andrew bounding over her to tell her about all the social media buzz they'd been getting already. The YouTube clips weren't causing spoilers, it seemed. They were encouraging people to buy tickets for the next show, the one after, the one after that. They were translating directly into sales on iTunes of their available songs and albums.

"The Blue Tonic fans are in melt-down," Andrew was laughing. "They're all coming out of mourning after what happened to Billy, because their guys are right up here on stage all the same. With you girls!"

The funny little man was dancing around like some kind of Persian leprechaun.

Meanwhile, everything was whirling around Kat, and she almost missed Daryl coming right up to her and grabbing her and kissing her as though there wasn't a care in the world and the two of them were a couple. As much as she enjoyed it, she had to warn him off—they weren't a couple, not in public.

Daryl simply chuckled, "After the party, gorgeous," he said with a glimmer of fire in his baby blue eyes, and she nearly came there and then again, just from the look of pure lust he gave her.

Then Julian was there again, and her heart melted a little bit again, and she so wanted to be with him, and yet there was the promise of Daryl...

"Hey, honey!"

"Hey, sweetie. That was just fantastic. You guys... just amazing."

"Thanks, honey. You enjoyed it?"

"Words could not describe..."

They hugged, they kissed, and it was so nice and familiar and more than a little sexy considering how horny she was, and the fact that she could feel how hard he was when she pressed herself against him. Was he

expecting her to go with Daryl that night? If he wasn't, he surely wouldn't be that hard already...

But she felt bad, that she might end up abandoning him that night, after he'd made all that effort to fly in to see her. Oh, she'd do her utmost to see him after Daryl, but all the same, Daryl had plenty of time during the rest of the tour...

"Honey, there's some kind of party we're all going to afterward..." she said to him.

"Of course," he said. "You've all got to celebrate, right?"

She smiled, "I just... I mean... you're coming as well, right?"

Julian shrugged, "Sure. If you want me to."

"Of course I do."

She felt glad he was coming to the party. Of course she did. It just suddenly started feeling complicated. Daryl would be there. She both wanted her husband there, and yet also wanted to be free of him, so that she could just have uncomplicated fun with the hot drummer.

It was like how she'd felt at the start of college, when her parents had dropped her off a month or two into Freshman year. She loved them intensely, and she missed them horribly while she was at college, but now she was there, she wanted them gone so she could really let her hair down and just enjoy the experience of college.

"You know, I am feeling pretty tired," he said suddenly. As though he was reading her thoughts.

"Just come for a little while," she said, though under the skin she started wondering if it would be easier for him to just go back to the hotel, not be there.

They both had this strong sense that she was going to be with Daryl that night. She could see it in Julian's eyes now. It was so unbelievably exciting, and yet at the same time frightening like she could never have believed it would. What if she liked Daryl too much? What if Julian suddenly decided he hated the idea of her being with the other man?

What if, finally when it happened, she went back to her husband and he could no longer bring himself to even look at her?

She would be crushed.

"You could have a few drinks, see how you feel," she suggested, suddenly afraid that if he didn't come to the party he would think she was

happy about it, that she was relieved he wasn't there—that she was, under the surface, rejecting him in favor of someone else.

"I could," Julian nodded. "If you really needed me there. If it would mean... you know... you feel supported..."

"I already feel supported," she smiled warmly. "Just that you flew out here. That you were here. That you saw the show."

He smiled, "Well, that's the important thing. But maybe... you need to be with your band right now. You know, first night and everything? You don't want to be babysitting your husband—you want to be knocking back shots with the Ponytails. And Blue Tonic."

The way he added that last part, the name of the other band, suddenly made it clear what he was referring to. He wanted her to let her hair down and just have fun with Daryl.

"And I'll see you later anyway," he said, sounding casual, relaxed, breezy. "I mean... whenever you're ready, right? Tomorrow morning, right? Or tomorrow afternoon. We haven't got any fixed plans—and you're flying out on Monday as well, right?"

"Right," she said. Funny to think that they had another city to get to. Another show to prepare for. This one had seemed so massive, so monumental, and now that it was over it was tempting to think that was it, the end of the world was now here and nobody had to worry about anything further.

Jesus. She felt some kind of explosion detonating between her thighs. Heat, energy just radiated out like some kind of blast wave from an atomic bomb. Julian was voluntarily stepping away to leave her in Daryl's hands. Just like that.

Somehow, she loved him even more intensely than she had before. The way he was looking at her... the way he was talking to her... the way he now stepped forward and hugged her again... so affectionate, so warm, so loving. Adoring.

It both pained her and thrilled her that he was leaving.

"I'm really not good with different time zones," he said, even if this was only a three-hour difference. She figured he was at least partially telling the truth—it would be rolling on toward 4am for his body right now.

"You sure you don't want... you know, a drink or two?"

He shook his head, apologetic, and yet not completely. He could read her well enough. Like her parents dropping her off at college Freshman

year, he knew that underneath it all, she was better off going and enjoying herself, with him leaving her to this other sphere to some degree.

“You enjoy yourself,” he said, kissing her again. “Tell me all about it afterward.”

“I will,” she promised. “I’ll tell you everything.”

He smiled, leaned in to kiss her neck, breathing in deeply as though sampling her aroma like that of a fine wine. “Everything,” he said. “Can’t wait.”

Then she was looking him in the eye, earnestly. Asking him for the final time: “Are you sure about this, honey? Are you completely sure?”

Both of them under no illusions, now, what she was referring to with her question.

“Completely sure,” he said firmly. Not even wavering a little bit. But then she needed him to be firm, she needed him to be certain.

One last sweet little kiss, not much more than a warm peck on the lips. And then he was gone.

*

The party was wild. Andrew had organized it at some nightclub just off Melrose Avenue on the way toward Beverly Hills. There was free booze at the bar and pounding music on the dance floor—but also comfy leather couches on which to collapse and talk.

But while there was a very celebratory atmosphere, early on there was also a feeling that there was networking to be done before they could all truly let their hair down.

A few reporters were in the crowd, apparently. A reviewer or two.

“There’s a photographer over there,” Renee told Kat in a loud whisper as she slumped down next to her while she had been on a couch chatting to Alyssa and Raj and someone’s cousin, she wasn’t sure who.

“So?”

Renee gave her a wicked grin, “So stop staring at your young stud for just a while, will you?”

Kat giggled. She hadn’t even realized she was staring at Daryl, who was mingling a little more successfully than she was on the other side of the club, with a little more energy. She had been allowing her eyes to drift over toward his direction a little too much, perhaps. Checking out his broad

shoulders, the hint of his toned body under his fashionably torn t-shirt and skinny black jeans.

“I’m not staring,” she insisted.

“You are too!” Renee laughed. “God, I would be. Look at him. Takes your breath away.”

Kat said, “You need a divorce, Ren. Quick.”

“It’s not that simple,” Renee sighed.

“Sure it is. Your husband doesn’t let you have any fun.”

“I do... kind of love the bastard.”

“He’s horrible to you.”

“He loves me. He’s possessive.”

“He won’t fuck you. He won’t let you have a sex life.”

Renee sighed, “He turns a blind eye when it’s a woman.”

“Does he, though?”

The redhead shrugged. “I don’t know. I guess he never asks me whether I slept with a woman. He never tries to get me to admit I cheated with a girl.”

“Right. So he’s not really turning a blind eye.”

“He just asks if I was with any guys. If any of them hit on me, or whatever.”

“He doesn’t think you could be attracted to a woman?”

Renee laughed, “He’s probably a little sexist, sure. But it’s a loophole I get to enjoy sometimes—and then I know I won’t have to lie when I get home and he asks if there were any guys around that got too friendly with me. But anyway, enough about me—what’s happening with you?”

The two of them looked up as Josie came to sit with them, having given air kisses to Alyssa and Raj, who seemed to be drawn to the dance floor just now.

“Hey, you two!” the blonde said, looking like a million dollars. Kat got the feeling she was no longer worried about YouTube attention. Then to Kat, Josie said, “Why so glum, chum?”

Kat shrugged, “I feel a little bad that Julian’s not here, that’s all.”

“He ducked out—voluntarily, right?” Renee pointed out.

“Only because I think he thought it would be easier on me... for me to... you know, hang out with Daryl.”

Josie said, “I take it hubby doesn’t want to hang out with Daryl, then?”

“It’s not that, I don’t think. He just wants... I don’t know... he wants to make sure I do the deed, I suppose. He wants to give me space so that... you know... it actually happens.”

“He’s worried that if you don’t do it now, you never will.” The blonde seemed insightful, and Kat figured she had every right to be, with the way she and George handled marriage.

“Maybe,” she agreed.

“That’s so hot—Isn’t it?” Renee was grinning like a woman bewitched. “That he wants you to... do it... so much?”

What her bandmate said stirred something in Kat. Wasn’t it hot, though? Her husband wanted her to fuck another guy. He really wanted her to sleep with Daryl, to have the beautiful younger man do whatever he wanted with her. And anything that happened would turn Julian on—in fact, the more that happened, the more Julian would be turned on.

“I still feel kinda bad he’s not here,” Kat told her bandmates.

Josie said, “Sure you do. But you have to get past that—he’s given you a damn hall pass, girl!”

“I feel kind of bad I’m not giving him a hall pass, too,” Kat said, and that was true enough. Along with the fear that going through with this crazy adventure might sabotage their marriage—that Julian would change his mind suddenly about it all—there was also the slow-burning guilt inside her that this all seemed to be about her. Her going on tour, her having a fling with a younger man, her getting fucked by strange cock. Julian got nothing but a confession.

“It’s what he wants,” Josie said.

“It’s what he says he wants,” Kat pointed out. “And you can’t always tell if he’s just being diplomatic.”

Renee sipped her drink. “Do you want to give him a hall pass?”

Kat shrugged. “Not particularly.”

“So what’s the problem? You get to have your cake and eat it, too.”

“Exactly,” said Josie. “You know, it took me a while to get used to George... you know... wanting me to see other guys. But at the end of the day, you just have to realize that you may never entirely understand why he wants you to do it... but you might as well enjoy the fact that he wants you to do it.”

Kat smiled. “Where is George tonight?”

Josie shrugged. “He’s keeping away,” she said. “Hoping that I’ll get lucky if he’s not here to distract.”

Kat laughed, “Maybe that’s what your hubby’s doing,” she suggested to Renee.

“Exactly,” Josie said, giving Renee a flash of her eyes to suggest maybe it was time for her to embrace the art of adultery, too. Then the blonde was on her feet again, pointing out some guy she recognized—perhaps one of the reporters present, in fact. And she was off again, leaving Kat with Renee.

Renee stifled a yawn. “How long are we expected to be here? Much as I love to party...”

Kat giggled, “You’re just down because you don’t get to take a guy home.”

“Maybe I like that,” Renee stuck out her tongue playfully. “I can go home right now if I like. You know, get some sleep before San Francisco.”

Kat smiled. “I don’t think we’re actually expected to stay out any length of time,” she said. “And anyway, it’s been a while already. I can’t see that photographer around anywhere any more.”

Renee looked around the club. “No,” she agreed.

In a way, part of Kat did envy Renee. She would have liked to go back to the hotel just now—to check on Julian, as much as anything. Make sure he was all right. Make sure he wasn’t having second thoughts. But she couldn’t keep sounding him out forever. At some point she’d have to take a step forward, in the dark, without any safety net.

She would cheat on her husband, and then there would be no taking it back, no do-overs, no changing of her mind over whether she would or would not be an adulteress.

“You know, I could knock on his door,” Renee said. “When I get back to the hotel.”

“Huh?” It surprised her how well the redhead knew her. What she was thinking about.

“Julian,” she said. “You need to know he’s okay, don’t you? I could just scoot over there, see how he is. Let you know.”

Kat liked that idea. She looked at her bandmate and felt that of all people who were not Julian, she could trust Renee the most. Well, the two of them had slept together. And done so with Julian watching, too.

If Renee went round to check on him... the thought did seem to dissolve some of Kat's guilt.

"You could," Kat agreed.

"Uh-huh."

Then she said, "You could talk to him a little."

"I could talk to him," Renee seemed very like-minded.

"You know, make absolutely sure he's okay with everything... with me... and Daryl..."

"Of course I could," Renee smiled.

Beautiful Renee. Renee whose nipples were so hard against her little white tank top. Renee, who so desperately needed cock. Would it really be so bad if Julian helped her out a little... in the flesh? Did it make Kat feel jealous? Perhaps a tiny bit. But it wasn't as though Renee would ever actually try to steal Julian. There was trust there. A lot of trust.

Maybe it was a little exciting, thinking of Julian actually getting a new experience. She being the one to give it to him.

"You could... spend a little time with him," Kat said. "And if... you know... something happened..."

Renee looked genuinely surprised at her.

"Something happened?"

Kat shrugged. "I'm not saying it would. Because he says he really doesn't want anyone but me... and you... well, you have this crazy notion that your husband will find out... or he'll get you to confess... or whatever..."

Renee said, "You are full of surprises, you know that?"

Kat shrugged, and now looked across the club to see Daryl standing at the bar with another guy, holding a Bourbon, checking her out like a hungry lion scoping out a herd of tasty yet strangely easy-to-catch antelope. She felt the heat surge between her thighs, felt the trickle of liquid seeping from her sex. Wow.

"It's up to you," she smiled. "But it would be so nice if you could make sure he's okay."

Renee stood, and Kat was fairly sure she wasn't imagining seeing the redhead's cheeks flushed pink, even with the difficult light levels in that nightclub.

"It'll be my pleasure," she said, and then she was away.

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Chapter Twenty-One

This time it was real. There was no ‘if’, no ‘maybe’, no ‘possibly’.

He had left his wife to attend a wild party with another man—and with a view to sleeping with that other man after leaving that party. And as far as Julian was aware, this intention was no longer up in the air, no longer something that vaguely might happen.

It was happening.

Back at the hotel, he felt his fatigue strangely melt away almost totally. He sobered up, too, somewhat miraculously, even if he’d ordered a bottle of red wine to take the edge off his anxiety. It was the adrenaline, the arousal. A cocktail of nerves.

He was hard, too. Boy, was he hard. So hard that he dropped his pants and took hold of it, and it almost didn’t quite feel like flesh and blood. Being on his own, he abandoned the rest of his clothes and just padded around the suite for a while, that huge great thing waggling in the air-conditioned chill. That hardness wasn’t going to go away. If he’d been at the party, he might have wondered if someone could have slipped a dose of Viagra in his drink for a prank.

Did you have to go to the Emergency Room if you had an erection lasting longer than four hours naturally?

“No, Doctor, I haven’t taken anything.”

“And it’s been this hard for five, hours, sir?”

“Yeah. About that.”

“You’re married?”

“Yeah.”

“Your wife is somewhere else, fucking another guy with your blessing?”

“How did you know, Doc?”

“It’s the only other way you can get this hard for so long, sir.”

He tried lying in bed, watching CNN for a while, and things did start to soften up between his legs, so it wasn’t a medical emergency. But then he was pacing again, unable to keep his mind on anything other than the fact

that Kat was out there somewhere, with him. Maybe still at the party. Maybe back at the hotel, in Daryl's room.

Fucking.

Kat was cheating on him.

Kat was an unfaithful wife.

A gorgeous, sexy, naughty unfaithful wife. Sullied by another man.

He checked his mobile phone every minute, to see if she had any questions, to see if she had any doubts. To make sure she wasn't going to suddenly pull out of the deal. He wasn't sure whether it was more frightening that she wasn't texting him just then, or whether it would be more terrifying if she was.

Maybe once every five minutes or so, he told himself to keep calm, cool it, relax. Just breathe.

And then, the knocking at the door which just about made him jump out of his skin. He grabbed a bathrobe, tightening the cord around his waist, the cord going over his hard cock, feeling weird, stupid, but unable to do anything since the hardness wasn't going away.

Would Kat have sent him something from room service, to distract him? What else could it be?

He peered through the spy hole and saw a familiar shock of luminous red hair. Renee. What the hell?

"Hey, come on—why don't we watch a movie or something?"

Julian raised an eyebrow. "You're really going to babysit me?"

She rolled her eyes, but flashed a smile at him. "Are you into that? Kinky."

The luminous red-haired keyboardist breezed past him into his room.

"You know what I mean. Did Kat send you over to check on me?"

Renee slumped down on the couch in front of the TV as though this was her suite. "Don't you think it's hot that she did?"

He did feel a little warmth inside, but it was both affection for his naughty wife—since she still had obvious concerns about his mental wellbeing—and also the added confirmation that tonight, Kat really did mean to go all the way with her new lover.

"Hot?" he raised an eyebrow. "I'm not sure about that..."

"She sent me over here... wearing this tiny little skirt..." Renee stretched out her legs as though trying to get him to notice how short her

skirt was. “And she knew you’d be nice and hard while thinking of her being all alone with another man...”

Julian chuckled, “She just asked you to knock on my door and double-check I’m all right, didn’t she? Maybe asked you to put your head around my door just to make sure.”

“It would be kind of mean, right? You let her have all this fun with hunky Daryl... and you don’t get any fun?” she glanced at him sideways, her eyes seductive.

“This is fun for me,” he said, insisted. “You—and probably Kat, too—don’t get it. I like it that she’s out with Daryl. I like thinking about it. I like that it’s happening right now, even if I’m not with her.”

She was toying with her hair a little with one hand, while flicking through the on-demand movie channels with the other, and the way she twirled the ends of her hair... well, the tips of her fingers were getting close to her breasts, and it was more than a little obvious that she was trying to engage his libido.

“Oh, hey, what about this one? Tom Cruise. You like Tom Cruise?”

“Sometimes. When it’s not too much about him.”

“So not many of his movies, huh?”

She wasn’t going to leave, he could sense it. And he didn’t want to be mean and demand that she leave. Eventually, she found a new Avengers movie for them to watch, and the two of them settled down on the couch with snacks and another bottle of red from room service.

And then Julian’s phone buzzed.

It startled him, made him jump almost out of the chair. Then he was scrambling to fish it out of his pocket as though it was liable to give him an electric shock if he left it there.

Unlocking the phone with his fingerprint, Julian’s heart burned as he saw the text message sitting waiting to be read. What had happened? Had she done the deed? Had she finally crossed that line? Or had something gone wrong—had things turned sour, had they gotten too drunk, had she changed her mind?

Now his cock jumped inside the bathrobe and his heart seemed to miss a few beats as the message drew up revealing a photo: a photo that showed the unmistakable form of his wife straddling another man. Jesus. Was she fucking him?

“What is it?” Renee asked.

He held his phone up for her.

“Wow,” she said, her eyes blazing. “She finally did it?”

“I guess... maybe she did.”

He was breathing deeply, and yet somehow struggling for air. Renee peered at the phone, and Julian just felt dizzy, his vision fizzing a little, the room spinning around him.

“No,” Renee said. “Look...”

She turned the phone back to him, and pointed at the bottom of the screen, between Kat’s legs and just under that glorious shaven pussy of hers, her black thong pulled tight to the side.

“You see that? That’s his... his cock.”

He looked, saw what she was alluding to. Not quite in focus, but he could see what she meant. Kat was riding it, rubbing herself against it, but it wasn’t inside her yet. Julian felt the butterflies start up inside his stomach again. Surely she wouldn’t stop now, wouldn’t turn back?

“How do you feel? Okay?” Renee asked him.

He paused, asked himself the same question. There was a surge of something akin to fear, it was fear of regret, fear of change, fear of not being able to stop something if he wanted to stop it. It wasn’t quite fear of losing his wife, though, he thought. He got a grip, took back control, tried to think about the excitement of his wife finally doing it, finally cheating on him as he desired.

“I think so,” he said. Now he was typing out a text message, feeling the need to let his wife know how he was thinking, if she was teasing him with pictures like that.

[Julian]: You look sensational, honey. Such a turn on... xxx

Renee leaned forward and pressed her hand down on his crotch—feeling his erection for a fraction of a second before squealing and retracting her hand rapidly. He was a little shocked—since he was wearing a bathrobe, she could so easily have put her hand through the gap and grabbed his bare cock.

“I’m... sorry,” she giggled. “I didn’t think... you’d really be hard right now. Not like that.”

He shrugged. Didn’t know what to say.

She laughed again. “I don’t think that counts, does it?” she said. “I mean, you had clothes on.”

Now it was his turn to laugh. "What are you worried about? I'm pretty sure Kat wouldn't mind if... you know... we did actually do something."

"I know, but..."

"I mean, as you said, she sent you round here just as she's going with Daryl... in that skirt..."

Renee flipped up her skirt as though trying to understand his point, giving him a little flash of her thighs and even a little glimpse of her underwear.

"I think..." she said, "I think... she did mean for something to happen. Maybe. But... I'm not sure I can."

He smiled, "I don't think I can, either."

"No?"

He shook his head. "I was only ever in this for Kat. To see her... you know... step over the boundary. The cheating... that wasn't her fantasy, though I think she finds it hot that I want her to cheat."

"I thought you said it wasn't cheating..."

"Oh, I know. But now it's happening... I don't know, I just hang on to that word... it's all so strange, and so... intense. Somehow nothing captures it better than that word."

She sat back in her corner of the couch, and for a moment or two, they were just watching the movie, neither of them really focusing on it.

Then came another text message. Another picture.

Julian felt dangerously close to coming without even touching himself at the sight of his wife with a huge cock in her hands, its tip in her mouth. She was looking up at the camera as she sucked on it. And it wasn't his cock. Wow. He wanted her so much, he wanted to kiss that mouth, he wanted to slide his own cock between her lips.

Renee demanded a look.

As he showed her the screen, the redhead looked as excited by it as he had been.

"Are you okay?" Renee asked him, as though suddenly remembering this was his wife, not hers.

"Sure," he said, trying to act calm.

"You don't want her to stop?"

"No. Not at all."

Julian texted his wife back:

[Julian]: You look so hot, honey. You gonna fuck him?

He felt himself trembling as he sent the message over to her, its approval for her to take that final step implicit.

There was no reply. They waited, and nothing came.

“If it was me, and I was going to fuck him, I’d probably forget about texting a reply, too,” Renee said at last.

“You think it’s really happening?”

She nodded. “Uh-huh.”

They looked at each other. Julian felt as though the whole world was slowing down to a stand-still. This was it. Kat was finally going through with it. She was committing adultery.

Renee said, “Are you still...” Then she leaned over to put her hand in his crotch again—just checking, but she squealed again as she felt his inevitable erection through the bathrobe, and it was clear she had wanted to feel it all along.

“I thought you couldn’t... touch,” he said.

She shrugged, “I can’t. I didn’t. I... You’re so hard!” Then she wrinkled up her face, gave him a wicked sideways glance, added: “Can I... see it?”

He laughed. “You serious? I thought you couldn’t...”

“Looking at it isn’t the same as cheating. Come on—please?”

Julian shook his head briefly, more than a little embarrassed, and looked down at his phone. Was that it from his wife? He wasn’t getting any more?

“Here...” Renee pulled up her skirt, “You wanna see me?”

He caught a flash of white between her legs, and then as she turned toward him on the couch, parting her thighs, she was showing him her panties—white thongs, fairly plain and simple. One hand snaked its way down to touch it, and Julian couldn’t help but watch her.

“You thinking about her?” she asked him.

“Of course.”

“He’s sliding that big dick inside her right about now.”

Julian shivered involuntarily at the thought. Kat actually taking some other guy in her pussy. Riding him. Letting him pound into her.

Renee turned toward him on the couch, her legs wide. Horny as fuck. “Come on—you have to show me something. I don’t get to see many nice cocks the way my husband is...”

Julian smiled, “You’re a bad girl.”

“Come on!” she laughed. “I mean, you already basically showed me. And you’ve seen me... it’s no big deal.”

She shifted back half a foot, and now slipped down her tank top to reveal her pale but nicely shaped breasts, and those stiff nipples of hers. He felt the inevitability of it all, but looking at her did seem to quell the nerves somewhat. It made him feel better—the excitement suppressing his fears now that the time had come for his wife.

He pulled his bathrobe open and allowed his hardness to rise up, free. Renee squealed her delight, but now she lay back along the couch, propped up on the cushions and the arm, and started to touch herself through her panties, before tugging them to the side to show him everything.

“You feel glad that you let her be with him?” she asked him.

“Uh-huh.”

“You have a nice cock, you know that?” she giggled. “Why don’t you... stroke it a little?”

He did as she asked, though he didn’t want to risk coming, not for her, not until Kat returned. Renee was under no such restrictions, laying back and stroking herself with increasing abandon. Telling him how much his cock turned her on, how much she wished he could slide it inside her—but also how incredible it was that he let Kat see other guys, and how hot it was that at that moment she was with another man.

After a while, Julian’s phone piped up again—something new had been received. They were both on edge as to what it might be.

Julian accepted the text and then gasped as he saw what it was.

A video.

Renee sat up and they both wedged together to watch the video on that little screen. It showed Kat on all fours on a bed, looking over her shoulder expectedly. The camera dropped to show her sublime derriere—and then the unmistakable form of a fully-erect cock being stroked around her pussy.

“Is this really...?” Renee whispered, but Julian shushed her.

They heard Daryl say on the video, “Here it goes...”

And then the man’s big cock slid effortlessly into Kat, between the sweet lips of her pussy, and straight in, all the way. She was so wet that he just entered her and kept going, filling her up with his full length, only stopping when he was fully penetrating her.

“Oh my God...” Kat cried in astonishment, and her voice made Julian’s own hard cock throb and buck—and very nearly come.

Then they were watching Daryl thrusting into her, time and time again. Julian didn't even think about anything else, he was just sitting there on the couch, his hand tightly gripping his shaft, pumping it as he watched another man fucking his wife for the first time. The first cock inside her, other than his, for years.

Wow, just wow. It had really happened—no way back.

Kat was unfaithful. And so sexy with it.

The video ran on a loop for a while, until Julian realized he was close to coming—he very nearly went over the edge, but the proximity to orgasm pulled him out of his daze. He stopped himself, calmed down.

Beside him— so close her bicep was brushing against his, her knee knocking against his—Renee was tending to her own lust, and though she wasn't quite squirting as Kat had done, she was seriously wet and pushing herself to an intense climax.

Julian saw a message arrive from his wife, and thought he wouldn't quite be able to handle another video, even another photo. It might send him over the edge.

But it was just a text message, perhaps typed while she was actually being fucked such were all the typos. Stating:

[Kat]: love you so much, honey... can't wait to see you again. Have fun with Renee until I get there... you can do anything you like with her. I want you to. Fuck her, and then me xxx

It was official, then. And yet now he didn't want to fool around with Renee because he was so close to orgasm. He needed to calm down, relax, perhaps take a cold shower and just reset.

He showed the text message to Renee once the redhead had come down from her high, and the redhead said: "I told you there wasn't anything to worry about."

But she said, "I don't think I was ready, anyway. I... my husband..."

He nodded. Whatever the logic, things were complicated for Renee's marriage, though she was strongly tempted to make it more simple through straight adultery.

The two of them tried to cool it, and Julian did actually take a cold shower. Now they were watching the movie again while waiting for Kat to return, and things weren't quite as nervous. To Julian it was because his wife was there now, an adulteress. It wasn't something anybody could prevent, or retract. All they could do was deal with the consequences.

It seemed to take an age. But then there was a knock at the door.

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Chapter Twenty-Two

She stepped out into the doorway wearing nothing but a purple-and-black bra and black thong, and she could hardly believe how calm and collected she was able to act, even though under the surface she was anything but. Hormones raged around her body like they hadn't since she'd been in the throes of puberty. Her insides were melting, nerves jangling, butterflies fluttering in her stomach enough to cause a hurricane. Her heart was beating twenty to the dozen and her chest was heaving as she tried to remember to just keep breathing.

And the heat between her legs was just plain astonishing.

He was just lying there on the bed, smiling up at her as she paused on the threshold, giving him a little show. Well, she was proud of her body, she'd worked at it in the run-up to the tour—ostensibly for the fitness to cope with the high-energy music, but with benefits for seducing a new boyfriend.

"Hey," she smiled, and walked slowly into the room, exaggerating the swing of her hips just a little, maybe pushing out her chest somewhat. Slipping a finger under the waistband of her tiny thong as though it needed adjusting over her hip.

"Hey," he said, beaming back at her, dazzled by her. She felt a little shiver of joy at how he responded to her, at how obviously he wanted her.

As good as sex was with her husband, she simply didn't get this kind of nervous energy with him. This kind of thrill. How could she? He knew what to expect with her, she knew what to expect with him. He had a marital obligation to tell her how beautiful she was, and to be attracted to her. Daryl had no obligations. He had only natural responses, and it was such a thrill to her that she still had what it took.

"So it's finally just us, huh?" she said, approaching the bed.

"That's right."

"Alone at last."

He was lying there on the bed, wearing nothing but a pair of tight black undershorts, and though his ripped body got her pulse racing, it was

the bulge rising up from his underwear that caught her eye and soaked her panties.

“Was Julian at the party? I didn’t see him,” Daryl said.

She smiled, “He was tired. Never does well with the time difference.”

She climbed onto the bed, offering him an easy view of her cleavage as she crawled up to him between his legs, moving as though in slow motion, giving her young stud a spectacle, loving the way his eyes roamed all over her.

“I can’t believe he’d let you out of his sight,” Daryl said.

Even now, he couldn’t quite get the whole deal with her husband. Well, could she honestly say she 100% understood why Julian wanted her to cheat on him like this? Not 100%.

“Oh, he’d watch if he could,” she smiled, “but I think he’s curious what it feels like to just let me go.”

He sat up as she approached him, but Kat planted her palm in the middle of his hairless chest and gently but firmly pushed him back down onto the bed. He didn’t resist. Some little spark in his eyes suggested he wasn’t used to a woman showing him what she wanted, and maybe the novelty factor was interesting to him, exciting even.

She straddled his bulge, and did not object as his hands swept around to spread over her rear, reveling in the roundness, the softness of her flesh there.

Wow. He was so hard for her. And for a moment it kind of shocked her. This was not her husband. This was another man, almost a stranger. The first other man she’d been with for years. She tensed her muscles and gyrated her hips slightly, grazing her throbbing sex over that hardness stowed within his undershorts.

Oh, God.

“I saw you with him,” Daryl said, surprising her. “At the theater.”

“You did?” Why was Daryl bringing up Julian at such a moment? Was he freaked out by it all, after all?

“You’re obviously crazy about each other.”

She felt a touch of fear, that he was suddenly going to demand she renounce her marriage or something—or maybe he’d just declare that whatever Julian had said, whatever the two of them had agreed, her marriage could not be a success if she continued this seduction.

“Yes, I’d say so,” she said warily.

“And he really wants you to do this with me?”

She smiled, trying to reassure him that everything was okay, but really she was also trying to give herself that final reassurance.

“It’s strange, maybe. He just gets off on the thought of me... you know... being a little naughty.”

“A ‘little’ naughty?”

He laughed, his smile broad and his teeth bright, and as she sat up on him, undulating her chest and stomach like some kind of belly dancer, or perhaps just some kind of lap dancer, grinding her pussy against his erect cock, there was no hint of reluctance on his part.

It wasn’t putting him off, that she was married, that Julian wanted this to happen. He was just curious.

He wanted her so much, and she wanted him. It felt so right, so perfect, so incredible—and yet ordinarily her marriage would have prevented it. Crazy. Monogamy was crazy. When you thought about it.

“I can’t stay the night with you, though,” she said with regret. “Not tonight.”

“Of course not.”

He slid his hands up her smooth thighs, now. This was adultery. Cheating. Even if she had her husband’s permission, society frowned on such a thing. Didn’t that just make it that much more delicious?

She shivered again, involuntarily, even though the temperature in there was on the warm side. She hadn’t felt this nervous about sex since losing her cherry back in high school.

“Does it make you feel bad?” She asked him, feeling honesty the best way to go here. Full disclosure. “That I’m going back to him tonight?”

He shook his head. “Why? I get to enjoy you... then you run on back to him. What’s the problem?”

She smiled again, trying to hide her resurgence of surprise at how understanding this guy was. Younger guys were supposed to be more possessive, more angry, right?

She reached up to brush her hair back out of her face again, and now his hands swept up under the little black triangle of fabric covering her sex. She moaned as she felt his thumbs graze over the wet material, rubbing over her throbbing pussy.

He grabbed her thong in one hand, stretching it, pulling on it, the narrow band of black covering almost nothing, digging into her soaking slit

as he held on to her underwear like the reins of a horse as she rode him. Revealing her bare pussy to his hungry gaze.

“You’re incredible, you know that?” he told her, and she warmed up inside another few degrees.

“You’re pretty incredible yourself,” she smiled, flattered, jubilant.

She rocked forward, onto him, pressing her breasts against his bare chest, cradling his head in her hands, kissing him. His hands traveled all over her body as she enjoyed the softness, the sweetness of his lips. Down her back, over her behind, down her legs. Down to her black suede cowboy boots. He was unfastening them, pulling on them.

He chuckled. “What’s this?”

She’d almost forgotten about her phone, stowed there in her right boot.

“Oh...” she said, and for a moment wondered if she’d scare Daryl away if she said the wrong thing. “I guess... it’s in case he... you know... changes his mind...”

Daryl chuckled again. “I can’t believe this is your first time. I’m your first time.”

He took the phone, and she sat up again, gently rocking herself over his hardness, wondering what he was up to. He held it up, framing her with the camera lens as she straddled him.

“What’re you doing?” she said, smiling, slightly self-conscious at having a camera trained on her, even if it was that of her own phone.

“Capturing pure beauty,” he said, his hand slipping between her legs, stretching her underwear aside as he snapped pictures of her.

“You better delete those afterward,” she warned. “You know how easy it is to hack into cameraphones.”

Daryl grinned, “You don’t think Jules would like to see?”

Kat caught her breath. Well, he had let her take a couple of pictures of her blowing him to send to Julian. They’d been quite drunk at the time...

“There,” he said, as though he’d done something.

She gasped, “What did you do?”

“Sent it to your husband,” he grinned. “Let him know what he’s missing.”

“Hey!” she grabbed for the phone, panicking a little since she hadn’t talked to Julian about sending him pictures that first time. This wasn’t a little blowjob, this was the final barrier being crossed—what if it made him think twice about it all?

She tried to relax as it was clear she wouldn't wrestle the phone back from Daryl. If pictures could make Julian change his mind about tonight... then let him. She would be wrong to go through with it if anything could change his mind. She pushed out her bottom lip, giving him a pretend sad face, and Daryl put the phone back in her hand.

It buzzed. A message from Julian.

[Julian]: You look sensational, honey. Such a turn on... xxx

It warmed her up inside again, and she felt a flicker of pure lust between her legs. He really wasn't going to change his mind. She was really going to get to fuck this gorgeous specimen of a man.

Kat flashed a pretend frown at Daryl, but then broke out into a smile and began kissing her way down his chest, enjoying the sheer physicality of the man.

"You see? He loves it," Daryl said, picking up the phone from where she left it beside them on the mattress.

It was surprising how the guy seemed so chill about referring to her husband while they were together.

"You know, most guys would probably shut up and just fuck me," she said, giggling. "You know... rather than bringing up the whole thing about my husband..."

Oh God, and he smelled so good. Whatever his cologne was.

"I just think it's interesting," he laughed. "You know... you don't hear about this kind of thing every day."

She kissed her way down his incredible body with its hard muscles and soft skin, and there was his huge bulge right there for her. She stroked it with her lips and her nose through the thin material of his undershorts, and felt that flush of lust and shock sweep through her again—this was not her husband's cock. This was another man entirely.

"'Interesting'?" she giggled. "You think it's 'interesting'?"

He shrugged. "I never thought marriage could be like this."

"Like what?"

"You know... fun."

Even before marriage she'd accepted that she'd never get to enjoy another man again in bed. That her decision to commit to Julian would prevent anything like this from happening again. And yet here she was, nuzzling up to a strange cock, feeling it so hard for her, breathing it in.

Peeling off his underwear to reveal the glorious sight of his huge manhood, shorn of all hair, bulging and veiny, throbbing as she laid her hands on it, glistening at the tip as she opened her mouth and licked its full length.

She glanced up and he snapped another picture.

“Have you got some secret deal with my husband to shoot pictures of this?” she asked him.

He said, “Did you think it was gonna turn out like this when you married him?”

“No, not really,” she said, holding up his cock and swirling her tongue around it as she gazed into the dark little circle that was the camera lens. Would Julian really see this?

“I mean, marriage is where you kinda... give up sex, right? I mean sex with anyone else,” he said.

“Supposed to be,” she stretched her lips around him and sank down on his cock, filling her cheeks with it, thrusting it right to her throat.

“But here you are... he lets you see other guys... and he actually enjoys it...”

“He says he does.”

“Look here: he says, ‘you look so hot, honey. You gonna fuck him?’” Daryl read a text message.

Kat laughed, “Are you going to just play with that phone? Or do you want to fuck me?”

She pulled herself up, slid over him, stroking his hard cock with her body, her breasts.

“Oh Jesus...” he moaned, thrusting his hips at her as she stroked him with her soft, golden skin, then wrapped her mouth around it again, pumping it with her fist. He couldn’t take it for long, pulling her up on his lap, sucking her hard nipples into his mouth.

“Fuck me,” she whispered his ear, kissing him. “Fuck me now.”

She pulled away from him, off the bed, stood up and removed her panties and her boots, slowly again so that he had a chance to just look at her a while. He shuffled forward onto the edge of the mattress and removed his own underwear completely, then reached for her, clutching her hips, kissing her stomach, taking in her lithe, petite form.

“You’re gonna do it?” he asked her.

“Do what?”

“Cheat on your husband.”

She smiled, covering her breasts with her hands as she looked down on him. “It’s not really cheating when he wants it to happen,” she said.

“You vowed to be with only him, right?” he said, stroking her wet pussy with two fingers while he kissed her stomach.

“I guess I did.”

“So you’re cheating.”

She looked down on him, wide-eyed and open-mouthed. “You like it, don’t you?” she asked him. “That I’m cheating on my husband.”

He turned her around with his strong hands, drummer’s hands, checking her out from the rear view, reaching between her legs to continue stroking her soaking pussy with skilled fingers. “I guess I think it’s kinda sexy,” he said.

“You think I’m a slut?”

He laughed, “Considering it’s the first time?” Then he said, “No, I think you’re more like... exotic... powerful... I don’t know... like some kind of femme fatale.”

She laughed at that. “A femme fatale? You think I’m dangerous?”

“Maybe,” he said, standing, kissing her mouth. “Maybe you could be dangerous.”

She brushed her hair with her hands and skipped past him, diving onto the bed, lifting her beautiful behind for his benefit. “I think you’d better tame me,” she said. “Don’t you think?”

She went on all fours so that her knees were on the edge of the bed, pushing her behind up so he could drive into her from where he stood on the floor. But Daryl knelt down, taking her thighs in his strong hands, and she felt his breath on her behind—and then he was pushing her up and clamping his mouth over her pussy, tasting her wetness.

“What are you—”

But he didn’t answer. Only licked her, moaning at her flavor as he lapped up her juices. The juices of a cheating wife. He wasn’t even married to her, how could he be so taken with the idea of an adulterous woman too?

But he was. Of that she had no doubt. He ate her with wild abandon, the same way her husband had started to once he’d accepted the fantasy of her infidelity. She could feel her body responding to him, to it, the whole idea of these men obsessing about her because she was unfaithful, because she was promiscuous.

“Fuck me,” she pleaded after a while, as she felt her juices dribbling down her thighs, and his tongue trying to mop it up. “Please... fuck me... fuck me now...”

He pushed her up the bed, and she allowed herself to go with the flow, still on all fours, but her knees spread wide, her body low on the bed. Daryl knelt between her thighs, placed one hand on her lower back, and lined up his big, hard cock between her legs. Oh God, here it came. She was about to take that final step. She was going to cheat on her husband.

“Wait,” Daryl said. He leaned down a moment. She looked back over her shoulder, saw him messing with something. A condom?

“When was the last time you slept with someone?” she asked him.

He said, “I don’t know. Months. Several months.”

She said, “You don’t need that...”

“What?”

“Protection. I’m on the pill.”

“Oh, right.”

“You’re clean, right?”

“Of course.”

But now he was holding it up. The phone.

“Seriously?” she laughed.

He smiled at her. “Just this last time,” he said. “Don’t you think it would be nice for him?”

She rolled her eyes. Why the need to be so nice to her husband? Oh, she thought it was a great idea, but it was strange that her lover would think of it. Did it make Daryl feel powerful, fucking someone else’s woman? Rubbing his face in it?

He was recording it on video, stroking his cock over and around her dripping pussy. She just wanted him inside her already.

“Here it goes,” he said, and now she felt the tip of his cock slip between the lips of her pussy.

She groaned. She needed him inside her, filling her up. Then, suddenly, he was. She yelped in surprise—she was so wet he simply flew straight in, up to the hilt. She could feel the tip of his great fat cock butt against her cervix.

“Oh my God...” she cried, as it felt like Daryl’s cock was grazing up against every single nerve ending in her entire pussy at once.

Daryl held up the phone and slowly thrust in and out of her, as Kat clutched the bedsheets and just moaned.

Then, after a while, he paused.

“What are you doing?” she asked.

“Sending...” he said.

She felt a funny feeling inside. Intense fear and trepidation combined with fiery excitement and sexual satisfaction. She had what she might later describe as almost a paranormal experience... feeling how her husband reacted to the incoming video sent to him showing her first act of true infidelity. Feeling how turned on and how scared and how alarmed he was by it, by knowing this was the point of no return. That his wife was now unfaithful.

It was almost like people seeing loved ones just after they'd died thousands of miles away. Ghosts. She had a connection with Julian that wasn't just a bit of paper that declared them to be married.

She grabbed the phone from Daryl and now texted Julian:

[Kat]: I love you so much, honey... can't wait to see you again. Have fun with Renee until I get there... you can do anything you like with her. I want you to. Fuck her, and then me xxx

She just felt wild, crazy. Things were overwhelming her, but as she put the phone down and ordered Daryl to fuck her and not stop until she said, she had the most intense feeling of love for her husband, the man who had wanted this.

Daryl leaned over her to kiss her, and then he was kneeling up, grabbing her hips, fucking her as hard as she wanted, making her moan, gasp, shout. Her shapely body shuddering every time he pounded into her, her golden skin shining with perspiration, her dark hair shaking all over the bedsheets as he fucked her.

She rolled over and he took her missionary style, and she gazed in his eyes and said over and over, “I'm cheating on my husband... I'm cheating on my husband...”

Finally he was fucking her and the whole bed was shaking as if an earthquake had seized hold of the building and wasn't letting up. She felt the fiery energy welling up from between her legs, and then every muscle in her body seemed to tense up, hard. Almost cramping. She felt a fresh warmth between her legs, all over Daryl, and as he gripped her waist and

plunged into her, he was laughing and coming and it was like fireworks exploding all around them.

She felt his come shoot deep inside her, and it gave her orgasm one last powerful kick at the realization that this was another man coming inside her, another man lacing her with his seed—not her husband. She had a stranger’s cream in her pussy.

“I think you might have squirted a little,” he said with a broad grin, pulling slowly back from her thighs, both their bodies now glistening with her juices.

“I’m sorry,” she said, “It’s something that just started happening.”

“Because your husband started sharing you?” Daryl laughed. “Well, I guess you’re into it like he is.”

She looked down—she really was soaking. And now the younger man’s cream was slowly leaking out of her flushed, puffy pussy. She wasn’t sure if she’d spoken to her husband about using condoms or not. What were his wishes? Well, too late now.

She dipped her fingers in the sticky cream, and now rubbed some of it up over her hairless mound, over her stomach, her breasts. Reveling in her status as a cheating wife, perhaps, in the naughtiness of having a strange man’s come inside her, and now all over her.

“I’m sorry... did we mess up your bed?”

Daryl laughed, and lay down beside her, taking her in his arms. “That’s what beds are for, right?”

She smiled, and picked up the phone that lay forlorn by the edge of the mattress. Text message from Julian:

[Jules]: That was the hottest thing I ever saw, honey. You are amazing. I love you more than ever xxx

It made her smile. She felt tired, but there was a little flicker of something between her legs, something that kind of made her want to go again—only not necessarily with Daryl. She wanted her husband. Wanted him badly. Wanted to see how he felt about her now she’d gone through with it. Wanted to see if he was as turned on as he believed he would be.

She had some doubts as to whether the reality would match the fantasy for him. But she had hopes that it would, that he would be ecstatic that she’d come through and fucked another man.

“You want to get out of here, huh?” Daryl smiled, reading her expression.

“Am I that obvious?” she said with an apologetic expression.

Daryl laughed, “I think it’s obvious that you’d want to go to him.”

“I’m so sorry. When... when he flies back...”

“I know, I know,” he nodded, and lay on his back with his arms folded behind his head as she pulled herself up from the bed. “But it’s kinda hot that you’ve got to run back to him now.”

“Yeah?” she raised an eyebrow.

“I wanna fuck you all over again,” Daryl said as she reached for her underwear. “But I think maybe I don’t have the greatest need right now.”

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Chapter Twenty-Three

She knocked on the door. It was her room, booked under her name, and she knocked on the door—and waited for the door to be opened for her before entering.

“It’s your room,” Julian laughed. “You don’t need to knock.”

She smiled, “I didn’t want to... you know... interrupt... if something was going on.”

Julian looked at Renee briefly, who shrugged and smiled as if to say, you see? We could have done something. It felt strange to him that his wife would want something to go on between him and her friend. But then, things had been so unconventional recently, particularly when sex with others was concerned.

But now, here she was. He took her in his arms before she had time to take three steps into the suite, and right there in the little hallway he kissed her.

She breathed in deeply as he kissed her, and brought up her hands to cradle his head as she responded, sucking gently on his lips. Was she tired? Was she too tired? He couldn’t tell. She looked full of energy. She looked... a little buzzed, and very content.

And as he kissed her, she smelled differently to him than he remembered. He couldn’t quite put it into words, but it was somehow unfamiliar.

“So?” he said at last.

“Uh-huh,” she nodded, beaming from ear-to-ear.

It had happened.

“You still love me?” she asked, sounding slightly flippant, though probably to hide her nerves. This was the most important question to her, now that she had been with another man.

He kissed her, breathing in that strange scent, which he realized must have been the scent of sex, of their sex, of another man’s cologne and their perspiration. Of come.

“Of course,” he grinned, “More than ever.”

He held her narrow waist, just amazed at what he had in his hands. The hottest woman he'd ever known. Sexy beyond compare. An unfaithful wife. Her body was so warm through the thin dress, she seemed so alive, so vibrant, and as they continued to kiss, taking the time to reacquaint themselves to each other, he pressed her up against the wall and felt her body respond to the feeling of his hard cock lying up against her through his clothes.

That was the biggest proof for her. Her husband was hard as a rock.

The two of them were lost in each other, and neither of them really noticed Renee was still there in the room with them. The redhead stepped back, away, giving them space though not quite knowing what to do with herself at such a moment for this couple. She stepped through the drawn curtains and onto the balcony... and yet could not entirely close herself off from what was happening. It was so wonderful, what Julian had done for his wife—and how he was so turned on by it. Renee had to see what happened next. She parted the curtains slightly, and watched.

Kat was stroking her husband's shoulders and his chest, and as they ended their kiss, she was laughing, overjoyed—but also relieved.

"It really happened," she said.

"You enjoyed it?"

"Oh, yes. It was... wonderful."

He pulled the straps of her dress down off her shoulders, revealing her bare breasts, and stunningly stiff nipples. Her bra was gone.

"I came straight over," she smiled, noticing that he noticed her missing underwear.

"Good, I wanted you to," he said.

"You want me to take a quick shower?"

He shook his head. "No," he almost growled, kissing his way down her neck, breathing so deeply, as though he was breathing her in, inhaling her, getting off on her scent. She felt sticky, dirty, unwashed after her recent exertions, but the way her husband held her, touched her, kissed her, made her feel deeply sexy, somehow, because it was so obvious that the lingering evidence of her infidelity was a serious thrill to him.

"It doesn't... freak you out?" she asked him, hesitant, but curious.

"Of course not," he smiled up at her as he kissed his way down her stomach, dropping down into a crouching position, running his hands up her bare thighs.

“I was only just with him,” she said, her face apologetic, her hands moving down to block her most intimate area as he pushed up her dress to reveal her little black thong, worried that it would be too much for him.

“And now you’re with me,” he beamed, kissing the top of her thighs, right next to her sodden underwear.

Julian was just intoxicated by her. The scent was so strong now,

“Did he make you come?”

“Oh, yes.”

“Did he make you squirt?”

“I think so,” she was blushing a little as he looked up at her, as though the whole squirting thing was still a little embarrassing for her. She added, “Only when I was thinking about you. About how you might feel about what we were doing.”

“That’s sweet,” he said, chuckling as he pulled her dress down and off.

She started stroking her pussy, right there next to his face, as though she might expose him to the full experience of her unfaithful sex little by little. He watched her for a moment, kissed her here or there, even over her panties. She stretched the material, tugged it a little to the side to expose her pussy to him.

The sharp spice of her arousal, mixed with an earthier scent of sex, hit his nostrils and made him feel a little light-headed. Wow. It had such a powerful effect on him. This was his wife, his cheating wife. Nobody could deny what had happened now, what she had done.

He removed her panties, and there was her beautiful sex, her dark petals parted and puffy, revealing a hint of glistening pink inside.

“Wait, wait,” she pleaded, but his mouth was over her sensitive folds, and as she felt him connect with her there, there was no way she was going to continue trying to persuade him to leave off, to let her bathe herself before he reclaimed her as his own.

He lashed her with his tongue, enveloped her sensitive button in his hot mouth, and there was nothing she could do but cling to the wall and try to remain on her feet.

“Oh fuck...” she breathed, placing one hand on his head as though to steady herself.

“Tell me what happened,” he growled, parting her legs as far as he could without her toppling over, tilting his head and pressing it up against

her soaking pussy.

“We went back to his room,” she said, breathless, her chest heaving to suck in any air she could.

“He fucked you?”

“Mmm... yeah... he fucked me...” she whimpered a little, as though from the memory, or perhaps from her husband sucking on her pussy lips.

“I... I cheated on you.”

He moaned as she said the word ‘cheated’. Even if he didn’t agree it was warranted, considering his role in her infidelity, it was a powerful word, perhaps even some kind of trigger to get him going. It made him slide his tongue into her as far as he could, lick her more forcefully. She noticed.

“I took off all my clothes for him, and he was so hard,” she said, her eyes brightening as she felt her husband responding to her dirty talk. “I sucked his cock and then he fucked me.”

“God...” Julian said, sucking hard on her clit for a moment—almost too hard. She bucked under him, then regained control. “Tell me... tell me how...”

“To begin with,” she said, “from behind. It felt sooo good...”

Kat looked up, then over to her left, and there was Renee standing by the TV, watching them, one hand pulling up her skirt and tugging aside her panties, the other pressed against her pussy, her middle finger stroking her slit. Kat caught her husband’s eye and nodded over to her bandmate, who for the moment was touching herself with her eyes closed.

He smiled, but the disruption to Kat’s dirty talk made Renee look over and realize she’d been discovered.

“I... I’ll go...” she said, blushing fiercely despite everything.

“No, don’t go,” Kat smiled and took the three steps over to her bandmate, leaving Julian kneeling on the floor watching them, loving every moment.

Kat slid her hands over Renee’s body, over her breasts, and up to her head before she leaned in to kiss her mouth. Julian could hear the redhead catch her breath as the nude brunette pressed herself against her, and her mouth approached for a kiss.

“You can stay,” Kat said softly as she kissed her.

Renee sucked on her bandmate’s lips tenderly, but then she was moving to kiss Kat’s neck, and take her breasts in her hands.

She whispered into Kat’s ear, “I can smell him on you.”

“Yes,” Kat said.

“I can smell him all over you.”

Julian watched his wife peel Renee’s t-shirt up and off her body, revealing her bare little breasts, the redhead’s nipples just as hard as hers it seemed. She took one of them into her mouth, and Renee groaned quietly.

The two women kissed again, and it seemed to Julian that Renee was ravenous for his wife at a level beyond anything he’d seen before. The redhead was reacting to Kat in a very similar way to Julian himself, it appeared.

Kat crouched and slipped Renee’s skirt off her hips and down her legs, helping her step out of it. Next she peeled down her panties, kissing the redhead around her coppery bush, though glancing over to her husband as though to tease him.

“So what about you guys?” Kat said, kissing Renee’s inner thigh, just under her sex.

“What about us guys?” Julian said, perching the corner of the large bed.

“What did you get up to while I was gone?”

Renee urged her friend up from the floor, said, “We watched movies. Hung out... you know.”

Kat giggled. “You really didn’t...”

Renee smiled, and now urged Kat down onto the bed. “Tonight was all about you, honey. Not us.”

“Yeah... but...”

“I’ve told you... I can’t fuck other men.”

Julian watched as Renee knelt over Kat, who lay stretched out on her back. The redhead ran one hand lightly down the other woman’s naked body, all the way from shoulders to lower thighs, checking out her curves, the heat and slight clamminess of her skin. The sense of a woman who had just had sex.

“You knew I was okay with you and Jules...” Kat said, almost nervous about Renee exploring her, since she had not had a shower.

“I nearly did,” Renee nodded. “But... you know...”

Renee ducked down and kissed Kat’s stomach, then her nearest breast, and took her hard nipple in her mouth.

“I wanted you to,” Kat said. “I think, when it finally got time for me and Daryl... I wanted to know...”

Renee grinned, "I wish I could have." Then they were kissing, mouth to mouth. Julian felt a little pushed out, but it was hot watching them, Renee almost possessive of Kat, after she'd been with someone else, and now she was taking her back.

Then she was sucking on her breasts again, saying in awe, "He's all over you... I can smell him..."

Renee slid down, and parted Kat's legs, lifting one of her knees so that she could kneel between her thighs. Kat glanced at Julian, and he couldn't quite read her—either she was nervous, or a touch apologetic that the redhead had stepped in meaning he could only watch.

Julian smiled and stood back, leaning against the wall, tempted to slip his cock out of his pants as he watched Renee gliding a hand all over Kat again, before she sank down to begin kissing his wife slowly and sensually up her inner thighs, closing in on her unfaithful pussy.

"Oh..." Kat moaned as her friend began licking her there.

Julian was just amazed watching them. He reached over to pull Renee's hair back out of her face so it wouldn't get in the way. She seemed to be not just reacquainting herself with Kat, but reclaiming her.

"His come is still inside you," Renee breathed as she came up for air in between lapping at Kat's sweet pussy. "I can taste him..."

"You... you like it?" Kat said.

Renee moaned, "Oh yeah... Can't you tell?"

The redhead was licking her and sucking her with obvious enthusiasm.

Kat laughed, and began moving her hips, gently thrusting her pussy at her friend as Renee lapped at it. She said, "You're just like Julian."

Renee smiled. "It's the nearest I can get to... you know... fucking a man..."

Julian moved up to lie by his wife as Renee ate her out. Kat looked up at him and smiled, satisfied, joyous, confident, thankful. Julian kissed her mouth, and then her breasts, and writhing under them, his wife screwed up her face as though in pain.

"I love it," Renee grinned, ear-to-ear, and sucked down more oxygen. "You're so sexy, Kat, you know that? Freshly fucked."

"It's true," Julian smiled.

"You're... glowing..." Renee said, then pushed her face back in her friend's shaven pussy, sucking on her clit as she slid two fingers into her sex.

Kat looked up at her husband, said, “No regrets?”

He shook his head gently. “None at all.”

She smiled, relief imprinted on her features. “Show me,” she said, and glanced down between his legs as though to explain what she meant.

Julian backed off the bed again, and now removed his clothes. His wife’s eyes widened, and then her smile grew as she took in the size and hardness of his fully erect cock.

“Here,” she said softly, “give it to me.”

He knelt up by her head, and while Renee continued enjoying her pussy, Kat helped her husband to guide the end of his hardness to her mouth. She couldn’t do much in her position, but seemed to enjoy the feeling of her lips stretching around his hardness. She sucked on him a little, pumped his shaft with her hand. She pulled it out and stroked it around her mouth, around her face, reveling in the feeling of a second cock for the night.

With Renee’s expert tongue against her pussy, and a cock in her mouth, it didn’t take long for Kat to reach climax—another intense one, judging by the writhing, twisting, bucking of her body, and then her cry as it struck. That and Renee’s squeal of delight as once again, Kat began squirting on orgasm.

Red all over, Kat just lay there for a few moments afterward, hanging onto her husband’s cock, gasping, “Oh God... oh God...” as she came to terms with the intensity of the climax. Her head tilted back, she broke out into laughter at just how wild it all was.

“Jesus, you are a squirter, girl!” Renee declared.

Kat said, “It’s your fault... I never did it before this happened.”

“Our fault?”

Kat looked up at Julian, “It’s knowing how turned on you are by... you know... me having sex with someone else...” then she glanced down at Renee, “And you, too.”

Renee said, “I love it.”

Kat, “It feels... pretty intense...”

Renee giggled, “You know I’m going to be trying to make you do this every time now.”

“Won’t happen every time.”

But you could see in Kat’s eyes that she liked Renee’s determination to try. The redhead now urged Julian onto his back, as Kat pulled herself up

from the bed. Then she was guiding her friend down onto him, to straddle him, to take his hard cock between her legs, and into her seriously wet pussy.

“Time to take her back,” Renee told him, as he glanced down to see his hard cock swallowed up by Kat’s exquisite hairless pussy. Her wet, cheating pussy. Tight, but feeling slightly different than he remembered, having fitted itself to another man’s cock. Wet, like she’d never been before, because this time it was another man who had made her wet.

Julian reached up to cup her breasts as she began to rise and fall on his shaft, panting for breath a little. She leaned back, offering him an even better view of her adulterous pussy—and then Renee was reaching around to stroke Kat’s pussy while she rode on her husband.

It was a speedy route to another orgasm, to plenty of crying and moaning from the Hispanic beauty, her body glistening in perspiration and her nipples poking up so hard. Julian grabbed hold of her and wrestled her over onto the bed, and now he was over her, thrusting into her as her whole body jiggled and jostled under him.

“Uh... uh... uh...”

She’d never been this loud before, he thought, as he stepped up the pace of his thrusting.

“Come inside her... come inside her...” they heard Renee cry out as the big peak finally arrived, and Julian felt as though he had no option but to do so anyway. His body wracked and pulsed and fierce heat and energy throbbed between his legs, and he was, indeed, coming hard inside his wife, filling her with his cream. The second man to do so that night.

Kat crying out over and over, “Jesus... Jesus... Jesus...”

Chapter Twenty-Four

Sunday afternoon. After a long lie-in, Julian was woken by Kat getting ready for what appeared to be a date.

He propped himself up on his elbows and just watched her trying a few things on in front of the mirrored doors of the wardrobe—most notably, various items of very sexy underwear. He didn't alert her to his presence at first, until she seemed to decide on a set of white lace bra and panties, combined with a black-and-white lace garter belt and black nylon stockings. She looked simply breathtaking.

Then she put a tiny little black dress over the top, and he said, "Afternoon date lined up?"

She turned and offered him the sweetest of smiles. "We're having lunch with Daryl," she said. "That sound good?"

"We're having lunch?"

She nodded, confident, assertive. "You're coming, too," she said. "I want you to meet him."

"I met him last night after the show."

"You said hello to him. It wasn't really meeting him." Now she bent over to put on some high-heeled sandals, and the dress was short enough to give him a stunning view of her underwear. She looked like the perfect celebrity hottie. "Come on—you'll like him!"

Julian groaned, but it was mostly for show, as if as a guy he wasn't supposed to want to socialize with another guy who was seeing her. Yet he was at least a little curious about what Daryl was like.

"What am I wearing?" he asked, joking, "I'm not sure I have such sexy underwear in my suitcase..."

And actually, when they were all around a table—and Renee was there, too, for lunch itself, since apparently she had invited herself, but did make the dynamic seem less unconventional to anyone outside of their immediate company—Julian did find that he liked Daryl. The guy was charming, and he was respectful, and conversation was both easy and interesting.

Strange to be around him, and know that he had slept with Kat. But Julian kind of liked that strangeness, however. Though he didn't let it affect how he was over lunch, it quietly fed Julian's fantasy, and though he didn't go so far as to get hard, it did make him feel a little warm inside, a little aroused.

Kat had cheated on him with this guy. It made Julian shiver—in a good way.

And it was reassuring, at the end of the day. Julian felt that Kat was in good hands as the tour got going properly. It wasn't clear how the tour was going to progress, and it wasn't clear whether she was going to end up bedding other guys as well—she was certainly free to do so. But at least Julian could feel comfortable that she was safe with Daryl.

*

Later, much later, they were back at the hotel, smoking. It was something Julian hadn't done since the early days of college. Passing around a joint between the three of them, each taking a long drag as though it might be the last of the joint, inhaling, letting the fiery heat invade their lungs, the narcotic filtering through to their hazy heads. Daryl had managed to disable the room's smoke detector without alerting the powers that be, and so here they were, draped on an armchair and a couch.

Kind of strange to see Kat smoking, Julian thought. Let alone marijuana. She'd always liked a drink, and when they'd been dating and she'd been doing a little more of the part-time rock band thing than recently, she'd hung out in plenty of smoke-filled rooms with fellow musicians smoking everything under the sun, but Kat had always kept off it in Julian's experience.

Now, she was the one doing most of the actual passing of the joint between them—the courier, you might say. Taking it from Daryl, bringing it over to Julian, taking a toke on it herself on the way. Giggling as she watched her husband smoking it. Well, it was probably an even stranger sight for her, seeing him putting his lips around a fatty. Julian, the straight-laced insurance agent.

“Gigathrust—now they were just insane for the weed,” Daryl was saying, speaking slowly, softly, like all three of them were.

“You knew them?” Kat said, taking the joint from Daryl again for the umpteenth time from where she was sitting on the floor by his feet.

“We supported them,” Daryl nodded, looking sage beyond his years. Experienced as a rock star, even at the tender age of 25. “Hanratty Festival—somewhere in Tennessee, I think.”

“Wow,” Kat pulled herself up onto all fours, crawled over to where Julian was sitting in the armchair in Daryl’s room, handed the joint to him. There wasn’t an awful lot left by now. Julian was feeling a little light-headed, his tolerance for dope at an all-time low.

Nevertheless, he welcomed it, touched the end to his lips, breathed in carefully to avoid a coughing fit. It took the edge off things. Downplayed the strange sense of fear he felt from not knowing how it would really be for Kat to be with another man.

“Even I’ve heard of them,” Julian chuckled.

Daryl shrugged. “They were on the downswing when we supported them. Still pretty amazing, though.”

Kat went to sit on the couch, now, beside Daryl.

“After we were done we went back to the Gigathrust hotel, and the boys pulled out this weed like you couldn’t believe.”

“I bet they could get the really good stuff.”

“I was a regular, you know? And it practically blew my head off.”

They’d been out for a long while, with lunch turning to afternoon drinks, and then to dinner, and after-dinner drinks.

All night, Julian had expected a quiet word from his wife asking him if he’d give them a little space, a little alone time. Perhaps even the rest of the night. But she hadn’t. They’d talked about this and that, as they had been all day—the show, the performance, the music, the crowd, the venue, comparing it all with their recollections of tours gone by.

Julian had kept a close eye on Kat and Daryl. They’d sat together, apart from him. No one had said anything about it, although he’d caught a few sly glances from Renee, who was burning up inside from curiosity at what was going on between them all, though she desperately didn’t want to seem uncool enough to show it. But Daryl had acted the gentleman throughout, respectful, charming, fascinating even. Kat had shuffled close to him at times, even making it look overtly as though the two of them were a couple at times, though there was no touching, certainly no making out.

He had the idea that she was testing him out, assessing her husband for signs that he really didn't want her getting too close to Daryl, or perhaps any other man.

Nevertheless, there had been a kind of tension in the air. No one but the three of them, possibly excepting Renee, could detect it, but to Julian it was thick, obvious. A hesitant uncertainty—was she going with Daryl, or with Julian at the end of the night?

Renee had departed off to her room when they had finally got back to the hotel, since she wanted to get some sleep before the next day's trek to the next town on their tour—San Francisco. But Julian had accompanied Kat and Daryl up to Daryl's room, expecting to say goodbye to his wife on the doorstep. Instead, Daryl had invited him in, suggesting that they all partake in something that would be somewhat relaxing.

"Greg Dowling was just hilarious..." Daryl was saying now—name-dropping, but then all day they had wanted him to name-drop. That was the fun of hanging out with rock stars. And Daryl hadn't dropped too many names earlier on. By now, Julian could hardly concentrate on anything anyone was saying, though.

And now, sat in the corner of the couch propped up on her elbows, Kat quietly turned to Daryl and lifted up her legs, draping them over his lap. She looked into Daryl's eyes, and Julian felt his heart skip a beat as he watched the younger man running his fingers down her chest, over the thin black material of her dress, which covered very little of her legs, and the garters that held up her thigh-high stockings.

He fiddled with her garters a little, her legs looking so sensational in those stockings, and then his hand danced its way back up over her stomach, her chest, to graze one of the hard nipples that was poking against her dress. Now the two of them were looking deep into each other's eyes, smiling with more than just a flirtation.

Julian held his breath, wondering if the two of them could have somehow temporarily forgotten that he was still there. The dope had been very strong.

He also felt that tension return, even with the amount of dope that had been smoked. His wife was curled up on a couch with another man who was touching her breasts through her dress. Was he supposed to stop them? Defend the sanctity of his marriage?

But it was such a thrill. Julian could have cleared his throat, suggested it might be time for him to retire to bed and give them some space—and yet, if they had truly forgotten he was there in that deep armchair across from them, he was so very tempted to stay and watch whatever he could before they discovered him and told him to leave.

Kat was breathing deeply, smiling sweetly yet hungrily as her new boyfriend touched her breasts. She bit her lip, and then he was stroking her lips with the tips of his fingers, totally taken by her beauty.

Julian remained completely still in that armchair, now more afraid that they'd discover him and ask him to leave than the slim possibility that he might lose his wife to this young stud. His heart was beating crazy-fast. Could you get a heart attack just from watching something shocking?

Daryl gently touching her chin, now, leaning over to her slowly, the smile spreading across Kat's face. They were going to...

He kissed her, and Kat closed her eyes, tilted her head slightly, and returned his kiss, gently sucking on his bottom lip while his hand moved from her chin to stroke her long, dark hair before skating down over her shoulder, her breasts, her waist, her hip.

Wow. Julian was suddenly finding it hard to breathe again.

It was so sweet, so tender, the chemistry between them seemed almost to be popping and fizzing—and it made the jealousy burn deep within Julian, something he'd never expected to happen after everything he and his wife had talked about, had imagined, had fantasized. However, the thrill overwhelmed that feeling of jealousy, and after a rocky moment or two, the arousal that made his cock swell more than it had ever swollen before made all feelings of negativity moot.

Eyes closed, the two of them were moaning quietly as they sucked on each other's lips, and as they slipped their tongues into each other's mouths, Daryl stroking her hair, her breasts, her cheek as they kissed, before his hand trailed down to stroke her exposed thigh, the tops of her stockings.

Julian felt a touch awkward and out of place, particularly with that huge erection rocking his pants. He took another long drag on the tail end of that joint, acting as noisily as he could so that he might remind the couple on the couch as to his continuing presence.

Still, they continued making out on the couch. What did Julian do? He felt like some kind of trespasser. He'd never talked with Kat about staying in their presence as she fooled around with Daryl. Sure, part of him was

desperate to stay—maybe even find some place to hide, do his utmost to witness everything, from making out to actual adultery, wanting to see his naughty wife going past the point of no return as far as finally spiking her monogamy.

But he also felt as though he was being rude in staying. Maybe they were aware of his presence, and making out like teenagers on the couch was their way of politely suggesting it was time for him to step out, head back to his own hotel room.

And worst of all, he suddenly worried that his continued presence there might even threaten everything entirely. Daryl or Kat or both of them might be put off from continuing if he was sticking around. And despite the burn of jealousy, the chill of fear, the nervous butterflies raging around his stomach, Julian did want them to continue. He wanted Kat to do this. He wanted her to be unfaithful, even if it was with his blessing.

He stood up, making it obvious. The two of them ignored him. He took the two steps over to them, over to the couch, leaned over to quietly whisper in Kat's ear that he thought it was time for him to leave. Touched her wrist gently as he was about to speak...

And she turned slowly to him, her hand taking hold of his wrist instead of vice versa, and now she was pulling him down to her, craning her neck up to him, drawing him in so that his lips touched down against hers.

Her kiss so sweet, so warm, feeling as though it was somehow melting his insides. Sucking on his lips, slipping her tongue inside his mouth, her eyes closed as she kissed him—this was no peck goodbye, no parting shot. Daryl was stroking her breasts, running his hands over her stomach and her hips as she kissed her husband, certainly not put off.

She was so beautiful, in that moment Julian could hardly believe she was his wife. She turned her head back to Daryl, and he kissed her warm, soft neck, breathing in her perfume and the slight remaining hint of perspiration. And she was kissing another man again, and it was just so graceful and bewitching to watch.

Were they really wanting him to stay?

Julian leaned in to kiss Kat's soft cheek even while she was locking lips with Daryl, as though he was offering her a goodbye kiss now—but she turned to him again, pulled him to her again, kissed him so passionately, there was no hint in her expression or in her body language that she wanted him to leave.

It seemed so strange, and yet now that he thought about it, the whole night Julian hadn't received any hint of possessiveness from Daryl as he might have expected. That this was his woman now, that Julian had to give her up. Daryl had had the utmost respect for Julian all along—as though the man was on a level with him, a rock star, purely because a woman like Kat had married him.

And now without any real signaling, both he and Daryl were simultaneously peeling off her dress, pulling it up over her head, exposing her bare breasts. Where had her bra gone? When had she even taken it off?

Daryl took one of her breasts in his hand and covered her stiff nipple with his mouth, and Kat tilted her head up to kiss Julian again. He could hardly believe it. And Julian's hand cupped her other breast, squeezed her other nipple all the while he tasted her sweet mouth.

Kat looked up at her husband with intense lust in her eyes, and before he kissed her again, her hand was between his leg, reaching for him, seeking out the bulge in his pants, making sure it was there and then exploring it, enjoying how excited she was making him.

Somehow with one hand she managed to unfasten the fly button on his black jeans, and now she was tugging on them, wanting them to come down. Julian felt his heart jumping about, totally shocked by what was going on, but eager to go with whatever his wife wanted.

She peeled down his jeans and his underwear, freeing up his monumental erection, and then her hands were all over it. She looked up at his face as though seeking his permission, and Julian felt suddenly self-conscious. Standing there with his cock out in front of another man—it wasn't what he'd ever expected.

In fact, just now Kat seemed almost to be ignoring Daryl in favor of her husband, and even as nice as it felt physically, Julian was beginning to worry that she was neglecting him, that he might get up and walk out of there, that she didn't want him any more.

Yet Daryl didn't seem at all put out by it. In fact, he was watching them closely, even stroking Kat's hair gently, almost encouraging her to get closer to Julian to take him in her mouth. Julian watched as the guy ushered her up, holding her hips in both hands to urge her onto her feet in front of her husband. For a moment, Julian feared he might just get up and walk out of there, but then as Kat did stand up—her hands still on her husband's hard cock her face closing in on his for another sweet kiss—Daryl remained

sitting on the edge of the couch, to check her out in only her garter belt, her stockings and panties.

“Down boy,” Kat grinned, and gestured for Julian to sit. He did so, returning to the armchair, expecting his wife to leave him there to watch, to turn away from him and focus on her new lover.

But she merely leaned over him, bending at the hips to leave her shapely behind pointing at Daryl, taking her husband’s cock in her hands once again, before brushing her silky, dark hair back out of the way, then stretching her lips around Julian’s hard cock.

Julian groaned as he felt the intense heat of her mouth engulfing his sensitive tip. Oh, it felt so good. And yet as he stroked her soft hair, he wasn’t focusing on the sight of her taking his cock in her mouth, or of her withdrawing it to lavish sexy licks all over his shaft. He was watching Daryl kissing his way along her garter belt, his hands all over her sweet ass.

Kat looked up at him and flashed him a wicked smile. So sexy. As though to ask if they were really doing this, or at least to draw attention to it. So bizarre. A woman sucking on her husband while another man toyed with her pussy. And Daryl was toying with it. From the noises Kat made, from the movement of her hips, from the movement of Daryl’s arms—it was clear he had pulled aside her panties and slipped fingers inside her soaking pussy.

Even over the smell of her perfume, Julian thought he could detect the scent of her arousal in the air now. It drove him a little wild—and he had to concentrate on not coming in Kat’s mouth. Not yet, at least.

Daryl was pulling off his shirt, revealing that ripped body of his that Kat was so taken with—Julian felt his heart rate pick up. Was he going to fuck her right in front of him? Was it really going to happen? The butterflies were stirred up in his stomach again.

Kat stood up again, and for a moment Julian had no idea what she was planning. She turned around, giving him a superb view of her body in just stockings, garters and a pair of white lace panties that didn’t quite seem to go with the rest of her outfit, seeming somehow almost rebellious. She turned to Daryl, who was pulling himself up to his feet while unfastening his belt, but straddled Julian’s thighs. Was she thinking of fucking her husband while going down on Daryl?

Julian was preparing himself for her to take his hard cock inside her, but he had a funny knot in his stomach, as though he felt again that he shouldn't have been there. This should have been a place for Kat to fuck her new man, and then only later go to tell her husband all about it. Instead, she was seeking to lull her husband into it by going down on him first, by fucking him first, with Daryl playing a supporting role only.

But now he caught a whiff of his wife's sexy scent. He gently but forcefully grabbed hold of her hips, while slumping down in the armchair. She squealed and giggled as he pulled her back, but she let him manhandle her, and went with what he wanted, carefully positioning herself over his head, while leaning forward to reach for her new lover.

From between her legs, Julian caught a glimpse of Daryl standing in front of his wife, his jeans now yanked down, his erection raised aloft, his cock looking huge no doubt helped by the fact that the guy didn't have a trace of hair anywhere. Was that how the younger generation was doing it now?

She was so wet, her panties drenched as he tugged them aside to expose her sweet flower, her dusky folds glistening with her juices. He tasted her, kissing her sex, slipping his tongue delicately inside her, sucking on her pussy lips a little—but at the same time he was listening out for what she was doing with Daryl. As hot as it was feasting on her delicious wetness, What really got Julian's pulse racing was his wife's little giggle, Daryl's soft moan, and then the wet sounds of Kat taking his hard cock in her mouth, swirling her tongue around it, sinking down on his length.

It was hot hearing her sucking on him, seriously hot. But perhaps better still, Julian felt her now begin to rub herself on him, taking control of the motion of her pussy gliding over his lips and his tongue. She was responding to her excitement of sucking on a new cock by wiggling her hips and stirring her sex against Julian's mouth.

Julian tightened his grip around her hips and her butt, wedging his face against her hot, wet pussy, and just went with the flow, hearing her moaning getting louder and louder and louder.

She was shivering, quaking, crying out—and then her whole body seemed to suddenly jerk. She squealed, and as her husband pulled away from her for a moment to figure out what was going on, his face was suddenly soaked. She bucked over him, almost some kind of seizure, and there were another couple of sprinkles of her juices over his face.

She was squirting again. Julian clamped his mouth to her pussy and ate her while she clamped her thighs tight against his biceps and wedged herself down on his face, shuddering, yelling, whimpering as the powerful climax coursed through her.

“Wow,” Julian heard Daryl say, as at last Kat rose slowly, uncertainly from her husband’s drenched face. “You see what you did?”

Kat giggled, and said, “It only started happening, you know. When we started doing all this crazy stuff.”

“Didn’t happen last night,” Daryl said.

“Oh no, my husband has to be here,” she said, and Julian felt a wonderful warmth blooming inside him.

Kat just stood there a moment, recovering, and Julian pulled himself up to a seated position, his jeans around his ankles, his cock exposed and rock-hard. Licking his lips, still tasting her, as he certainly still smelled her strong arousal all around him, admiring a rear view of her wearing only her stockings, garter belt, panties.

Daryl was seated on the couch opposite, and now Kat slowly climbed on his lap. Julian kicked off his jeans and then sat there, stunned, as he saw his wife straddling this other man, the guy’s big, hard dick just underneath her dripping pussy.

Julian held his breath as he watched her shuffle a little more up the other man’s thighs, lodging her knees by his hips, and now reached behind herself to grasp his stiff cock. She touched the tip of that great thing between her spread buttocks, to touch her glistening folds.

This was it. He was really going to see it—live, and in the flesh.

She breathed out, and then her hips sank slightly, and though her hand obscured it somewhat, Julian could tell that the guy’s tip was inside her, *inside his beloved wife*.

She held him there for a moment, and Julian saw her wedding ring sparkle on her finger as she held another man’s cock so that it was partially inside her. Then she suddenly sank right down, so that only the guy’s balls were visible as she removed her hand.

Oh my God.

Another man had his cock inside of his wife. All the way. Right in front of him. She was so wet she’d just slid right down his full length, engulfing him totally. Julian watched her rise up again, and the man’s shaft emerged, soaked by her juices, before being swallowed again.

Julian just watched a while, totally stunned as he watched her bouncing on the man's lap, his cock thrusting into her like a piston as he held aside her panties. He didn't really feel jealousy now—he was beyond jealousy. This was just pure excitement. His naughty wife was cheating on him, damn it. He could see it with his own eyes, he could smell the sex. She was so wet the guy kept slipping out of her, and she had to help guide it back in, allowing Julian to see him penetrating her time and time again.

Maybe what got him most of all was the sounds of her moans—so pure, so beautiful, so joyous. Was that how she sounds when she was with him? He couldn't be sure. Everything seemed so different now he was watching from outside.

He started to touch himself, but then he felt the sudden need to see her face while she rode this other man, to catch her expressions, to look into her eyes. He stood up and stepped over to the couch next to them. He climbed up to sit on the back of the couch, encouraged on by Kat's glorious smile.

While still fucking Daryl, she leaned over to kiss her husband. It was unreal, feeling her body rocking while he kissed her, knowing it was from fucking another. He cradled the back of her head, stroked her hair, delighted in the sweetness of her lips—lips that had just been stretched around another man's cock—and then he felt her hands close around his cock, her fingers tightening.

She leaned down, and took his cock into her mouth while still bouncing on Daryl's hardness. She wasn't exactly focused on her husband's cock, but that didn't matter. It was the hottest blow job he'd ever had purely because another guy was filling her pussy at the time.

Oh, she was so pretty. He pulled his cock out of her mouth and stroked it over her pretty face. Tapped it against her full lips, making her grin, making her giggle. This was just so ridiculously wild. Daryl gave her ass a few playful pats and now Kat seemed to be rising toward another orgasm. Julian just leaned back and watched, her bobbing down on his shaft all but stopping as she seemed to just use his cock to hang onto while her next orgasm dropped.

Finally, she was coming, and merely holding her husband's cock against one of her cheeks. Julian closed his eyes a moment or two, trying to keep from letting go, and then he heard her squealing sharply, and opened his eyes to gaze down into her shocked face.

“He’s coming...” she said in barely more than a whisper, “he’s coming inside me...”

Sure enough, Daryl had his eyes shut and was quietly grunting, his own orgasm hitting perhaps a little on the early side. Again, Julian had to be careful to control himself—he did not want to come yet—and it was ten times as difficult this time. He felt overwhelmed by some powerful urge, by some kind of biological force as he watched another man coming inside his wife. His own cock was harder than it had ever been, bulging in Kat’s hands, throbbing and pulsating, ready to slide inside her and reclaim her from his rival suitor.

Kat looked up at him, a touch fearful, perhaps, at whether she had overstepped the boundary by involving Julian to such a degree.

But he smiled down at her, leaned forward again to kiss her mouth again, before he whispered to her: “My turn.”

She knelt up, lifting one leg to allow Daryl to escape, and yet remained where she was on the couch. The younger man moved out of the way, but now as Julian pulled himself off the couch and stood behind his wife, Kat ushered Daryl into position where Julian had been on the back of the couch, even if his cock was softening now. She wasn’t done with him.

She knelt forward and brushed her hair back out of her face with both hands, sweeping it down over her shoulders. She looked so gorgeous in those stockings, so trashy and yet her white lacy panties added an unexpected touch of class.

Julian watched her take hold of Daryl’s semi-soft cock, bending down to wrap her lips around it, to nurse it back to readiness. Then he crouched briefly, kissing the spectacular roundness of her behind, pulling aside her panties again to just look upon her adulterous pussy. It was incredible. A pussy freshly fucked by a man who was not her husband.

Then he was up, holding onto her panties as though they were some kind of reins, allowing him to hold her in place as he tapped his hard cock against her peachy ass, and stroked his tip against her slippery folds.

He eased the head of his cock slowly inside her, taking it slowly even if his entire body now quivered and fizzed with adrenaline, that biological urge compelling him to leave all the finer behavior out and just slam his manhood into her, to fuck her hard and fast and ensure the continuation of his bloodline instead of his rival’s. She was so wet, so slippery, and it

wasn't only from her juices—her pussy was covered in another man's come.

Kat cried out, muffled by the hardening cock in her mouth, and Julian was inside her, filling her completely, feeling like a new cock himself because he was just so unbelievably turned on.

Julian held on to her panties by the waist and started thrusting into her, fucking her increasingly hard thanks to the copious wetness inside her, while watching her head bobbing up and down on Daryl, who was now back to full hardness, surprisingly quickly.

After a while, his biological urge seemed to simmer down a little, his body seemed to accept the sharing of this beautiful woman. The two of them switched places again, only with Kat lying down on the couch on her back, Daryl sliding into her missionary-style while Kat turned her head to suck on her husband. Later, Julian spooned on the couch with her while she took Daryl's manhood into her mouth again.

It just went on and on, until Julian couldn't hold out any more. He came in her mouth, his thick cream spilling out of her lips, tumbling down onto her breasts as she eagerly licked and sucked on his bucking cock.

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Chapter Twenty-Five

Late in the evening, it was just the two of them. No Daryl, no Renee. Just Julian and Kat, husband and wife, lounging around the hotel suite in t-shirts and underwear. They didn't go out for dinner, but ordered room service. They watched a little TV, cuddling up on the couch, just enjoying the time with each other. They even switched off their phones for a while, cutting themselves off from the outside.

For a long while, they didn't even talk about the huge changes that had happened in their relationship since Kat had left home. They just rested, took comfort in their own company, made out as though everything was as it had always been.

They weren't entirely isolated from the world outside—while watching TV, Julian was flipping through the channels when he stumbled on a local news segment about The Ponytails and the tour.

"...Fans of the popular boy band Blue Tonic are lining up to buy tour tickets for the re-formed 90s girl group The Ponytails. Blue Tonic had been due to support The Ponytails on their nationwide tour, but last week lead singer Billy Madden checked into a local rehab center with reported drug problems. But last night's first tour performance saw remaining Blue Tonic members joining The Ponytails—with the combined band playing both Ponytails and some Blue Tonic songs. As our correspondent Dave Gardener reports, fans were raving about the show..."

Kat returned from the bathroom to watch the rest of the report, standing still as the information washed over her.

"Wow," was all she said.

"Some great coverage," Julian said, getting up from the couch, wandering over to her. "You guys deserve it."

"Andrew's been ecstatic ever since the show," Kat said, smiling as her husband stood behind her and wrapped his arms around her affectionately. "Now I can see why."

"So the rest of the tour can go ahead," Julian said, stooping to kiss the base of her neck. "I'll bet it's going to be a seriously successful one, too."

She leaned back against him, and moaned quietly as he ran his hands over the delightful topography of her breasts, her nipples now stiffening up under the thin material of her t-shirt.

“It’s amazing, isn’t it?” she said. “Do you think things would have gone as well if Billy hadn’t got sick?”

Julian peeled off her t-shirt, leaving her in nothing but a pair of white panties. “I think if Blue Tonic had been up and running, maybe their fans would have been just as happy—and others would have wanted to go see them later in the tour.”

She tilted her head up to him, and he kissed her mouth, his hands gliding over her smooth, golden skin, reveling in her toned stomach, her shapely waist, her gorgeous breasts.

“I think we’ve been quite lucky,” she said. “Fans want to see the weird combination of the Ponytails and Blue Tonic—it’s more than just the sum of its parts.”

“What does it matter?” he asked her, slipping his hand down into her panties, feeling the softness of her flesh over her mound, his fingers dipping into her moistening folds. “The show was a success, and the tour will be, too. You’re going to have an unbelievably great time...”

“But you won’t be here,” she complained.

“I’ll be with you sometimes. Often enough.”

Slowly, taking his time, he stroked her pussy with one hand, then the other, kissing her tenderly. She was able to reach behind her, to stroke him, to seek out the bulge in his undershorts, to take hold of it in her hand.

“You won’t even notice I’m gone,” he said with a dry smile.

“I will.”

“You’ll be so wrapped up in Daryl and his big, hard cock.”

One hand inside his undershorts, she felt him hardening up as he mentioned her spending time with her new lover. It never ceased to amaze her how he could feel that way about her taking pleasure from someone else.

She turned to face him, kissing him again so sweetly, and now she pulled off his t-shirt, then peeled down his boxer shorts to reveal his thickening cock. Perhaps it was a little smaller than Daryl’s, perhaps not. It was familiar, though, and she loved it.

“I’ll have Daryl,” she said, running her hands down his chest, then slowly dropping down to her knees in front of him to take in the sight of his

bare body, his exposed manhood.

“And Renee,” Julian grinned.

“And Renee,” she nodded. “But you won’t have anyone—you’ll be all alone on the other side of the country.”

He smiled as she took hold of his cock in one hand, holding onto his hip with the other for support. She leaned forward and took him into her mouth, and it just felt exquisite.

He said, “I don’t need anybody else. You know it’s always been about you.”

She looked up at him, her mouth full of his cock, her eyes grateful and touched at his selflessness.

But his smile said it wasn’t all selflessness. “You know what a turn-on it is for me,” he said as she sucked on him, slowly bobbing down on his length. “I’m going to be at home thinking about my gorgeous wife being all naughty and sexy and doing all kinds of things with another guy. It won’t be so bad for me.”

“I’ll tell you... everything... that happens...” she promised, in between mouthfuls of his cock.

“And that’s all I’ll need.”

He helped her up off the floor, and now led her to the bedroom, urged her down to lie across the bed, her legs draped over the edge of the mattress. She lay back as he knelt between her thighs, touching his mouth gently to her sex.

For an age and a day he licked her, he lapped at her tangy, addictive nectar, he mapped out the topography of her pussy in rich detail with his tongue. They had time, they weren’t in any real rush. Kat leaned back and enjoyed it, less worried now about the whys and the wherefores, more able to let it go and just enjoy the fact that her husband was now obsessed with her pussy—much more so than before, when she had been true to him.

Julian simply indulged, soaking his entire face with her wetness, adoring that this was her pussy, this was where she had accepted another man—this was the heart of her adultery.

Then, at last, he was up on his feet and sliding his full thickness into her wet, puffy pussy, squeezing his hips to slowly thrust into her, filling his naughty wife, then withdrawing, then filling her again.

“Oh God... oh God...” she moaned, her body rocking back and forth as he fucked her slowly and sensually. He didn’t need to go fast, she was so

tuned up by her weekend of solid sex.

Was it different now that she'd been with another? To some degree, they both would have had to say it was. Yet only in a good way. They seemed to notice each other more, they seemed to respond to each other with new eyes, as though starting their relationship from scratch. The knowledge that she had been unfaithful just increased Julian's hunger for his wife tenfold—and her appreciation for him, and what he was giving her, meant the same the other way.

Husband and wife were no longer cutting sex short, no longer speeding things up and making it all as efficient as possible. They took their time, they slowed things down, they appreciated each other with all their senses.

And though their pace was slow, the intensity of their orgasms when they finally hit was beyond compare.

*

In the morning, everyone was at the airport. The band was raring to go, to build on the success of LA with a fantastic show up in San Francisco.

Julian had to split from them after security, but despite facing a flight across the country alone, back to home in good old suburban Kingston, after a final embrace and a passionate PDA-style kiss with his wife, he had the pleasure of watching her step away from him only to be enveloped by the arms of another man.

He walked slowly away from them, backwards, offering them a wave here and there until he was out of sight around the corner. But he saw Kat turn her head, tilt her face up to Daryl—and he saw them kiss. It wasn't just a little polite peck, it was the kiss of lovers.

Julian was hard all the way home, it seemed.

And now, he had the promise of his wife going wild throughout a whole tour to keep him company while he waited to see her again.

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